Young Women's Labour-Market Inclusion

Findings and cost of inaction, Ukraine

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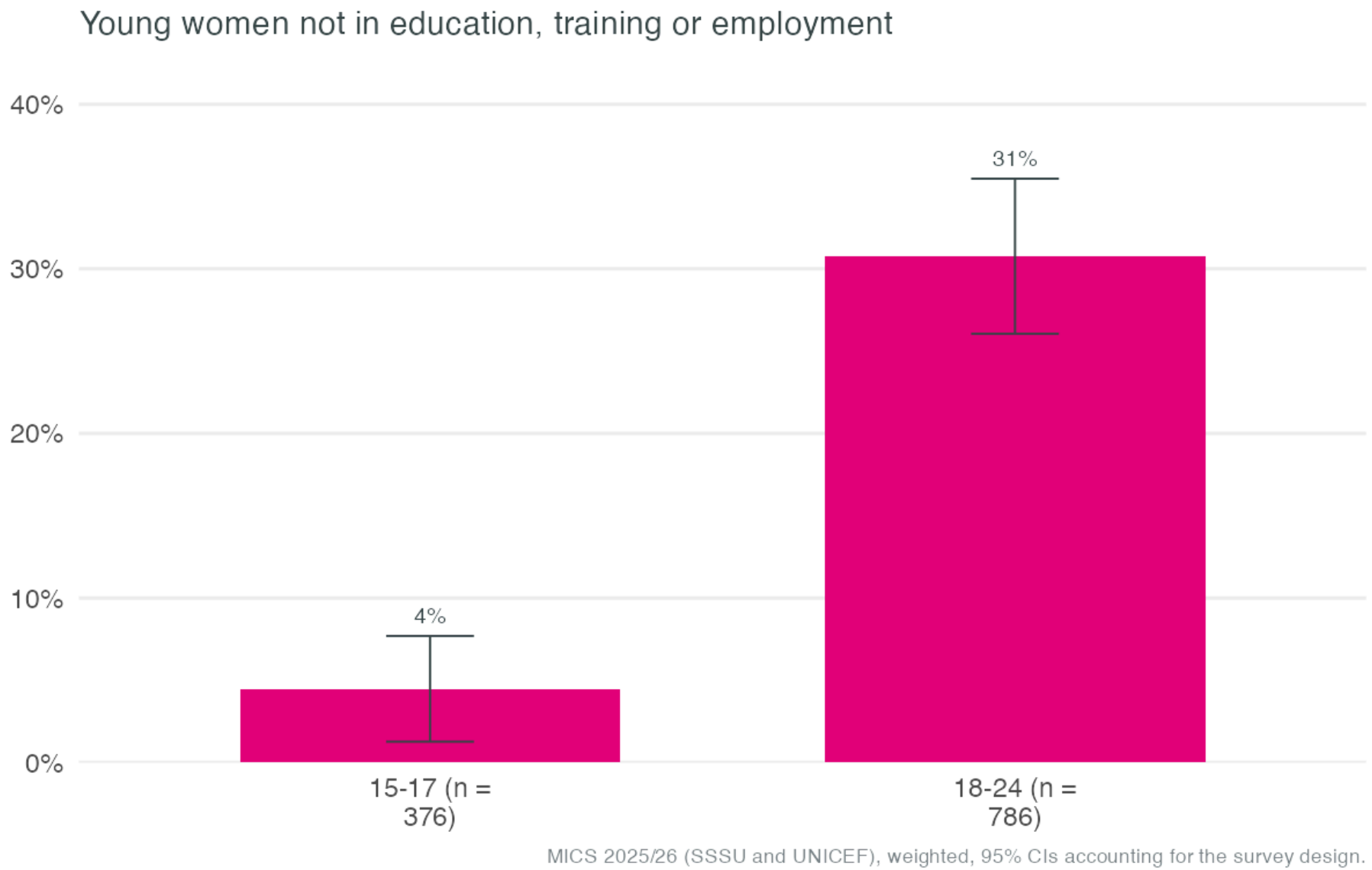
Appendix

Data sources

- **Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) 2025/26**, State Statistics Service of Ukraine with UNICEF: 23,708 households, 37,315 household members, 8,213 women aged 15–49 selected for interview, and children 5–17. There is no men's questionnaire. Main source for education, NEET and employment among young women, marriage, motherhood, disability, displacement, wealth and changes in households since the beginning of the conflict.
- **UNICEF Household Social and Economic Status Survey (HSESS)**, December 2023 to February 2024, Institute of Demography and Quality of Life Problems: 18,838 individuals in 8,024 households, all regions covered by the survey (Luhansk oblast is not included). Covers women and men: participation, employment, NEET, job quality, occupations, earnings and childcare.
- **SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021** (anonymised public-use file), collected in 2021: 265.6k interviews from 151.7k persons aged 15+. Shown for reference only.

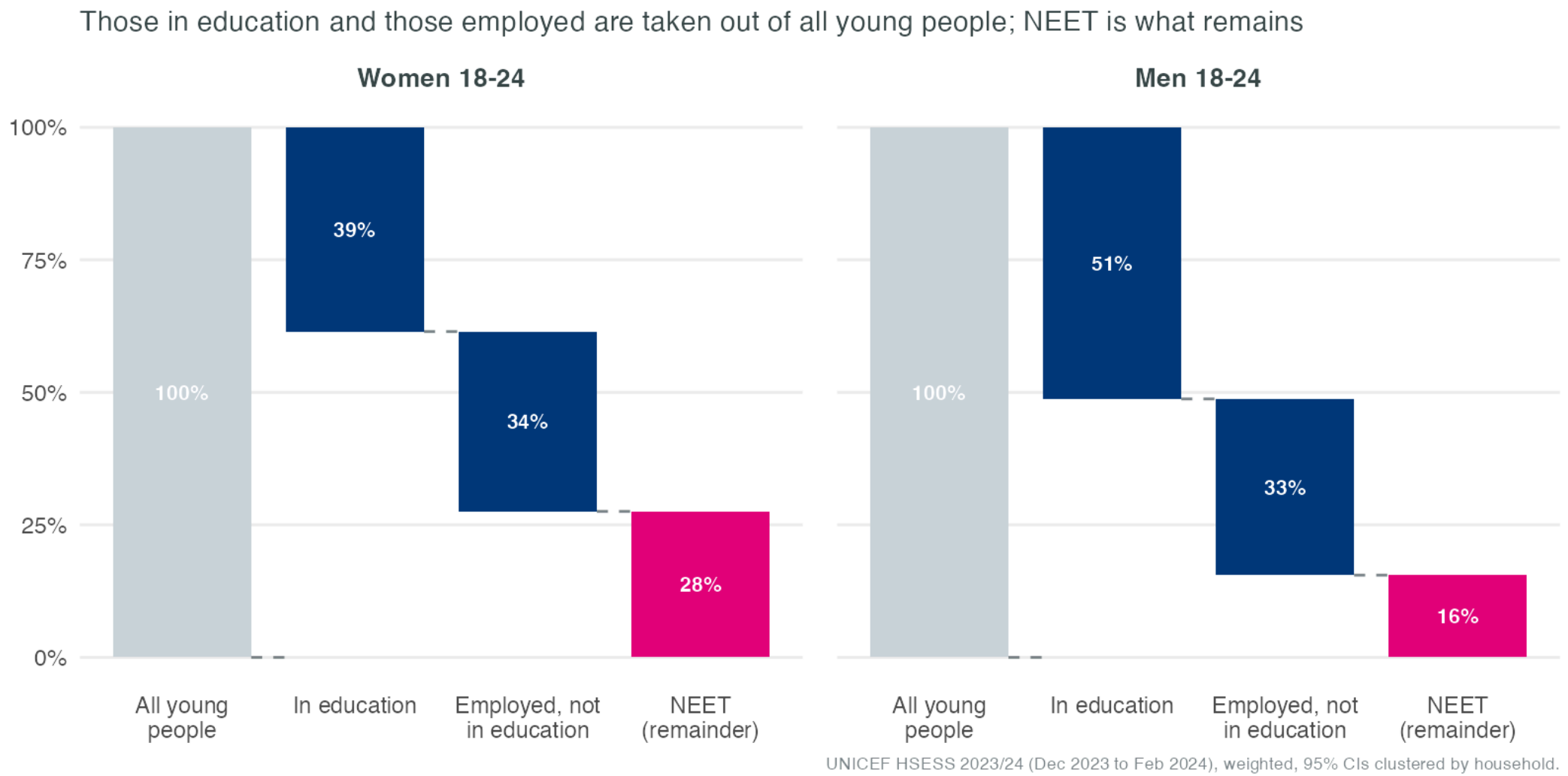
1 · The problem

31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET



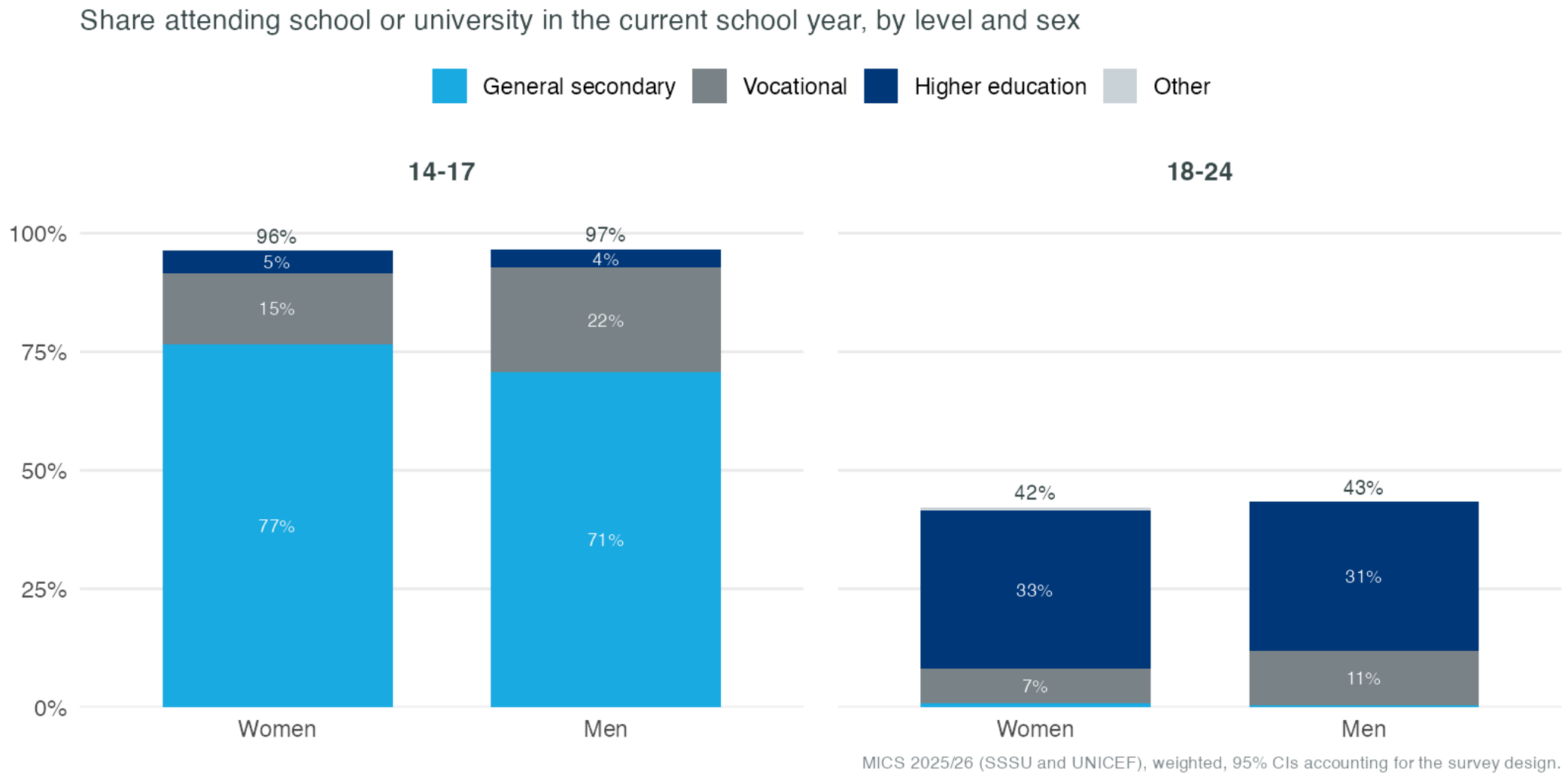
MICS 2025/26. NEET: not in education or training and not employed. At 15–17 the rate is 4%: almost all girls are still in education. The survey asks these questions to women from age 15, so NEET cannot be measured at 14.

The gap with young men comes from education, not employment



HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24. NEET: women 28%, men 16%. In education: women 38%, men 51%. Employed and not in education: women 34%, men 33%. NEET is what remains after education and employment.

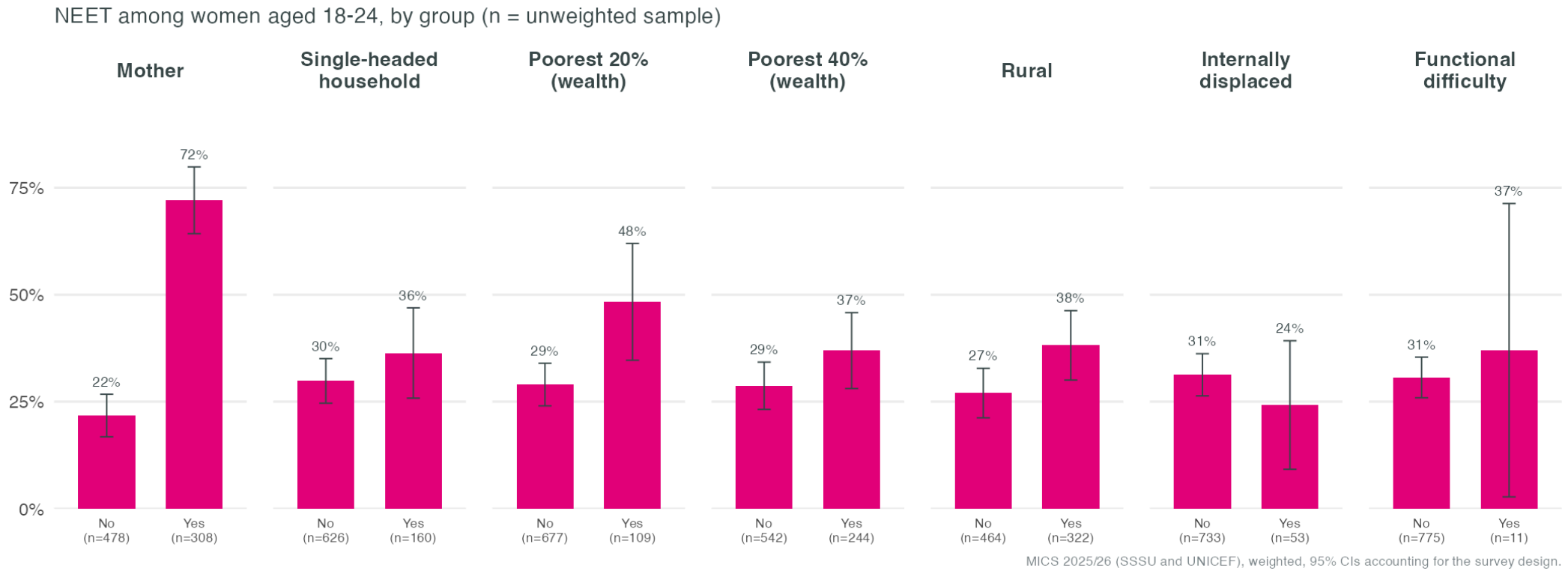
At 14–17, almost all girls and boys are in school



MICS 2025/26, household members attending in the current school year. Ages 14–17: girls 96%, boys 97%. Ages 18–24: women 42%, men 43%. School attendance is available from age 14; NEET and employment only from age 15. MICS does not show the gap in education at 18–24 that HSESS shows; the surveys differ in date, respondent and definition.

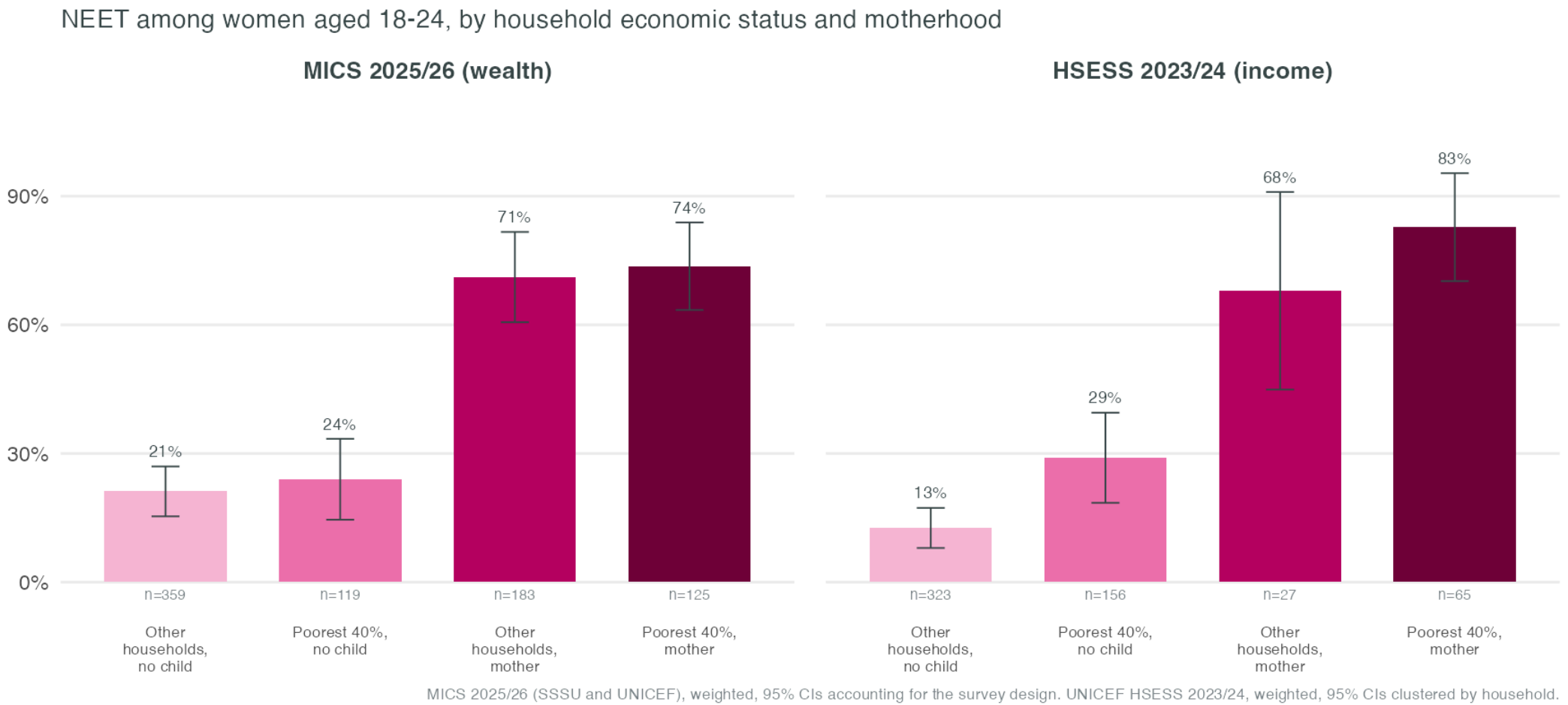
2 · Who is most affected

Mothers and the poorest have the highest NEET rates



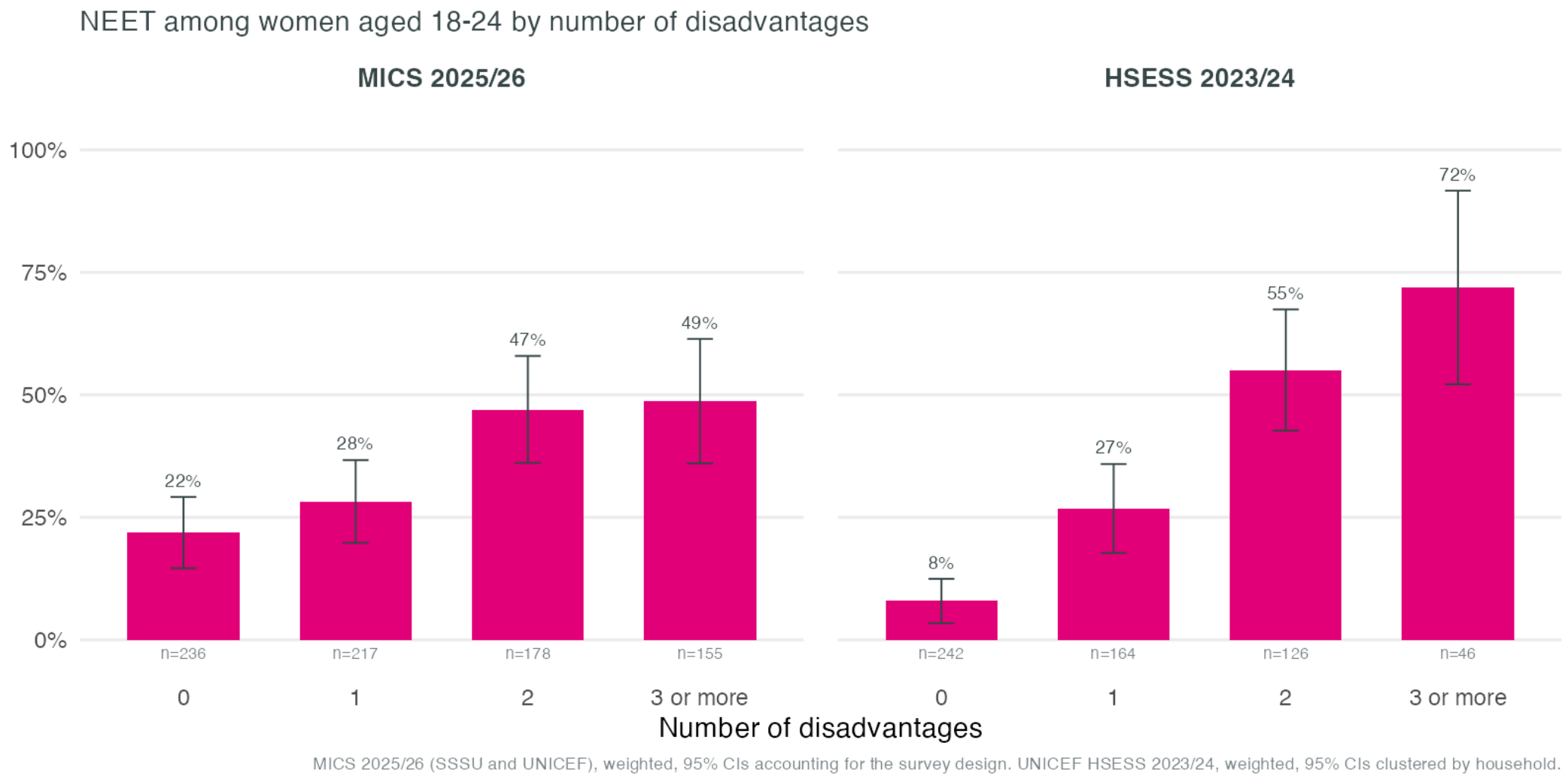
MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. Mothers 72% vs 22%; poorest fifth 48% vs 29%; single-headed households 36% vs 30%; internally displaced 24% vs 31%. Bars show 95% confidence intervals and the sample size; small groups should not be ranked.

Among poor young mothers, NEET reaches 74% to 83%



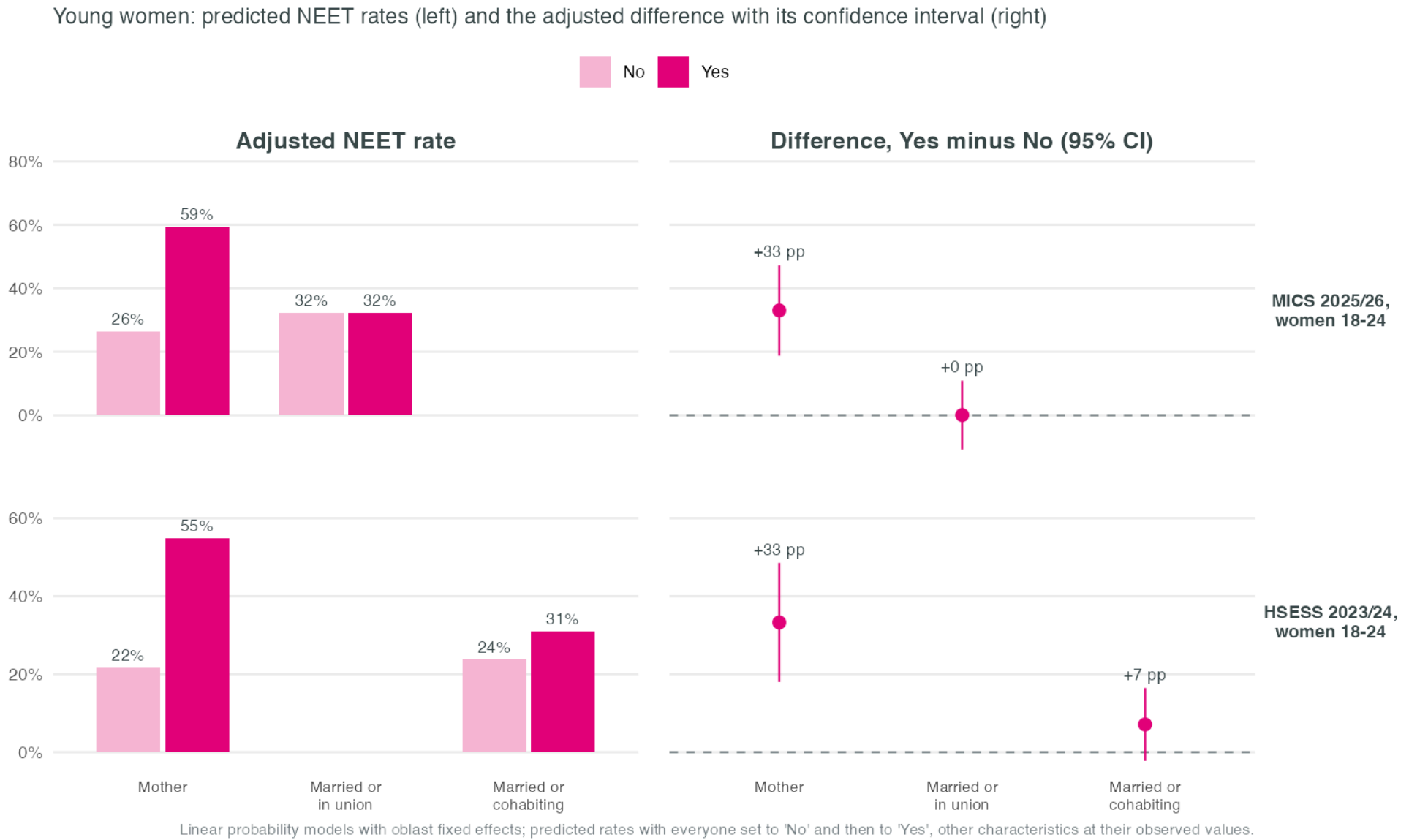
Women aged 18–24. Women with neither characteristic: 21% (MICS) and 13% (HSESS). Poor mothers are 16% of NEET young women in MICS and 30% in HSESS. Poorest 40% by wealth (MICS) or income per household member (HSESS).

Disadvantages add up



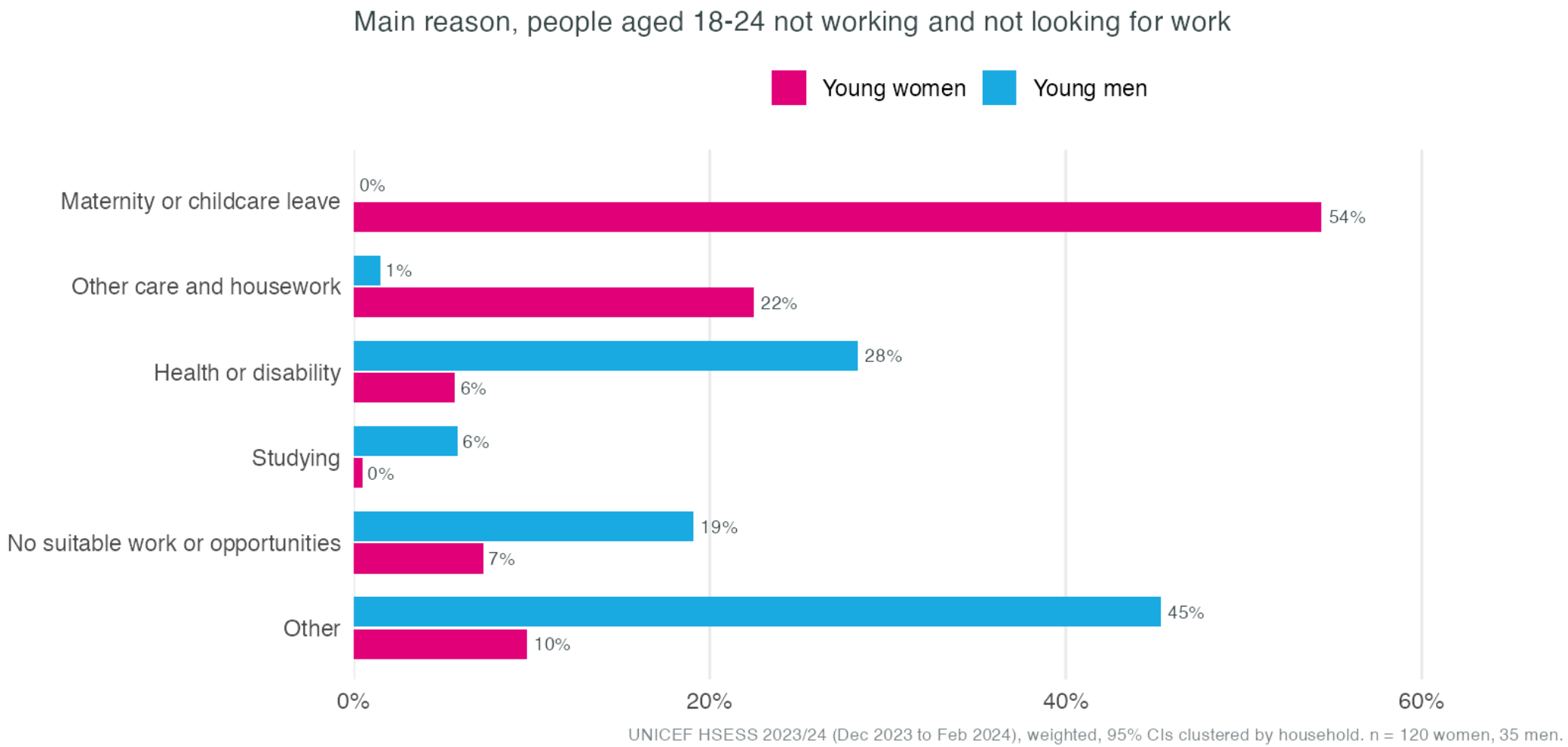
Women aged 18–24. With none of the five disadvantages, NEET is 22% (MICS) and 8% (HSESS); with three or more, 49% and 72%. Disadvantages: motherhood, poorest 40%, rural, displaced, single-headed household.

Motherhood remains the main factor after adjustment



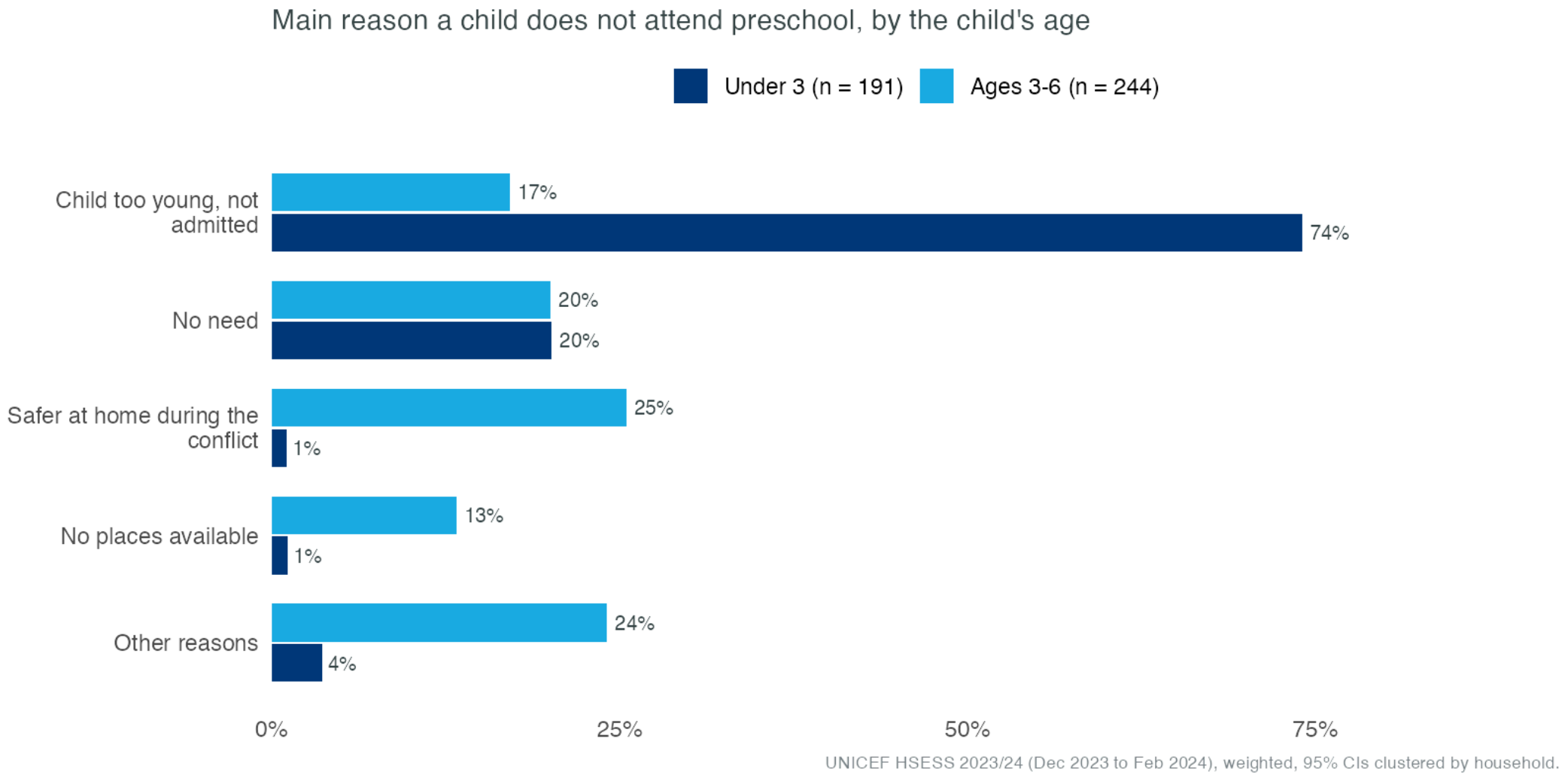
Women aged 18–24, both surveys. Left: predicted NEET rates for mothers and others, and for married women and others, holding age, area, education, income and displacement constant. Right: the difference with its 95% confidence interval. Associations, not causal effects.

Why young women are not working or looking for work



HSESS 2023/24, people aged 18–24 who were not employed and not looking for work. Maternity or childcare leave is shown separately from other care and housework.

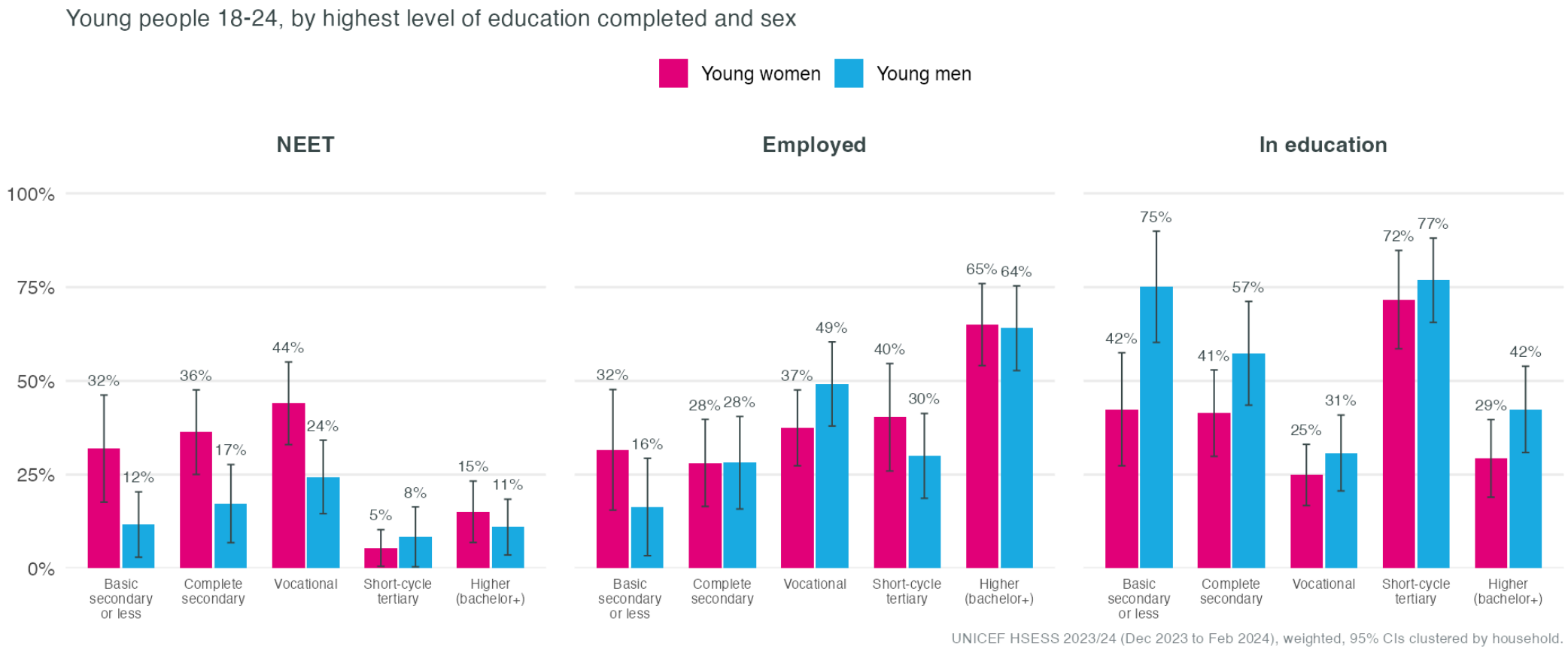
Childcare barriers differ by the child’s age



HSESS 2023/24: main reason a child does not attend preschool, for children under 3 and aged 3–6. Preschool attendance at ages 3–5 is 60% (MICS 2025/26).

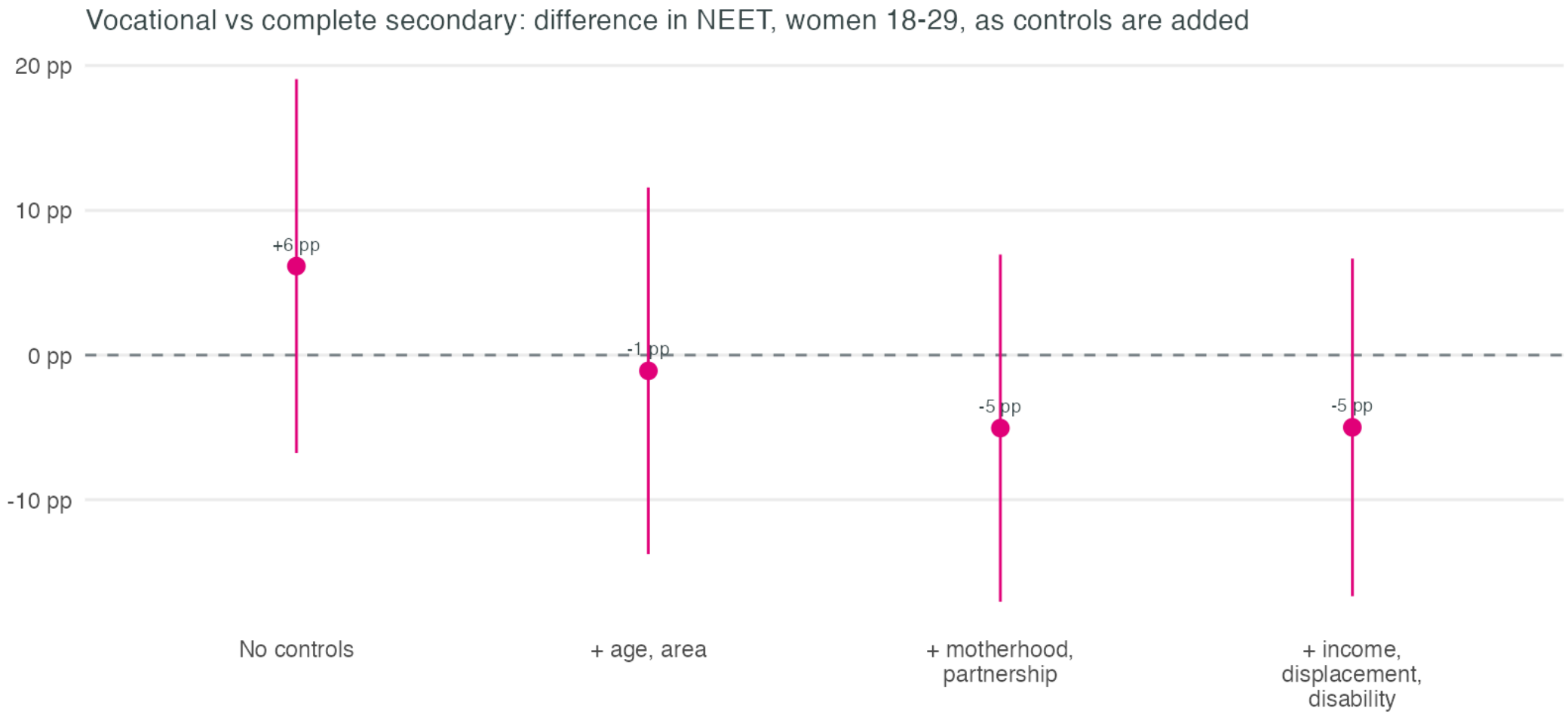
3 · From education to earnings

NEET falls with education



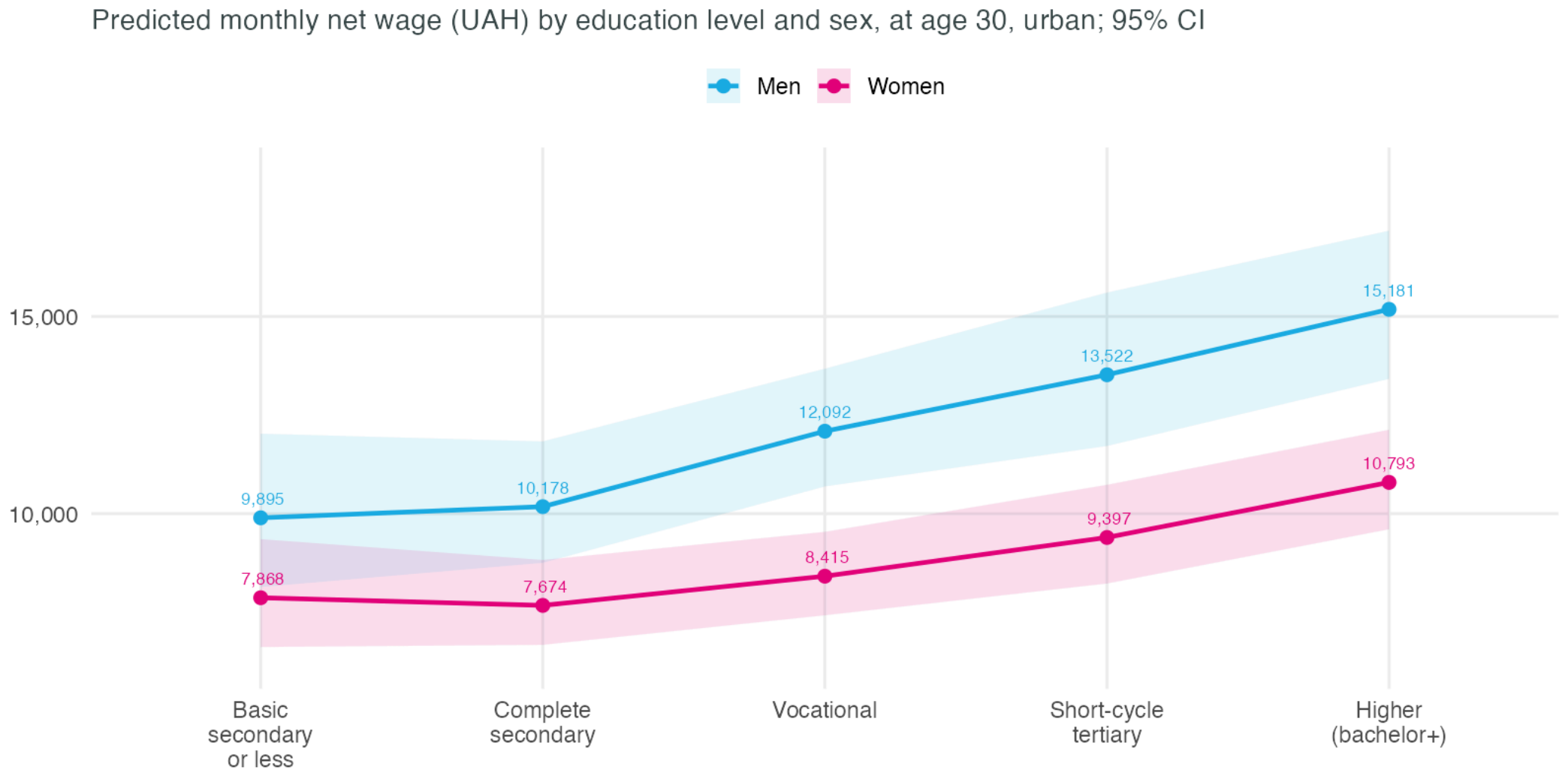
HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24, by highest level completed. NEET among women: 15% with higher education, 36% with complete secondary. Many 18–24 year olds are still studying, so rates by level should be read together with the share in education.

No significant NEET gap between vocational and secondary education



HSESS 2023/24, women aged 18–29. Each dot is a regression coefficient: the difference in the NEET rate between women with vocational and with complete secondary education (linear probability model, oblast fixed effects), with its 95% confidence interval, as controls are added. The difference is 6 pp without controls and -5 pp with all controls; no interval excludes zero, so the difference is not statistically significant in any specification. NEET by level: vocational 48%, complete secondary 44%, tertiary 30%.

Women earn less than men at every level of education



HSESS 2023/24, wage earners aged 18–64. Predicted net monthly wage at age 30 in an urban area. Gap at comparable age and area: 25% with complete secondary, 29% with higher education. Each additional year of education is associated with 5.8% higher wages for women and 7.2% for men. Not adjusted for hours, occupation or sector.

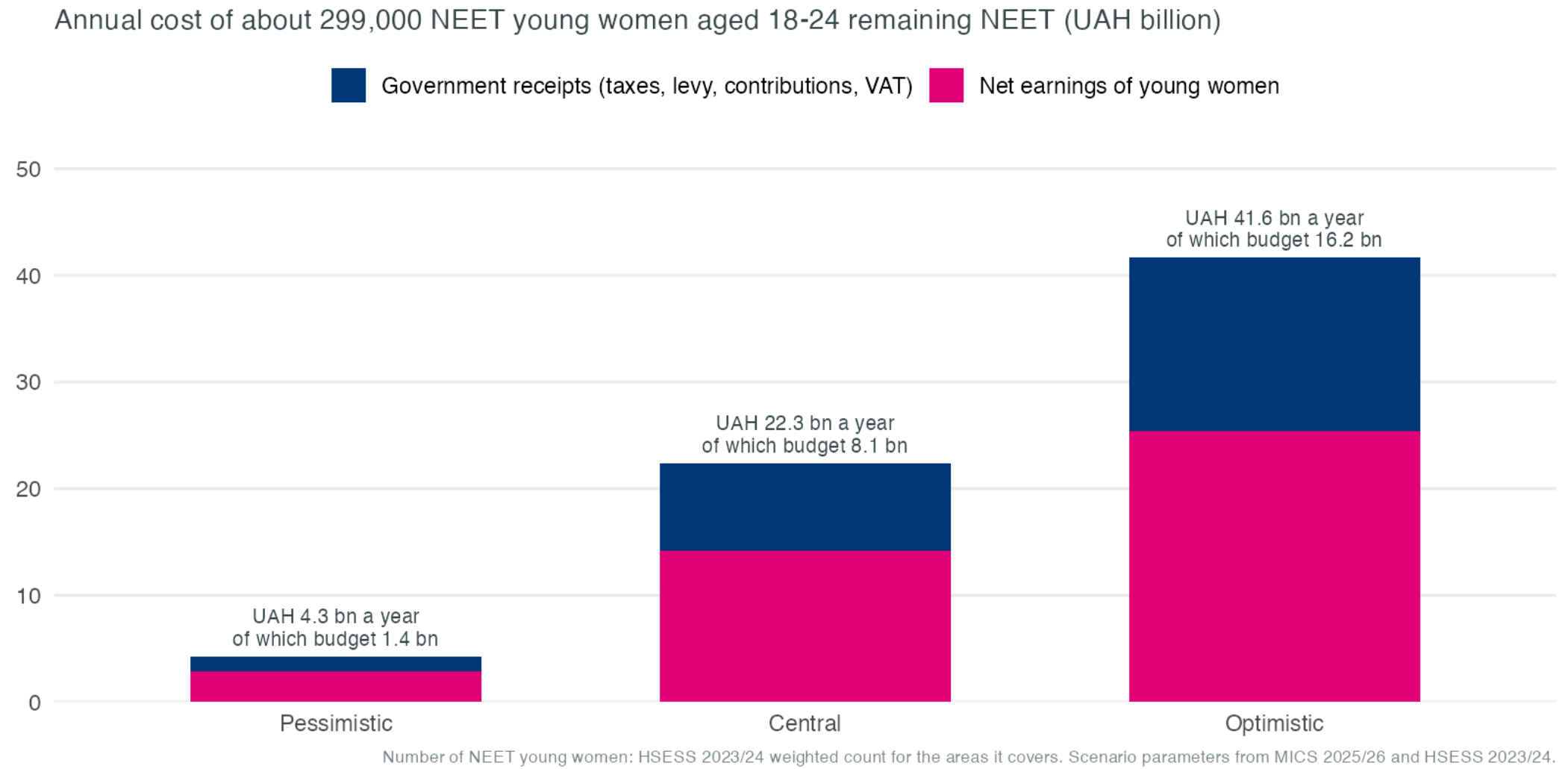
4 · The cost of inaction

How the cost of inaction is calculated

Step	What is used	Source
1. Who	NEET women aged 18–24: 30.8% of young women, about 299,000 in the areas covered by the survey	MICS 2025/26; HSESS 2023/24 weights
2. What they could earn	Wage predicted for each NEET young woman from her education, age and place of residence, using a wage equation estimated on employed women: UAH 9,078 a month on average	HSESS 2023/24
3. How many could work	Pessimistic: neet young women already looking for work (11%). Central: closing the neet gap with young men (44%). Optimistic: looking for work, or out of work because of care duties (71%)	HSESS 2023/24
4. How many jobs are formal	62% to 86%: formal share among employed young women, by level of education	HSESS 2023/24
5. Who gains	Young women (net earnings) and the budget (income tax, military levy, employer social contribution, VAT)	Statutory rates

The cost of inaction is what is forgone each year that these young women remain NEET. Results are shown for the country and per 1,000 NEET young women (about 3,250 women aged 18–24). Full assumptions and the wage equation are at the start of the appendix.

Young women remaining NEET cost about UAH 22 billion a year



Central scenario, of which UAH 8.1 billion would reach the budget; UAH 4 to 42 billion across scenarios. About 299,000 women aged 18–24 are NEET in the areas covered by HSESS 2023/24 (weighted count, out of about 1,085,000 women of that age). The figure excludes areas the survey could not cover and should be updated with an official 2026 population estimate when available.

How to read the cost of inaction

Is there demand for these workers?

- Employers report record shortages: 69% of industrial firms cited a lack of workers in May 2026 (IER monthly enterprise survey), and 78% of employers reported a shortage in 2026 (OLX Robota and European Business Association).
- Firms are raising wages to recruit and keep staff, and some are hiring women into occupations traditionally held by men.
- But demand is uneven: only 32% of businesses surveyed by the State Employment Service planned to hire in 2026, and unemployment is still high (about 15% in early 2026, Info Sapiens).
- So demand exists, but jobs have to be reachable for young mothers: location, hours, childcare and skills matter as much as the number of vacancies.

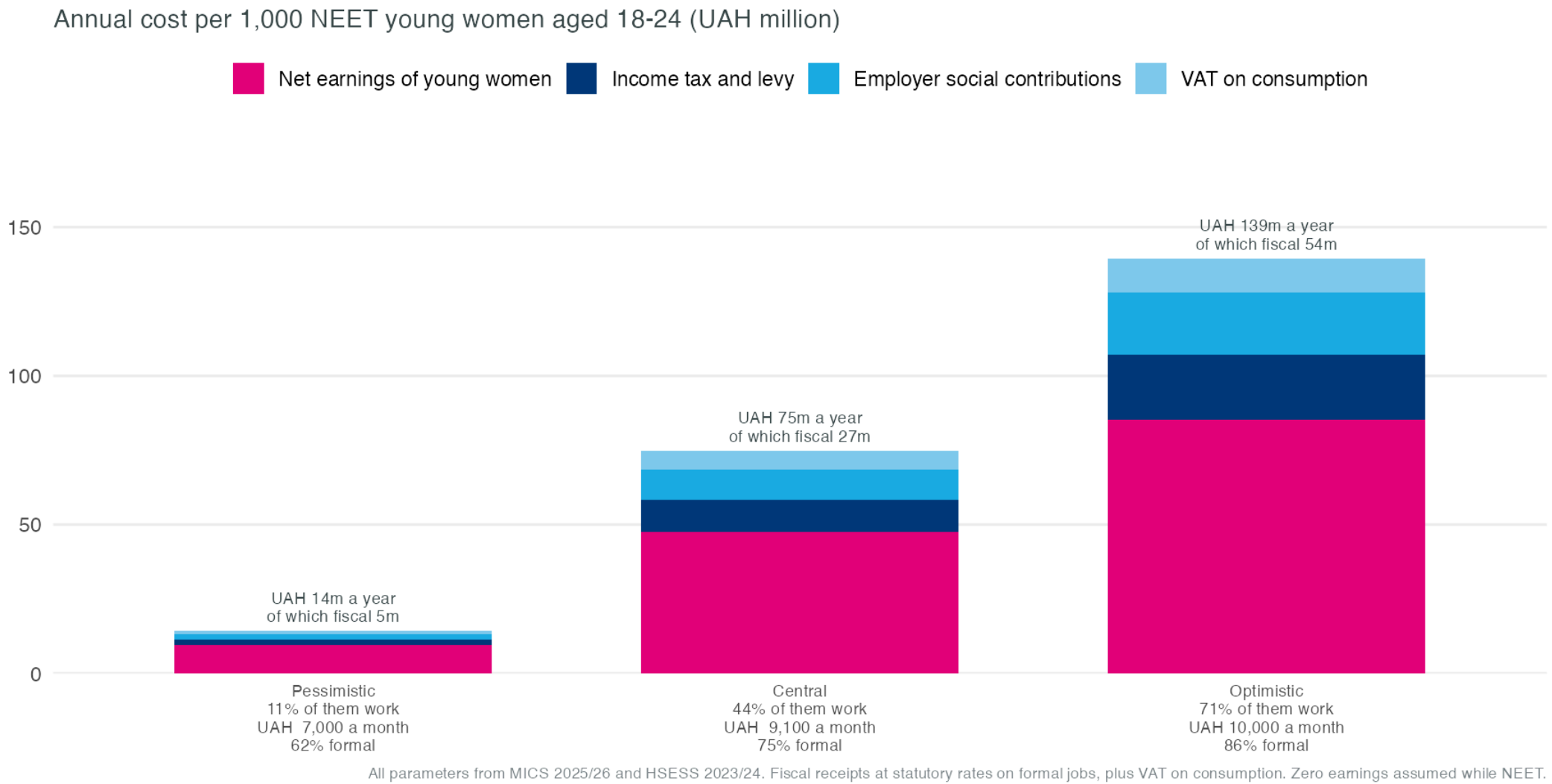
What the estimate does and does not capture

Likely to understate the cost: it counts only earnings and taxes; it leaves out effects on children, on young women's future careers (lost experience), on employers, and the wider economy; the pessimistic case counts only women already looking for work.

Likely to overstate it: it assumes jobs are available at the wage of employed women with the same education, age and location, that new workers do not displace others, and that NEET women would earn as much as employed women with the same profile.

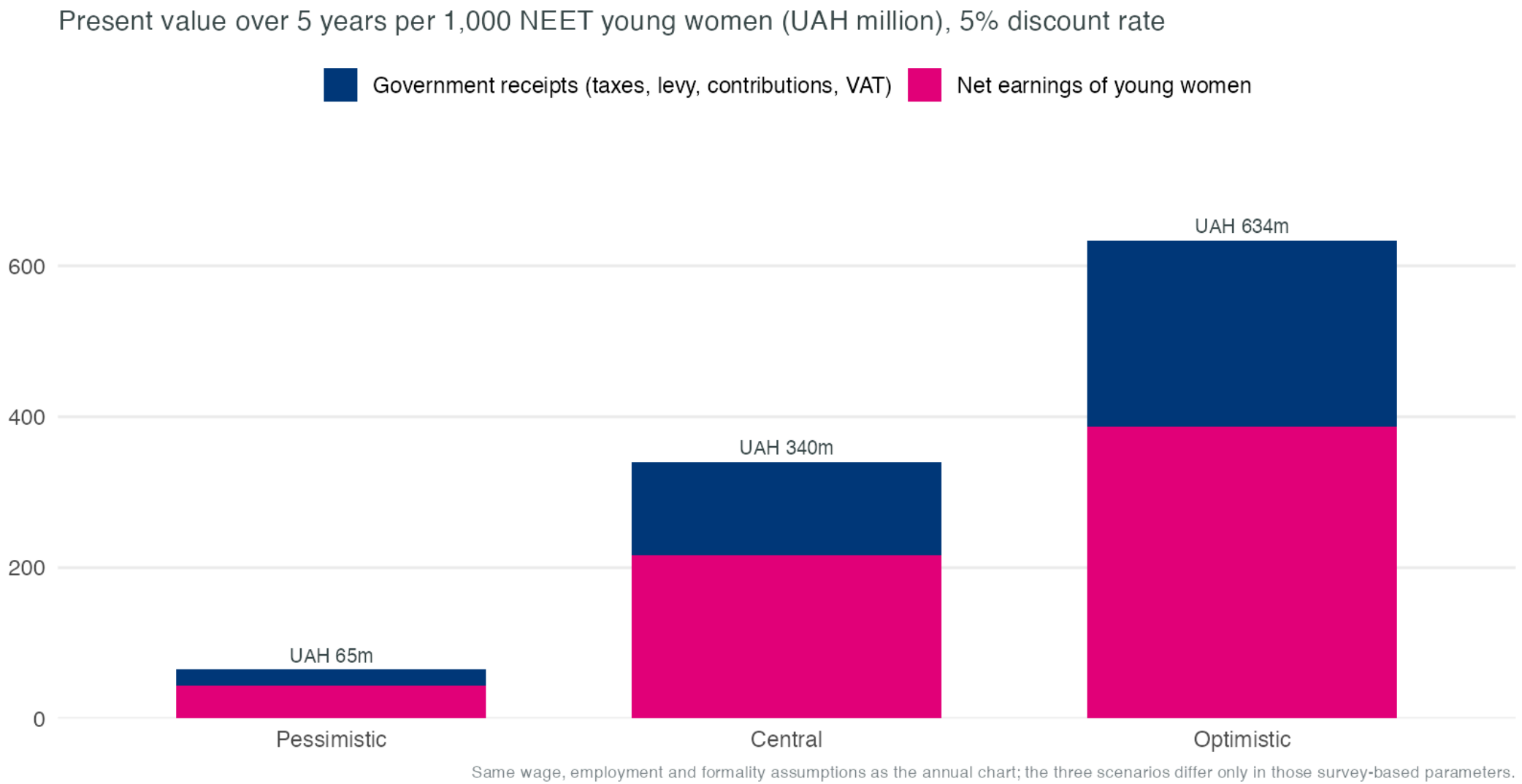
How to use it: as the order of magnitude of what is at stake, with a range rather than a single number, and as the benchmark against which the cost of support services can be judged.

Per 1,000 NEET young women: UAH 75 million a year



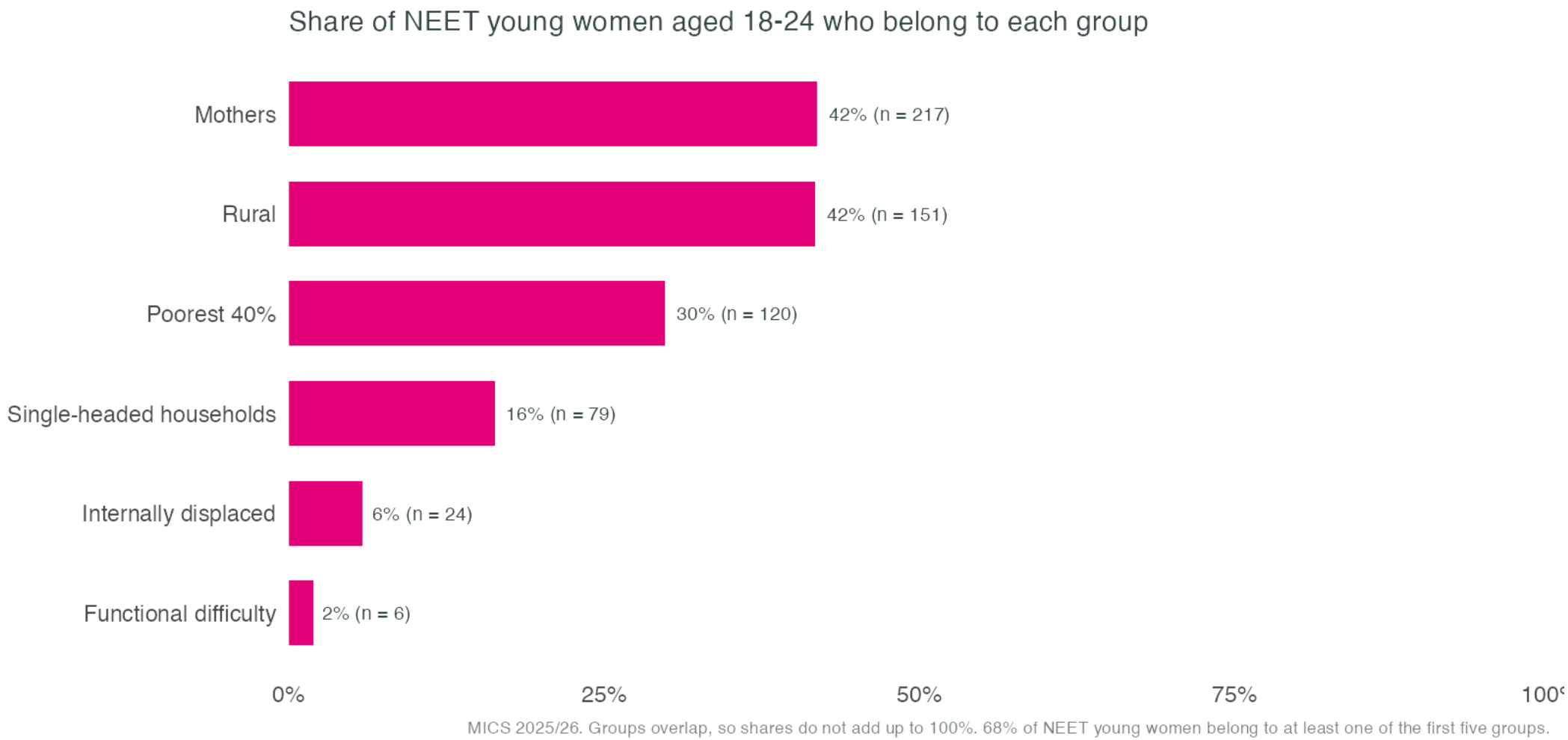
1,000 NEET young women correspond to about 3,250 women aged 18–24. Central scenario, of which UAH 27 million would reach the budget. The pessimistic, central and optimistic scenarios (UAH 14, 75 and 139 million) combine the lowest, middle and highest values found in the surveys for the wage, the share who would work and the share of formal jobs; the labels under each bar show the values used. Per 100,000 women aged 18–24, the central cost is UAH 2.3 billion a year.

Over five years, UAH 65 to 634 million per 1,000



Present value of five years at a 5% discount rate (UAH 340 million in the central scenario); the horizon and discount rate are the same in all three scenarios, which differ only in the survey-based parameters. A woman who remains NEET to age 60 forgoes about UAH 2.0 million in earnings and the budget UAH 1.1 million (present values, central wage).

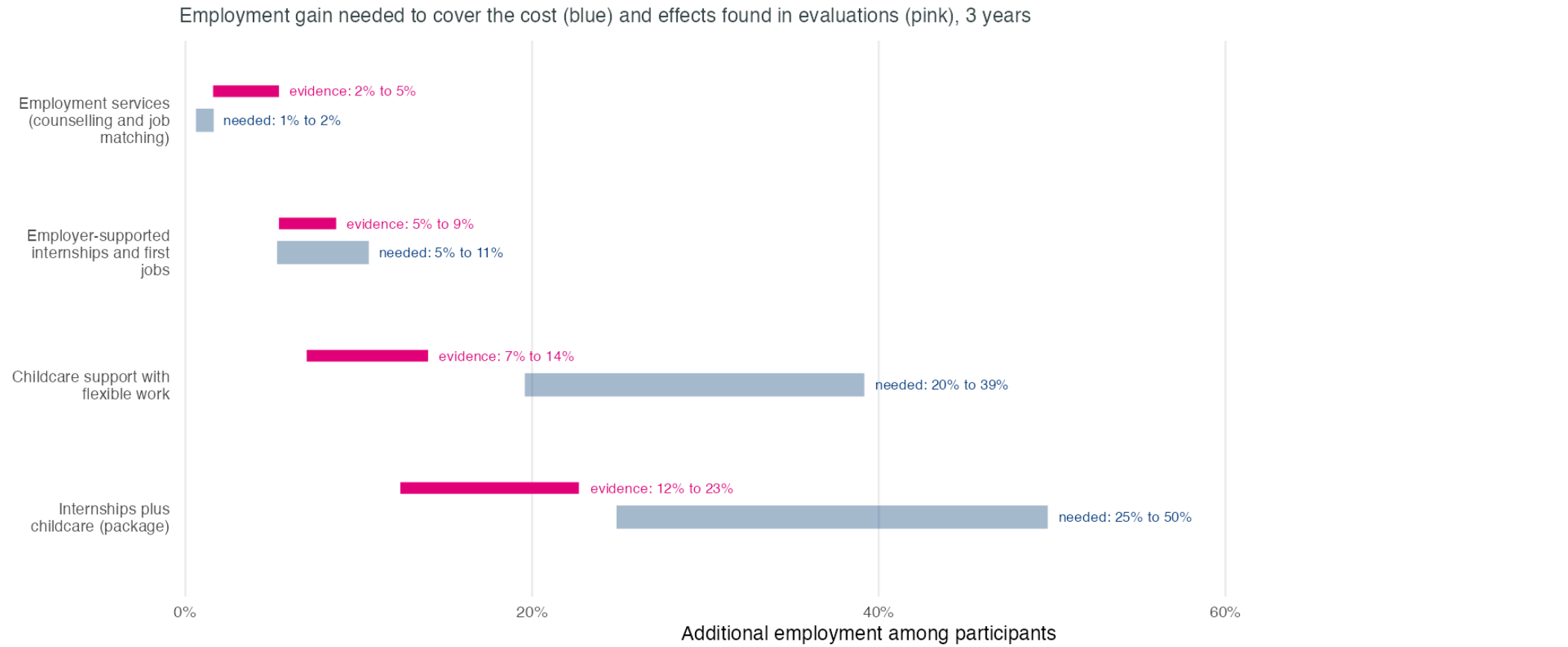
Mothers are 42% of NEET young women



MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. This describes who the NEET young women are: the share of them in each group. Groups overlap, and 68% belong to at least one of the first five, so not every NEET young woman has one of these characteristics. Mothers are the largest identifiable group, so support that works for young mothers addresses the largest part of the cost.

5 · Investment options

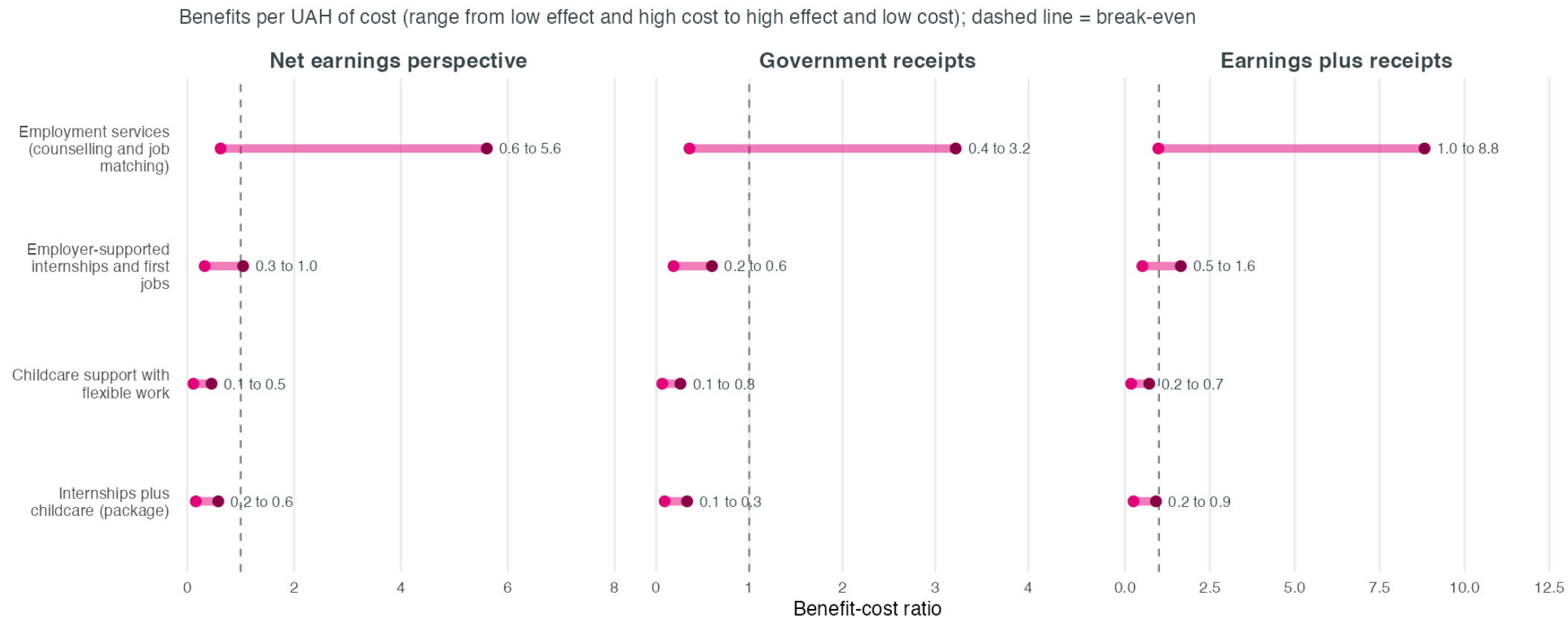
What employment gain would justify each service?



ernment receipts, central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount. Costs from Ukrainian programme amounts; effects from evaluations in other countries (sources in the appendix). Pink to the right of blue: pays off; overlap: depends on cost.

Blue: share of participants who must gain additional employment for three years to cover the cost. Costs use existing Ukrainian amounts: 3 to 6 months of the minimum wage (UAH 8,647) for first-job support and 12 to 24 months of the eYasla payment (UAH 8,000 a month) for childcare; the cost of employment services is an assumption. Pink: employment effects from evaluations in other countries (Card, Kluve and Weber 2018 for employment programmes; Berlinski and Galiani 2007 and Clark et al. 2019 for childcare). None of these evaluations comes from a country in conflict, so the pink ranges are indicative for Ukraine; sources and caveats are in the appendix.

Illustrative returns by type of service



inian programme amounts where available (see appendix). Effects: evaluations in other countries. Benefits: additional employment sustained for 3 years at the central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount. Employer returns not included.

Benefits per UAH of cost, from the least to the most favourable combination of cost and effect, for young women's earnings, government receipts and both. Same costs and evidence as the previous slide. Employment services need the smallest employment gains to pay for themselves and first-job support gains close to those found in evaluations; childcare support at the level of the eYasla payment needs larger or longer-lasting gains to pay for itself through earnings and receipts alone. Benefits to children and employers are not counted.

6 · Conclusions and recommendations

Key messages

1. The problem is large. 31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET (MICS 2025/26); in HSESS, 28% of women against 16% of men.

2. The gap is about education, not employment. Young women and men work at the same rate (34% and 33%); fewer women stay in education (38% against 51%).

3. Motherhood is the main factor. NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22% among other young women, and the difference remains after adjusting for other characteristics.

4. Poverty compounds it. Among poor young mothers NEET reaches 74% to 83%; displacement is not associated with higher NEET.

5. Inaction is costly. Young women remaining NEET cost about UAH 22 billion a year (range UAH 4 to 42 billion), of which UAH 8.1 billion would reach the budget.

6. Services differ widely in cost. Employment services need small employment gains to pay for themselves; first-job support needs gains close to those found in evaluations; childcare support needs the largest.

Priority 1: Learning-to-Earning (First Experience, Earning Engine)

Finding	Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms	Who	What the model indicates
At 18–24, young women and men are employed at the same rate; the NEET gap (28% against 16%) mirrors lower education participation (38% against 51%)	Support young women to stay in education and training, and bridge the exit with first work experience (internships, apprenticeships, first-job support) through the State Employment Service and employers	Ministry of Economy; State Employment Service; employers; education and VET institutions; UNICEF (GenU)	The employment gain first-job support needs to cover its cost is of the same order as the effects found in evaluations; shorter subsidies pay off more easily
NEET is lower with tertiary education (30% against 48% vocational and 44% secondary, women 18–29); the vocational gap against secondary disappears once motherhood and area are accounted for	Do not treat vocational education as the cause: focus on the transition after it, especially for young mothers and rural women, and on guidance towards fields with employer demand	Ministry of Education and Science; VET institutions; State Employment Service; employers	Needs vacancy, pay and entry-requirement data by occupation (SES dashboard, SSSU)
Women earn less than men at every level of education (median wage gap at 18–24: 29%), although informal work is less common among women (25% against 36%)	Pair first-job pathways with formal contracts and decent-work standards; monitor the pay gap by occupation	Employers; State Labour Service; State Employment Service	Each formal job adds about UAH 62,505 a year to the budget

Priority 2: Inclusive Access and Navigation (protection and employment)

Finding	Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms	Who	What the model indicates
Motherhood is the main factor: NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22%, and mothers are 42% of NEET young women	Build on eYasla (UAH 8,000 a month for parents who return to full-time work): combine it with flexible working arrangements and family-friendly workplace policies, and give young mothers priority in employment services	Ministry of Social Policy, Family and National Unity; local authorities; employers; UNICEF	Childcare support is the most expensive option: it pays for itself through earnings and receipts only if a large share of supported mothers would not have worked otherwise, or if their employment lasts longer than three years
Poverty compounds it: NEET is 48% in the poorest fifth against 29%, and 74% to 83% among poor young mothers; it is also higher in single-headed households (39% against 27% in HSESS)	Link social assistance for low-income and single-headed households with employment services (referrals, case management), so that benefits and job support reach the same young women	Ministry of Social Policy; State Employment Service; hromadas	Existing benefit registries can identify most poor young mothers
Displacement is not associated with higher NEET (24% against 31%); disability groups are too small to estimate	Keep inclusive outreach through existing services for displaced young women and young women with disabilities, without a separate programme stream	Hromadas; IDP councils; UNICEF and partners	Not estimated; track outcomes as programmes report

Appendix

Cost of inaction: key assumptions

Element	Assumption	Source
Population	NEET women aged 18–24: 30.8% (MICS). National total: weighted count of NEET women aged 18–24 in HSESS (about 299,000). Per 1,000 NEET young women = about 3,250 women aged 18–24	MICS 2025/26; HSESS 2023/24 weights; override with an official 2026 estimate in COI$pop_w1824
Potential earnings	Central: wage predicted for each NEET young woman by the wage equation on the next slide (UAH 9,078 a month on average, n = 161). Bounds: 25th percentile and median wage of employed women aged 18–24 (n = 180)	HSESS 2023/24; nominal UAH, Dec 2023 to Feb 2024 prices; no wage growth
Counterfactual	Zero earnings while NEET	Assumption
Share who could work	Already looking for work: 11%. Closing the gap with young men (27.5% against 15.5%): 44%. Looking for work or out of work because of care duties: 71%	HSESS 2023/24
Formal jobs	Formal share among employed women aged 18–24: 62% without tertiary education, 75% overall, 86% with tertiary education	HSESS 2023/24
Government receipts	18% income tax and 5% military levy on the gross wage; 22% employer social contribution; 20% VAT on 80% of net earnings (consumption share assumed)	Statutory rates
Time	Annual cost; present value over 5 years at a 5% social discount rate; lifetime to age 60	Same discount rate as A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024)
Labour demand	Jobs assumed available at the wage of employed women with the same profile; no displacement of other workers	Assumption; employer surveys report shortages (see main deck)
Not included	Employer returns; women's work-related expenses; effects on children and other household members; wider economic effects	

Cost of inaction: the three scenarios

Scenario	Monthly wage (UAH)	Wage basis	Share who work	Basis	Formal jobs	Formality basis
Pessimistic	7000	25th percentile wage of employed women 18-24	11%	NEET young women already looking for work	62%	Employed women 18-24 without tertiary education
Central	9078	Wage predicted for NEET young women (Mincer equation)	44%	Closing the NEET gap with young men	75%	All employed women 18-24
Optimistic	10000	Median wage of employed women 18-24	71%	Looking for work, or out of work because of care duties	86%	Employed women 18-24 with tertiary education

For each parameter, the lowest survey-based value goes to the pessimistic scenario and the highest to the optimistic one. The horizon (5 years) and the discount rate (5%) are the same in all scenarios.

Wage equation behind the cost of inaction

STEP 1 · ESTIMATION ON EMPLOYED WOMEN

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \Sigma_k \beta_k \, \mathrm{Educ}_{ik} + \gamma_1 \, \mathrm{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \, \mathrm{Age}_i^2 + \delta \, \mathrm{Rural}_i + \mu_{\mathrm{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

w_i: monthly net wage of employed woman i · Educ_{ik}: highest level completed (reference: basic secondary or less) · μ: oblast effects

STEP 2 · PREDICTION FOR EACH NEET YOUNG WOMAN

$$\hat{w}_j = \exp(\, x_j' \, \hat{\beta} \,) \times S, \qquad S = \Sigma_i \, \omega_i \exp(\, \hat{\varepsilon}_i \,) \, / \, \Sigma_i \, \omega_i$$

x_j: her own education level, age, area and oblast · S: smearing factor that converts predicted log wages back to UAH · ω_i: survey weights

Sample
Employed women aged 18–64 with a reported wage, HSESS 2023/24: n = 3,112, R^2 = 0.32. Predictions for 161 NEET women aged 18–24.

Estimation
Weighted least squares with survey weights. Coefficients in the next appendix slide.

Limits
No adjustment for hours, occupation or sector, and no correction for selection into work: NEET women may earn less than employed women with the same profile.

Wage equations behind the education and gender results

RETURNS TO A YEAR OF EDUCATION · ESTIMATED SEPARATELY FOR WOMEN AND MEN

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \rho S_i + \gamma_1 \text{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \text{Age}_i^2 + \mu_{\text{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

S_i: years of education implied by the highest level completed (9, 11, 12, 13, 15 or 17) · Return per year = exp(ρ) − 1: 5.8% for women, 7.2% for men · Wage earners aged 18–64 · Standard errors clustered by household

WAGES BY EDUCATION LEVEL AND SEX · WOMEN AND MEN POOLED

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \Sigma_k \beta_k \text{Educ}_{ik} + \lambda \text{Woman}_i + \Sigma_k \theta_k (\text{Educ}_{ik} \times \text{Woman}_i) + \gamma_1 \text{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \text{Age}_i^2 + \delta \text{Rural}_i + \mu_{\text{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

Adjusted gap at education level k = 1 − exp(λ + θ_k), shown at age 30 in an urban area · Wage earners aged 18–64 · Neither equation adjusts for hours, occupation or sector, or for selection into work

Wage equation for the cost of inaction: coefficients

Term	Coefficient	SE	p
Constant	8.456	0.110	<0.001
Education: Complete secondary	-0.010	0.044	0.817
Education: Vocational	0.087	0.039	0.027
Education: Short-cycle tertiary	0.181	0.046	<0.001
Education: Higher (bachelor+)	0.323	0.038	<0.001
Age	0.029	0.005	<0.001
Age squared	0.000	0.000	<0.001
Rural	-0.212	0.019	<0.001

Dependent variable: log of monthly net wage, employed women aged 18–64, HSESS 2023/24. Reference education level: basic secondary or less. Oblast effects not shown.

Investment options: sources for costs and employment effects

Intervention	Cost per participant (UAH)	Cost basis	Employment effect	Evidence
Employment services (counselling and job matching)	3,000 to 8,000	Assumption (no public unit cost found): UAH 3,000 to 8,000 per client; to be replaced with State Employment Service cost per client	1.6 to 5.4 pp	Card, Kluve and Weber (2018), meta-analysis of 207 evaluations: +1.6 pp employment within a year, +5.4 pp after one to two years
Employer-supported internships and first jobs	25,941 to 51,882	3 to 6 months of the 2026 minimum wage (UAH 8,647), the amount the State Employment Service already uses to compensate employers	5.4 to 8.7 pp	Card, Kluve and Weber (2018): +5.4 pp after one to two years, +8.7 pp after more than two years
Childcare support with flexible work	96,000 to 192,000	12 to 24 months of the eYasla payment (UAH 8,000 a month since January 2026 for parents returning to full-time work)	7.0 to 14.0 pp	Berlinski and Galiani (2007), Argentina: +7 to 14 pp maternal employment; Clark et al. (2019), Kenya: +8.5 pp; Halim, Perova and Reynolds (2023): 21 of 22 studies positive
Internships plus childcare (package)	121,941 to 243,882	Sum of the two components above	12.4 to 22.7 pp	Assumption: effects of the two components add up; no evaluation of the combined package

Card, Kluve and Weber (2018), Journal of the European Economic Association 16(3); Berlinski and Galiani (2007), Labour Economics 14; Clark, Kabiru, Laszlo and Muthuri (2019), Demography 56; Halim, Perova and Reynolds (2023), World Bank Research Observer 38(1). None of these evaluations comes from a country in conflict. In Ukraine, labour shortages could make effects larger, while safety, displacement and childcare closures could make them smaller; Card, Kluve and Weber find larger effects for women and in weak labour markets. The ranges should be replaced with Ukrainian evidence, for example State Employment Service follow-up data, when available.

Evidence on employment effects (1/2): employment programmes

Study	Where and when	Design	What was tested	Effect on employment	Comparability with Ukraine
Card, Kluve and Weber (2018), Journal of the European Economic Association	207 evaluations, 857 estimates, 47 countries; mostly European and other high-income countries	Meta-analysis of impact evaluations (experimental and non-experimental)	Training, job search assistance, subsidised employment, public works	+1.6 pp within a year; +5.4 pp after one to two years; +8.7 pp after two years	Not specific to youth. Medium- and long-run effects are similar in high- and middle-income countries; effects are larger for women and in weak labour markets. Used for the employment services and first-job ranges
Kluve et al. (2019), World Development	113 evaluations of 107 youth programmes in 31 countries	Meta-analysis of youth employment programmes	Training, entrepreneurship, employment services, subsidised employment	Small on average; about one third of estimates positive and significant; employment services and subsidised employment small and often not significant	Specific to youth. Larger effects in low- and middle-income countries, for disadvantaged youth, and for programmes combining several services. Suggests the upper ranges for employment services alone may be optimistic

No published impact evaluation of a State Employment Service programme for young women in Ukraine was found. None of the studies comes from a country in conflict.

Evidence on employment effects (2/2): childcare

Study	Where and when	Design	What was tested	Effect on employment	Comparability with Ukraine
Berlinski and Galiani (2007), Labour Economics	Argentina, national expansion of public preschool places in the 1990s	Natural experiment: timing of new preschool places across areas	Free public preschool for children aged 3 to 5	Maternal employment +7 to +14 pp	Middle-income country with formal labour markets. Places for children aged 3 to 5, while eYasla is a cash payment for children aged 1 to 3
Clark, Kabiru, Laszlo and Muthuri (2019), Demography	Kenya, informal settlement in Nairobi, from 2015	Randomised controlled trial	Vouchers for subsidised early childcare	+8.5 pp for mothers offered vouchers (about +20 pp among those who used the care); gains mostly among married mothers	Closest in mechanism to eYasla (a subsidy that mothers choose how to use), but low-income setting with mostly informal work
Halim, Perova and Reynolds (2023), World Bank Research Observer	22 studies in low- and middle-income countries	Review of studies with credible causal designs	Public childcare, longer care hours, lower childcare costs	Positive in all but one study	Confirms the direction of the effect across very different settings; no single effect size

eYasla started in January 2026 and could be evaluated directly, for example by comparing employment of eligible mothers before and after it started or across eligibility thresholds; that would replace these ranges with Ukrainian evidence.

How this builds on earlier investment cases

	A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024)	This analysis
Focus	Early childhood development: children under six	Young women aged 18–24 who are not in education, employment or training
Question	Returns to scaling up childcare, preschool, health, social protection and WASH services to 2050	Who is excluded, why, what it costs each year, and what employment gain would justify each service
Data	National statistics, mostly from before 2022, and regional assumptions	Microdata collected since 2022: MICS 2025/26 and HSESS 2023/24
Link	Estimates that expanding childcare would allow caregivers, mainly women, to return to work	Measures that link directly: motherhood and childcare are the main reasons young women are out of work

The two are complementary: the earlier case argues for expanding early childhood services; this one identifies the young women who would use them and what their exclusion costs. Both use a 5% social discount rate.

How the intervention parameters are built and updated

Step	What was done	How the country office can update it
1. Intervention types	Four types from the GenU priorities: employment services (counselling and job matching), employer-supported internships and first jobs, childcare services with flexible work, and a combined package for young mothers	Add rows to code/intervention_parameters.csv (one per intervention or package), with a target group
2. Costs	Present value of the total cost per participant over the support period, low and high, from existing Ukrainian programme amounts where available	Replace with State Employment Service, partner and UNICEF unit costs
3. Employment effects	Additional, sustained employment attributable to the intervention, low and high, from published evaluations in other countries (sources on the previous slide)	Replace with Ukrainian evaluations where available (for example SES programme follow-up data)
4. Benefits	Effect multiplied by the annual value of a job (net earnings; income tax, levy, contributions and VAT) over the years sustained, discounted at 5%	Change wage, formality or duration in 04_cost_of_inaction.R to test scenarios
5. Outputs	Benefit-cost ratios by perspective, break-even employment gains, and the comparison with the evidence range	Re-run bash UPDATE_RESULTS.sh; all slides update

Employer returns (productivity, retention, vacancy costs) are not included and would be the next step for the private sector case.

Age groups

Age group	Used for	Why
18–24	Main group: NEET, employment, earnings, cost of inaction	In line with government statistics and UNICEF programming
15–17	NEET and employment among the younger group	MICS asks the NEET questions to women aged 15–24; HSESS asks employment questions from age 15
14–17	School attendance	Available for all household members in both surveys

MICS 2025/26 has no men's questionnaire, so NEET and employment in MICS refer to women; comparisons between women and men use HSESS 2023/24 and, for school attendance, the MICS household roster.

Variables and definitions (1/2)

Concept	Definition	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
In education	Attending school or university in the current school year	ED9 (members 3–24); NE3 (women 15–24)	IND_A9	reason_inactiv = 2 (inactive students)
Employed	Worked at least one hour for pay or profit in the reference week, or temporarily absent; production for own household use only is not counted	NE8–NE11, NE20–NE21 (women 15–24)	IND_B1	labour_force = 1
NEET	Not in education or training and not employed	NEET module (women 15–24)	IND_A9, IND_B1	labour_force, reason_inactiv (upper bound)
Labour-force participation	Employed, or looking for work or starting a business	not available	IND_B1, IND_B21	labour_force 1–2
Informal employment	Verbal agreement, unregistered own-account work, or family farm work for sale	not available	IND_B3_1	informal_empl = 1
Mother	Has given birth (MICS) or lives with own child under 18 (HSESS)	CEB	household roster (IND_A1, ages)	not available

Variables and definitions (2/2)

Concept	Definition	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Care work	Caring for children or the sick in the past week (5–17); daily care of own children	CL11E, CL11F	IND_B28_1	reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy)
Internally displaced	Self-reported IDP status	WB10A	IND_A19	not available
Disability	Washington Group functional difficulty (18–49); any household member with disability	AF module	D1_Mult3/4	not available
Economic status	Wealth quintile; household income per member	windex5	V1 / household size	not available
Years of education	Years implied by the highest level completed (9 basic secondary, 11 complete secondary, 12 vocational, 13 short-cycle, 15 bachelor, 17 master)	welevel	IND_A7	education

Key variables (1/2)

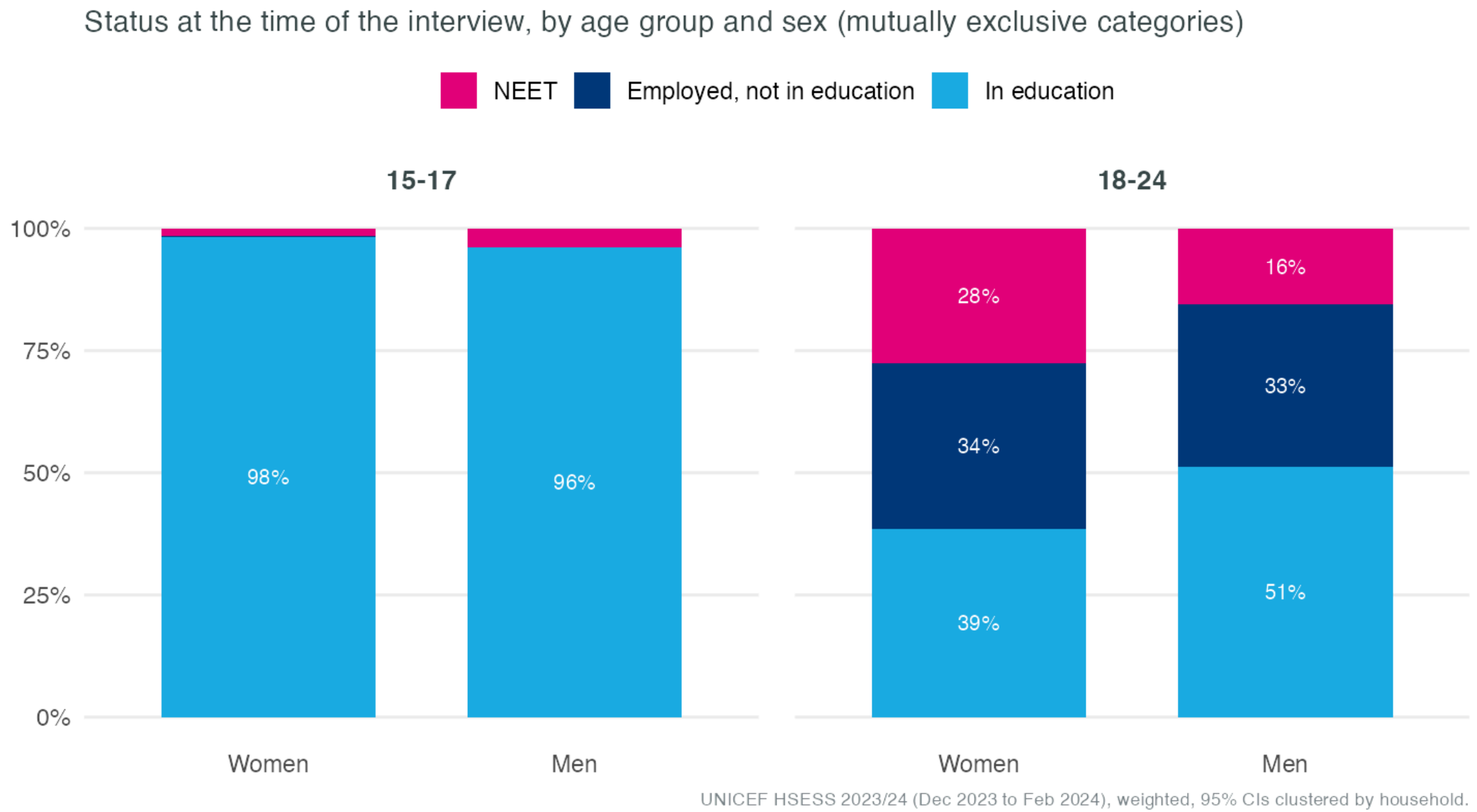
Concept	Use	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Age	Groups 15-17, 18-24; 15-29 for NEET	HL6; WB4 (women)	IND_A2 age in years	age_gr (bands)
Sex	Breakdown by sex	HL4 (household members)	IND_A3	sex
Survey design	Weighted estimates	hhweight, wmweight, fsweight; psu; stratum	Final weight; household key	weight_year; kod_res
Region / area	Regional and urban/rural breakdown	HH7 oblast; macroregion; HH6	OBLAST; SETTL_TYPE	rg; tp_ar
Displacement	Breakdown by displacement	WB10A IDP status; PE3 household moved	IND_A19 IDP status	not available
Disability	Breakdown by disability	disability (functioning, 18-49)	D1_Mult3/4 household member	not available
Marital status	Household formation	MSTATUS	IND_A6	marital_st
Motherhood	Breakdown by motherhood	CEB children ever born; WDOBFC	Own child under 18 (roster)	not available
Care work	Care responsibilities	CL11E/F caring for children or the sick (5-17)	IND_B28_1 daily care of own children	reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy)
Childcare access	Preschool attendance	ED9, ED10A (ages 3-5)	IND_A14 reason not attending	not available
Economic status	Breakdown by income or wealth	windex5 wealth quintile; PE20 income	V1 household income per member	not available

Key variables (2/2)

Concept	Use	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Changes since 2022	Household context	PE3 moved; PE5 dwelling damaged; PE12 members separated	not available	not applicable
Education level	Education-to-work transition	welevel; ED10A level attended	IND_A7	education; special_dipl
In education	School attendance, NEET	ED9 (members 3-24); NE3 (women 15-24)	IND_A9; IND_A10 type	reason_inactiv = 2
Training	NEET	NE6 courses or training (women 15-24)	not available	not available
Employment	Employment, NEET	NE8-NE11, NE20-NE21 (women 15-24)	IND_B1	labour_force
Job search	Unemployment, participation	not available	IND_B21	labour_force = 2
Reason not working	Reasons for inactivity	not available	IND_B24	reason_inactiv
Occupation / sector	Occupational distribution	not available	IND_B6_2; IND_B5_2	occupation
Job quality	Informality, hours	not available	IND_B3_1; IND_B9_1; IND_B10_1	informal_empl; actual_duration
Earnings	Wage differences, costing	not available	IND_V1_1_1 (wages)	not available

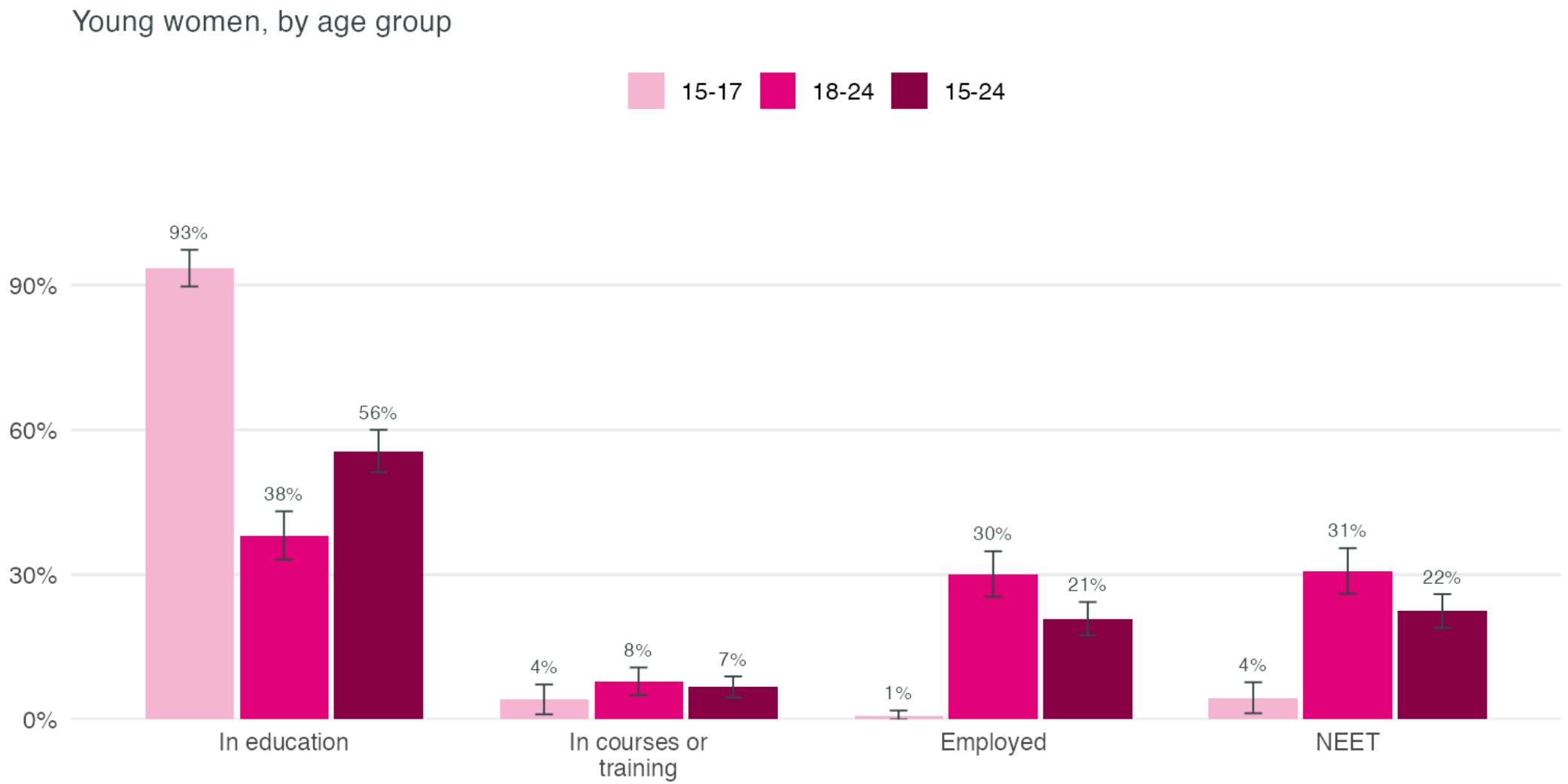
Variable codes as in each questionnaire. Full list of variables in every file: output/inventory/variable_report.xlsx.

Status at 15–17 and 18–24 by sex (HSESS)



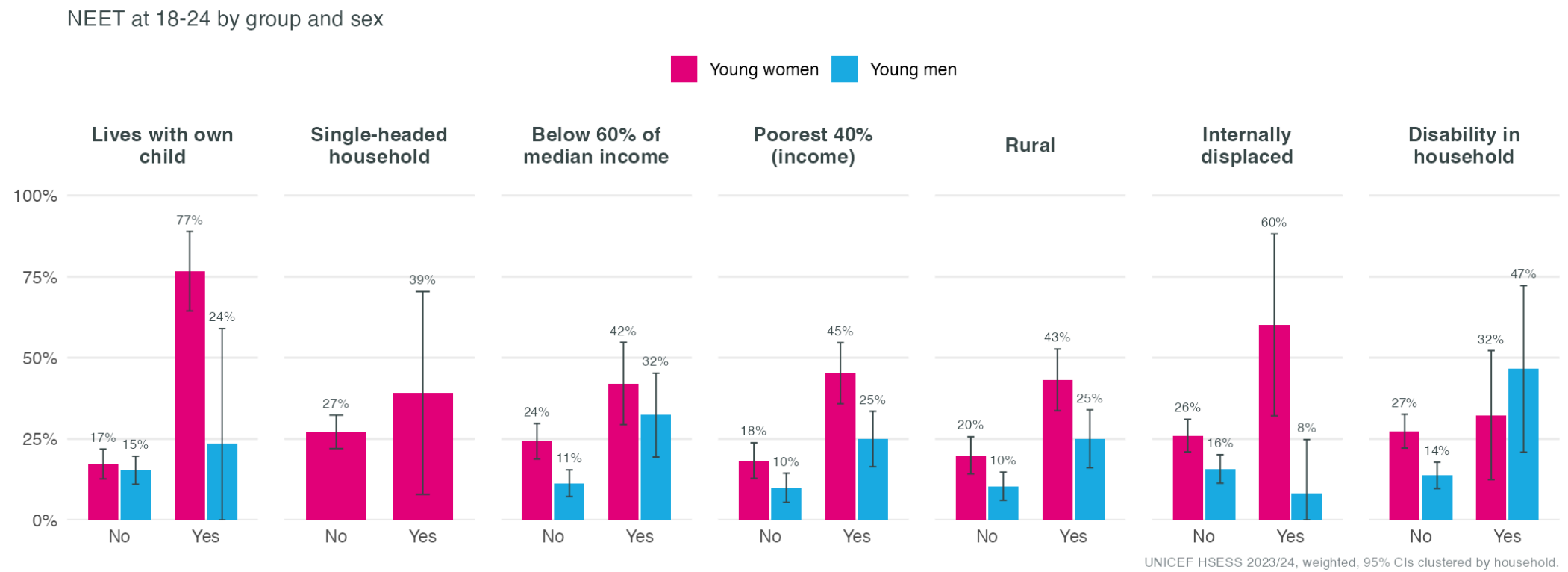
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Young women by age: education, training, employment, NEET (MICS)



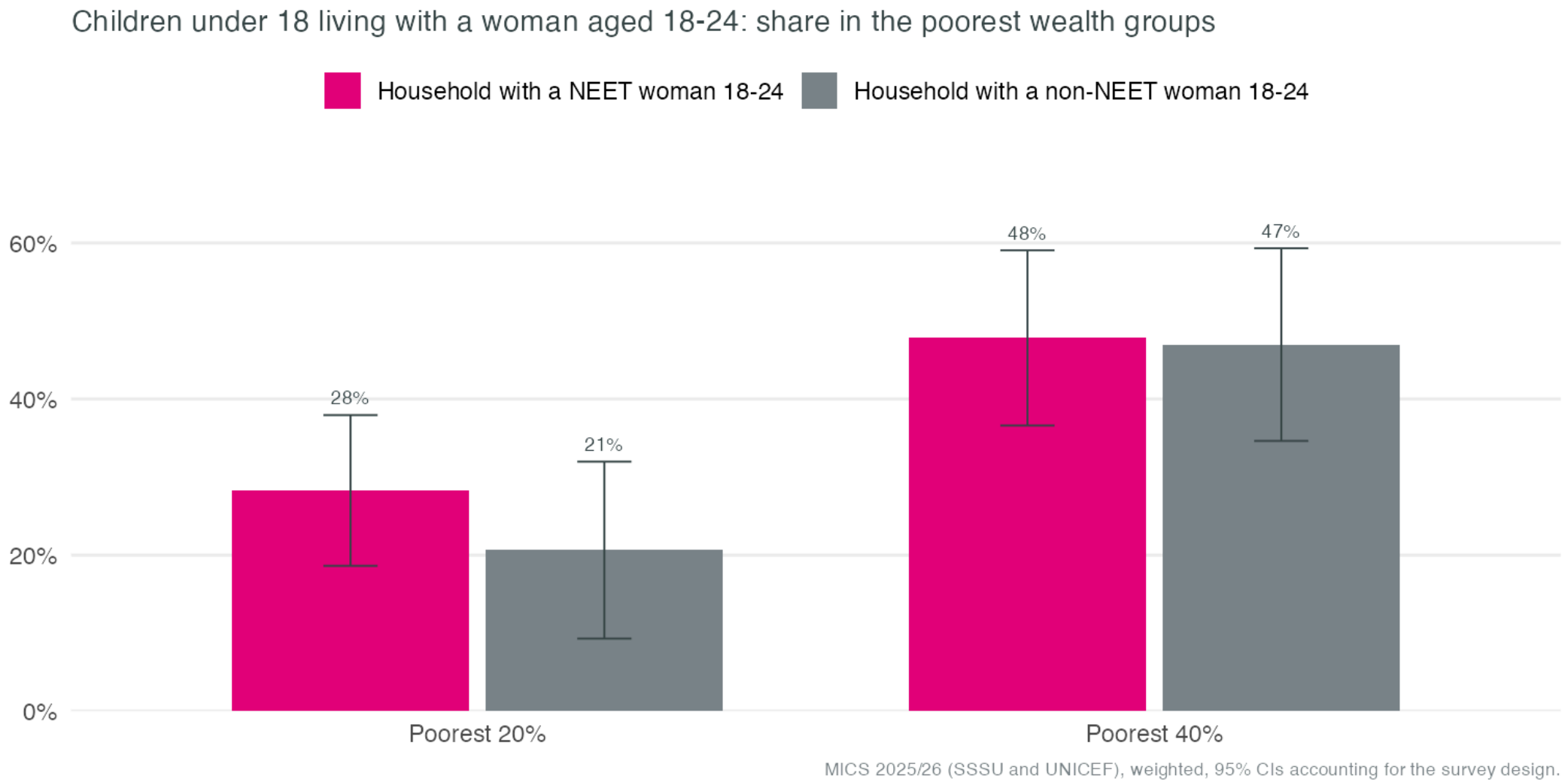
MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

NEET by group, women and men aged 18–24 (HSESS)



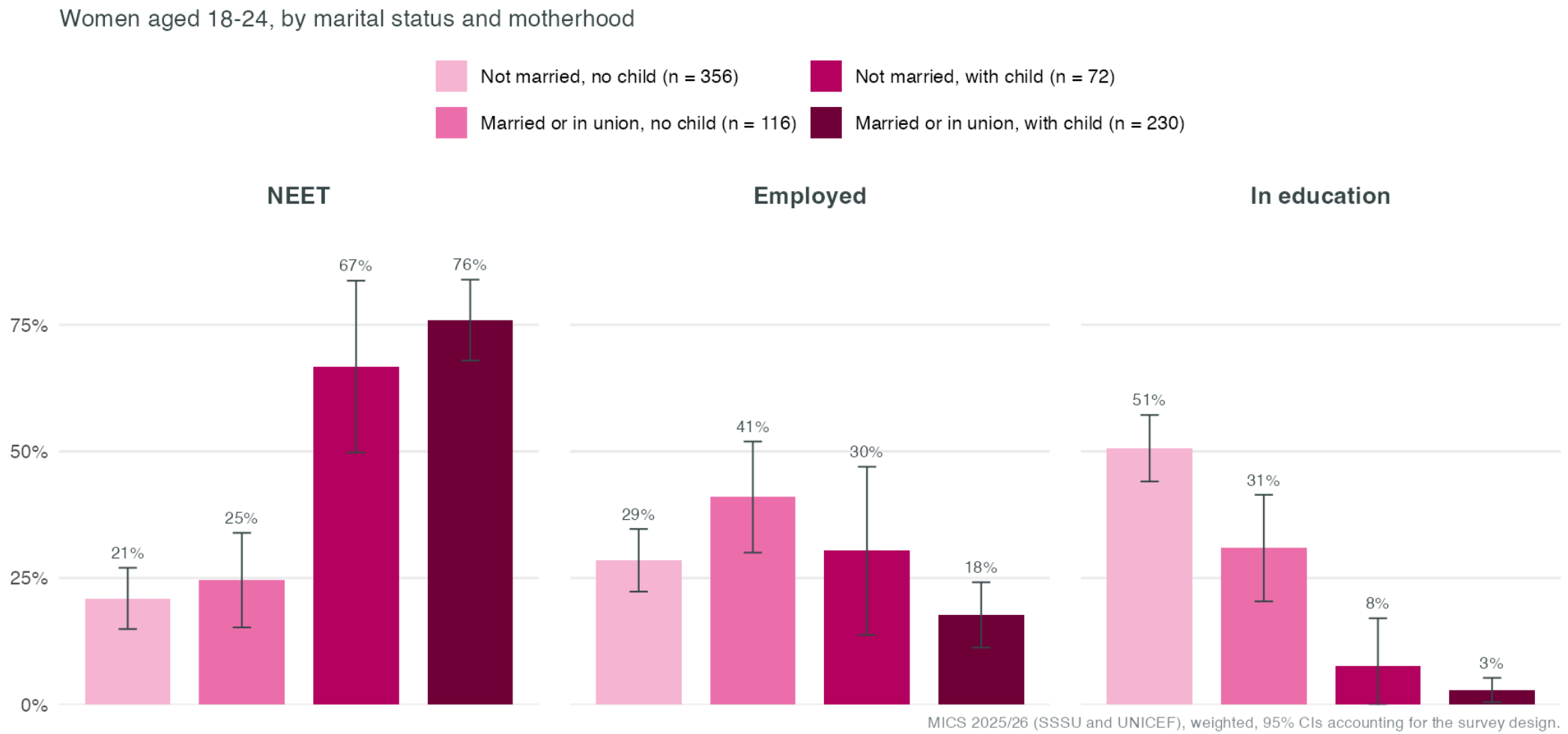
HSESS 2023/24. Below 60% of median income: women 42% against 24%. Single-headed households: 39% against 27%.

Children in poor households, by the young woman’s NEET status (MICS)

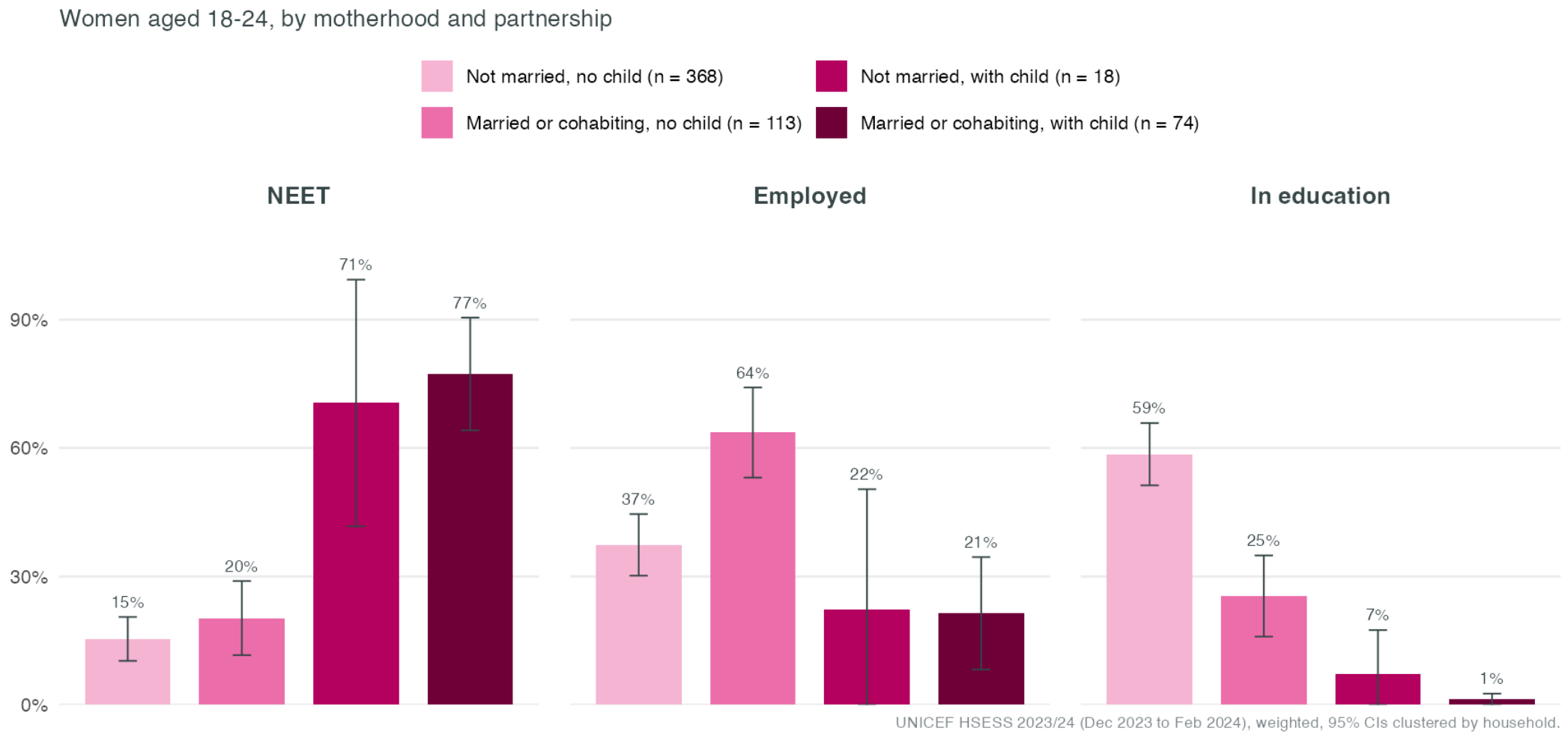


MICS 2025/26, children under 18 living with a woman aged 18–24. In the poorest 40%: 48% where she is NEET and 47% where she is not. The two are similar: children living with young women are more often in poor households regardless of her NEET status.

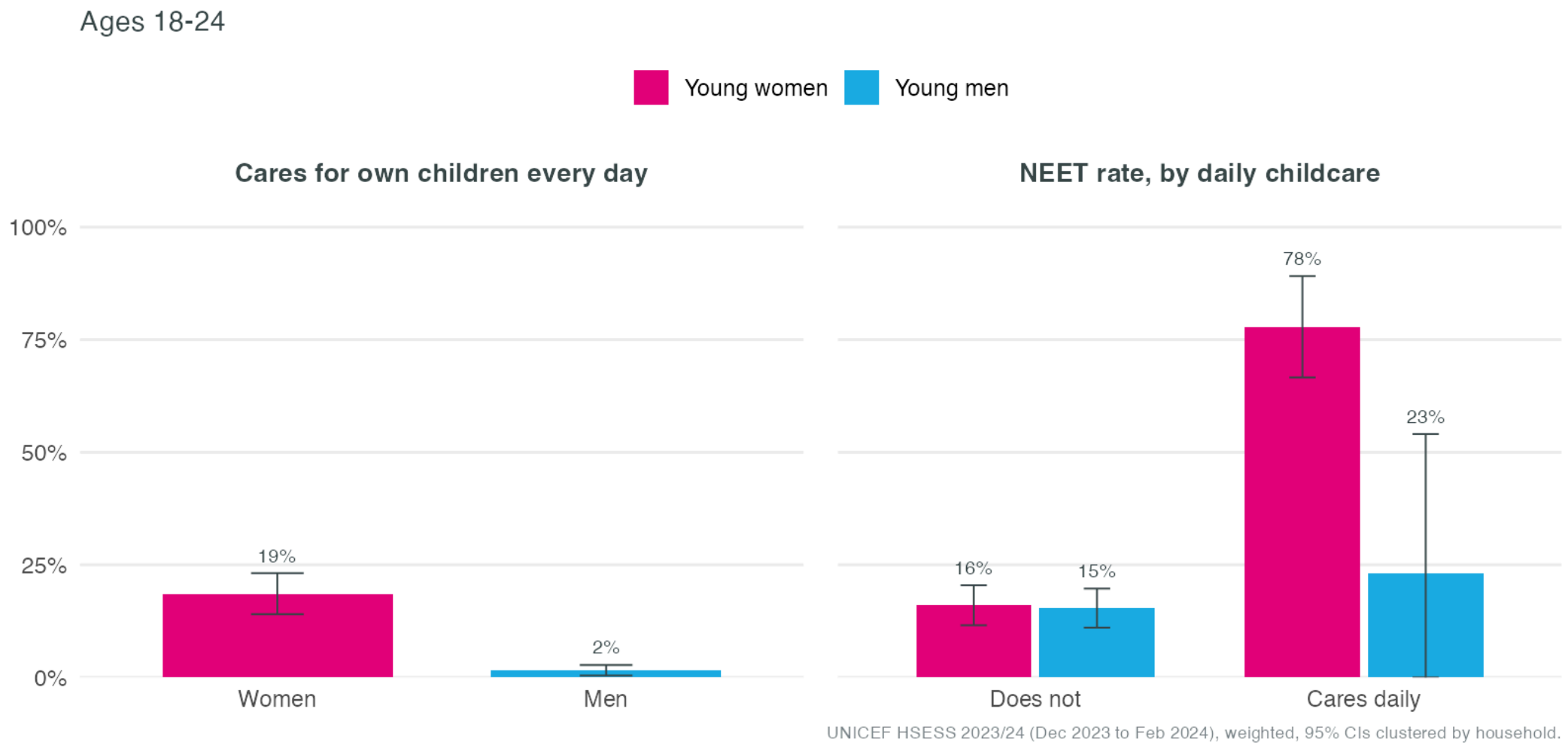
Marital status and motherhood, women 18–24 (MICS)



Motherhood and partnership, women 18–24 (HSESS)

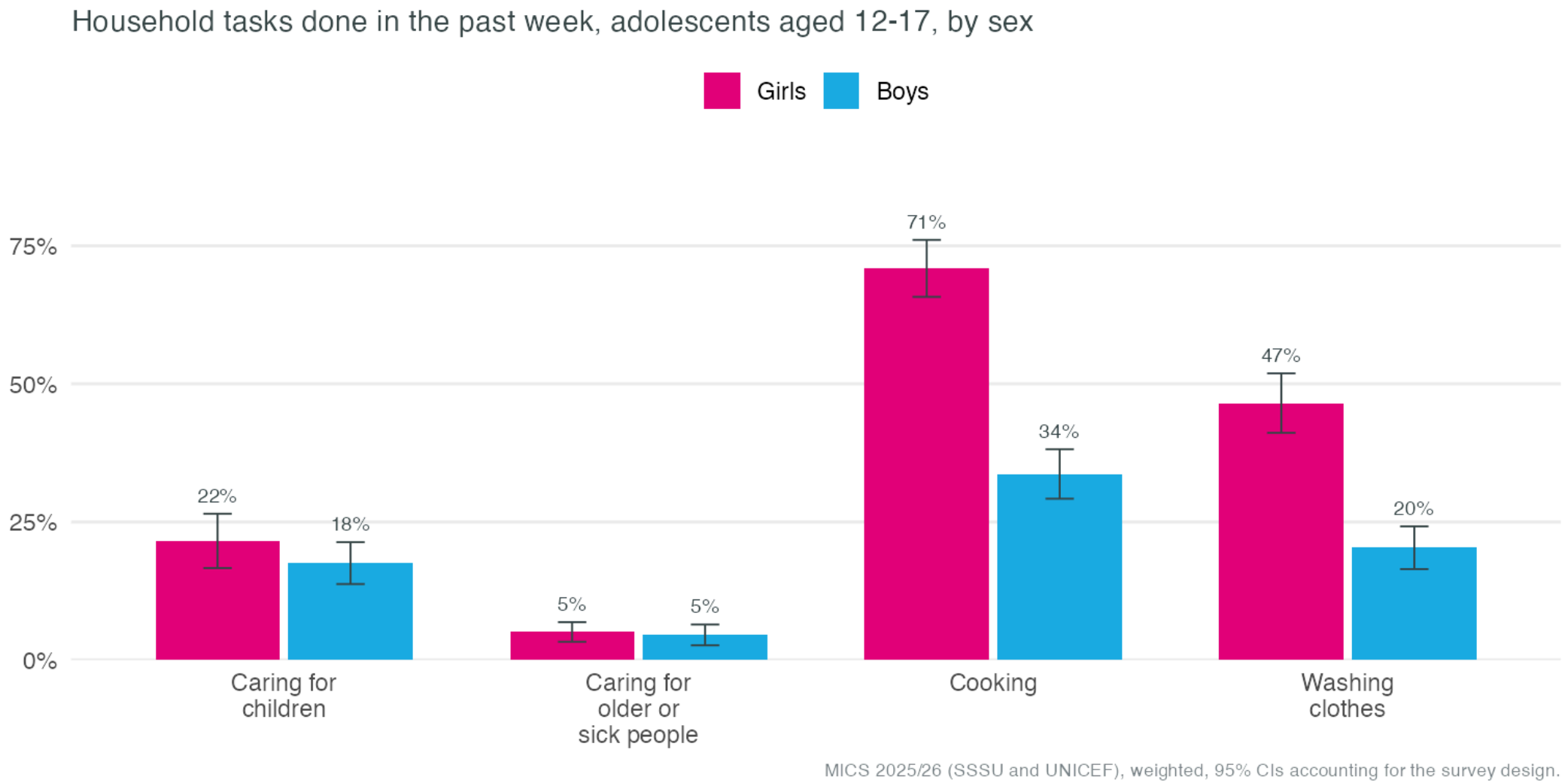


Daily childcare and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



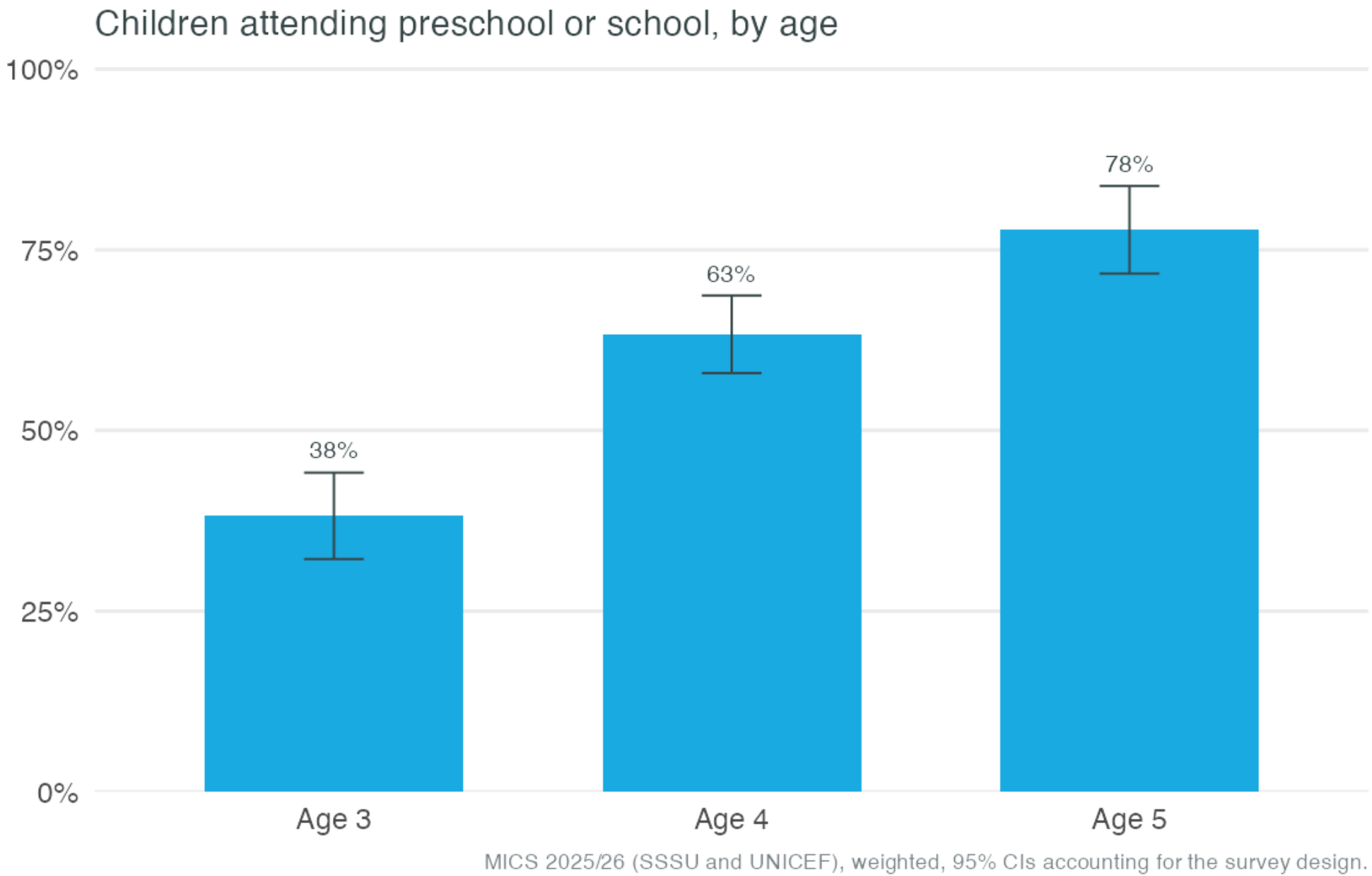
Daily care of own children: women 19%, men 2%. NEET among women who care daily: 78%; among others: 16%.

Care work among adolescents aged 12–17 (MICS)

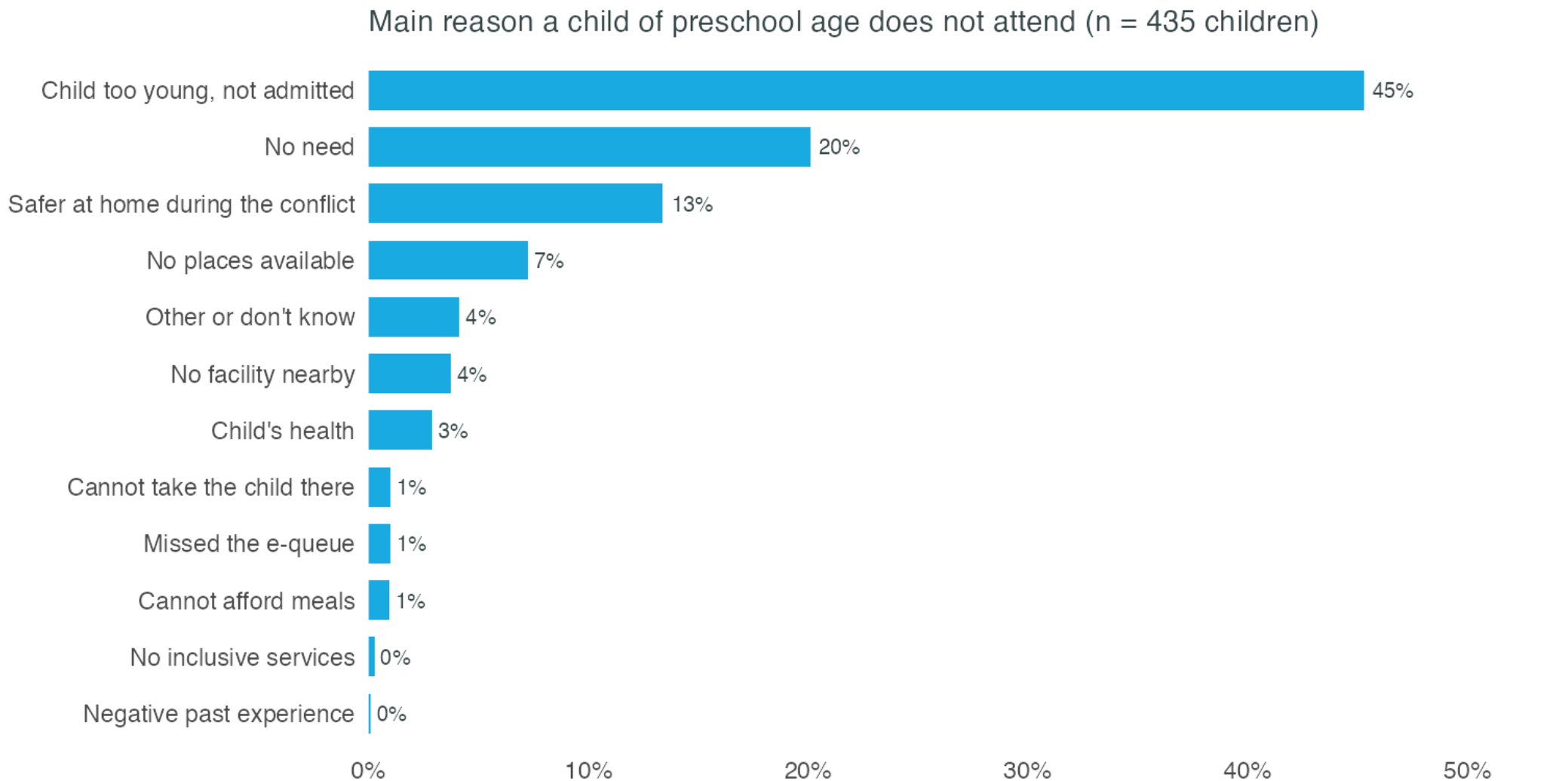


Cared for children in the past week: girls 22%, boys 18%.

Preschool attendance by age (MICS)

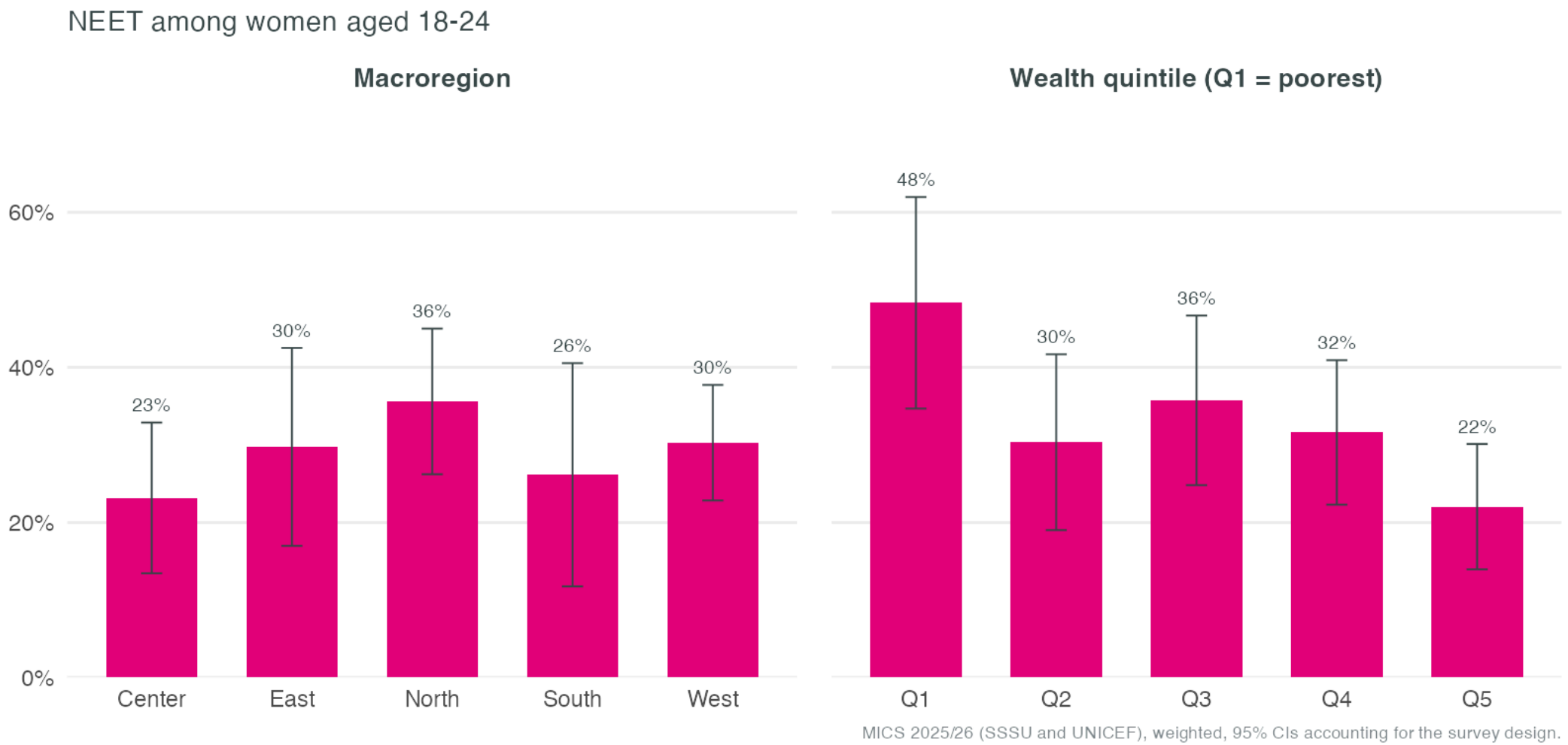


Reasons for not attending preschool, all children (HSESS)



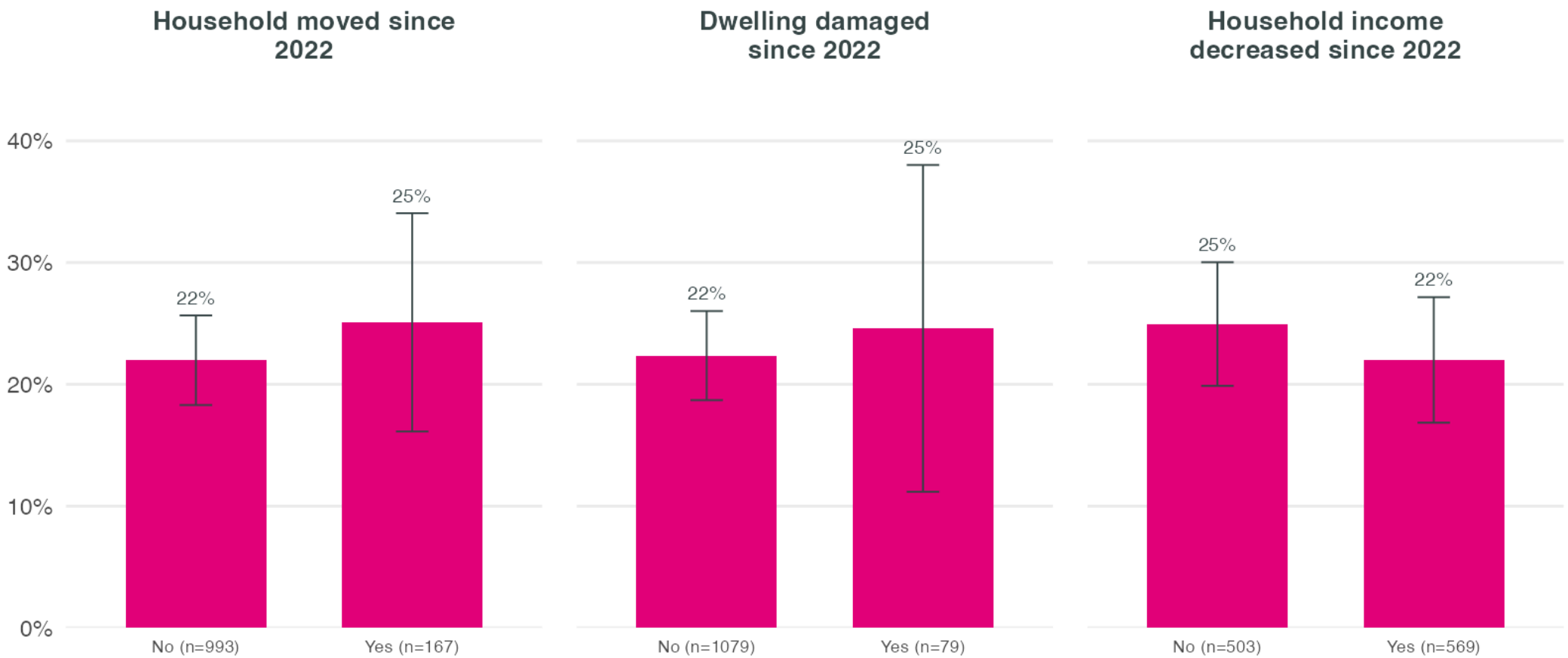
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

NEET by macroregion and wealth, women 18–24 (MICS)



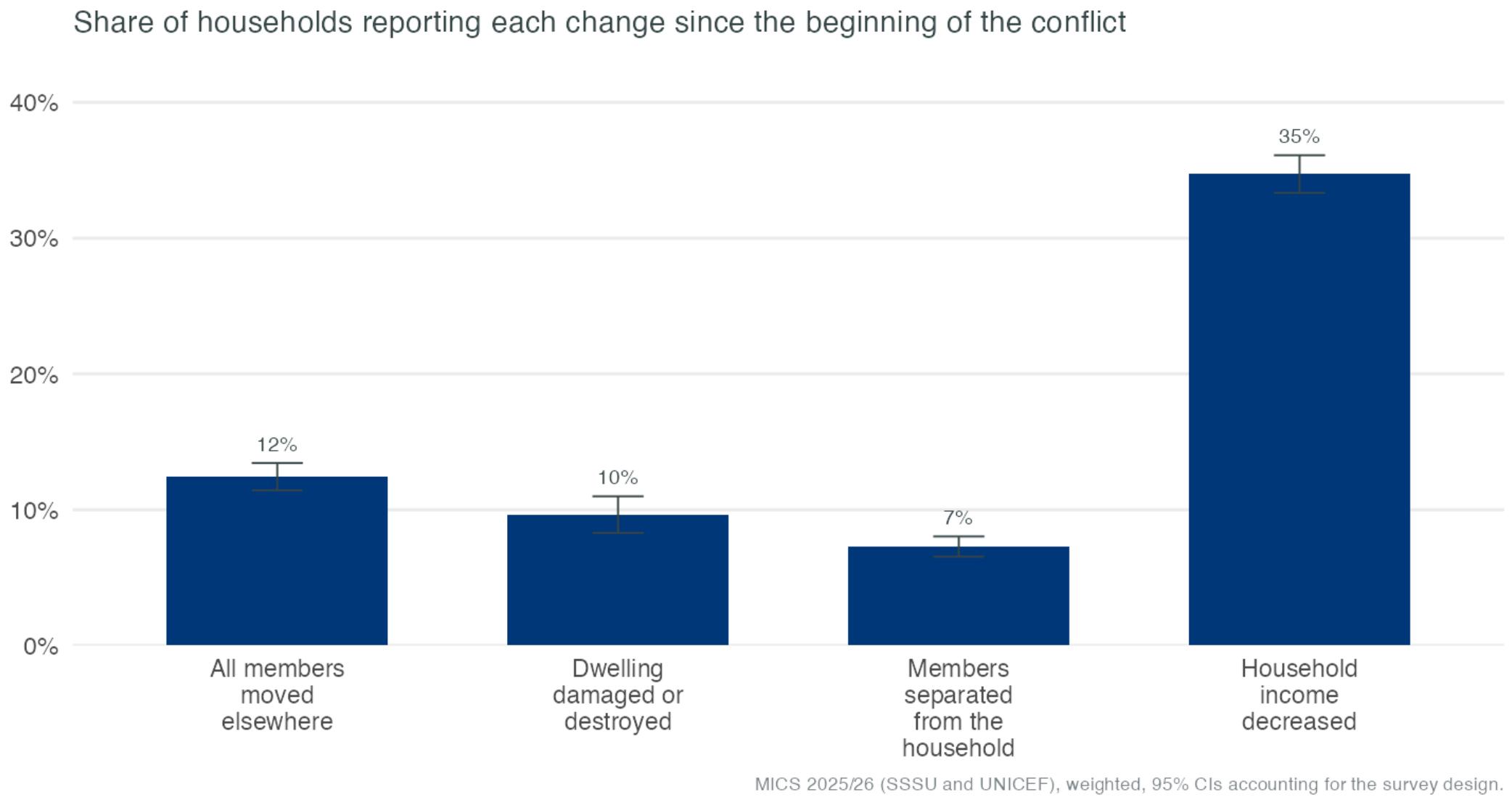
NEET by household changes since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)

NEET among women aged 15-24, by household changes since the beginning of the conflict



MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

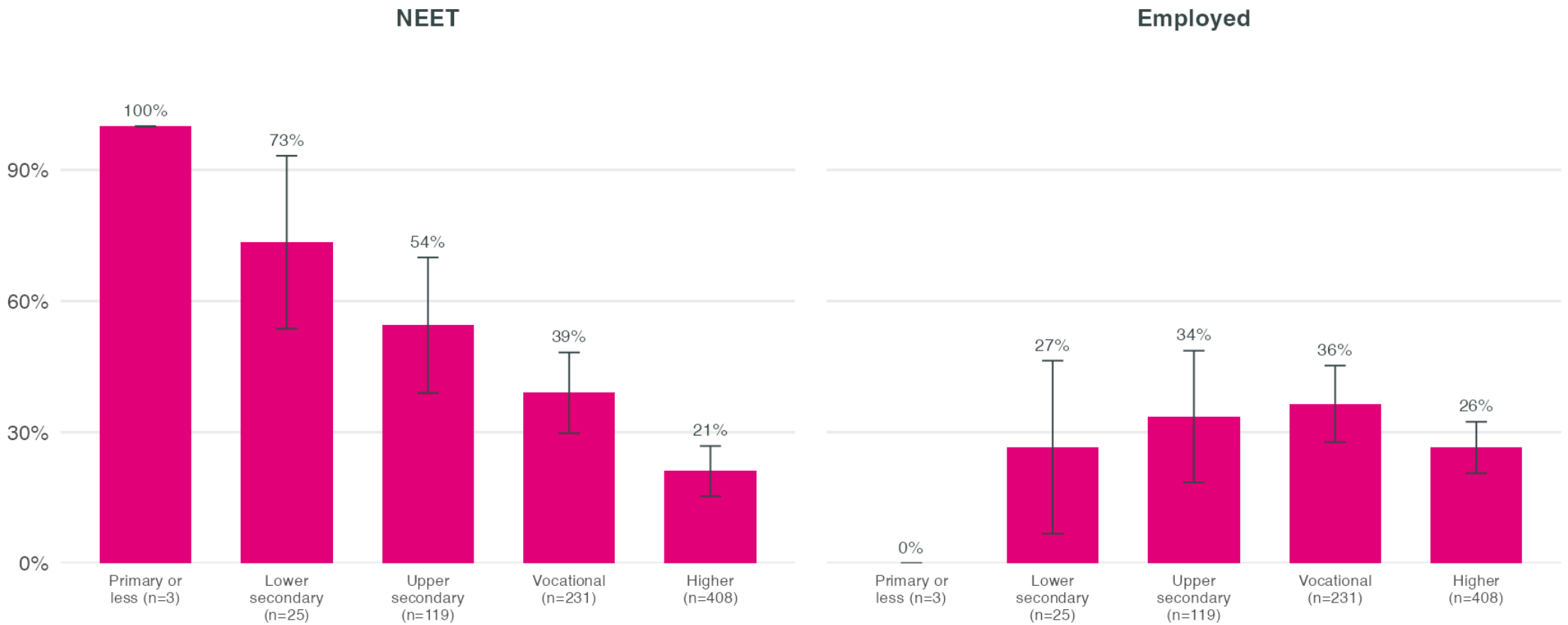
Households since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)



Moved: 12%. Lower income: 35%.

NEET and employment by education, women 18–24 (MICS)

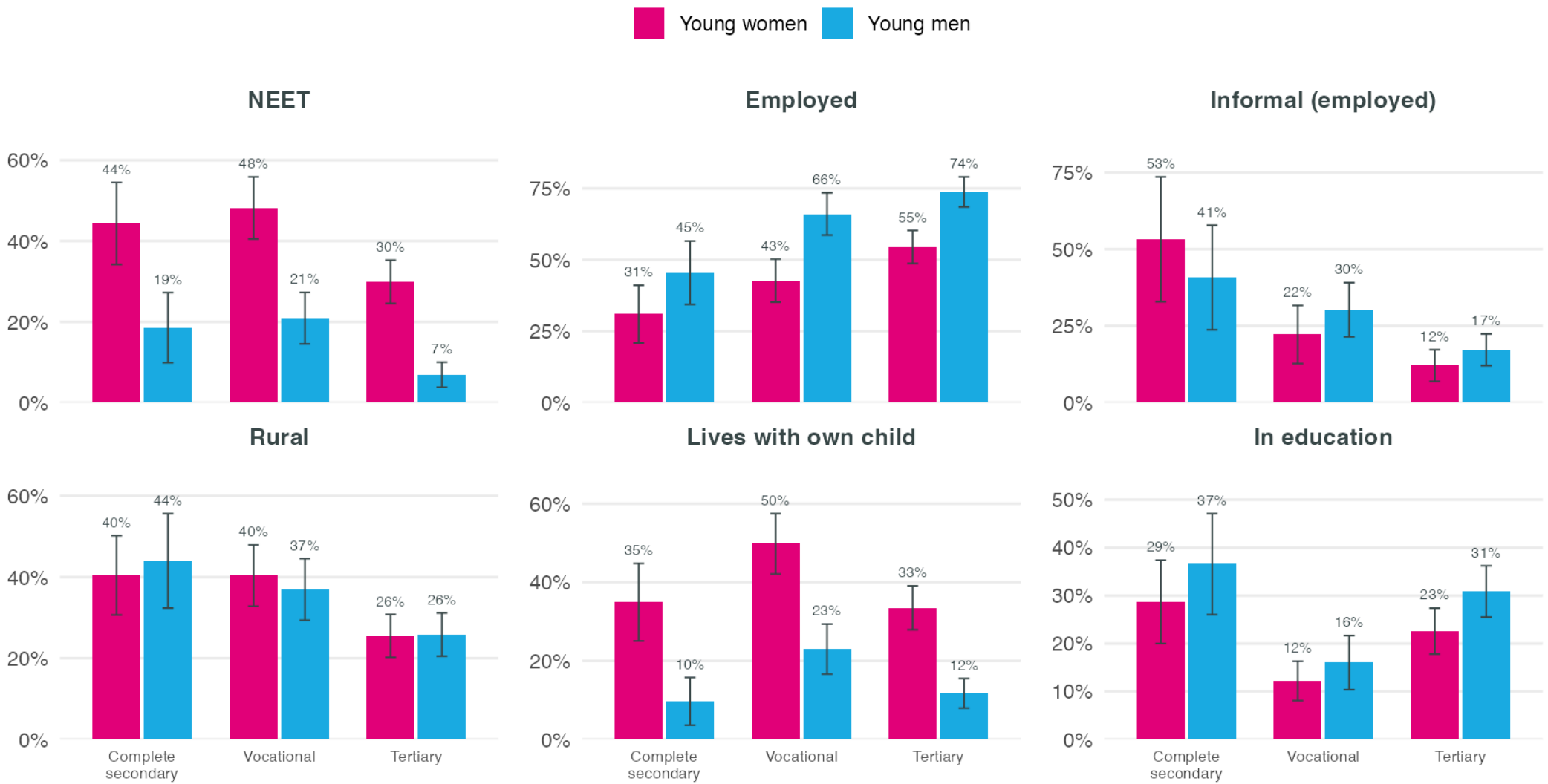
Women aged 18-24, by highest level of education



MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

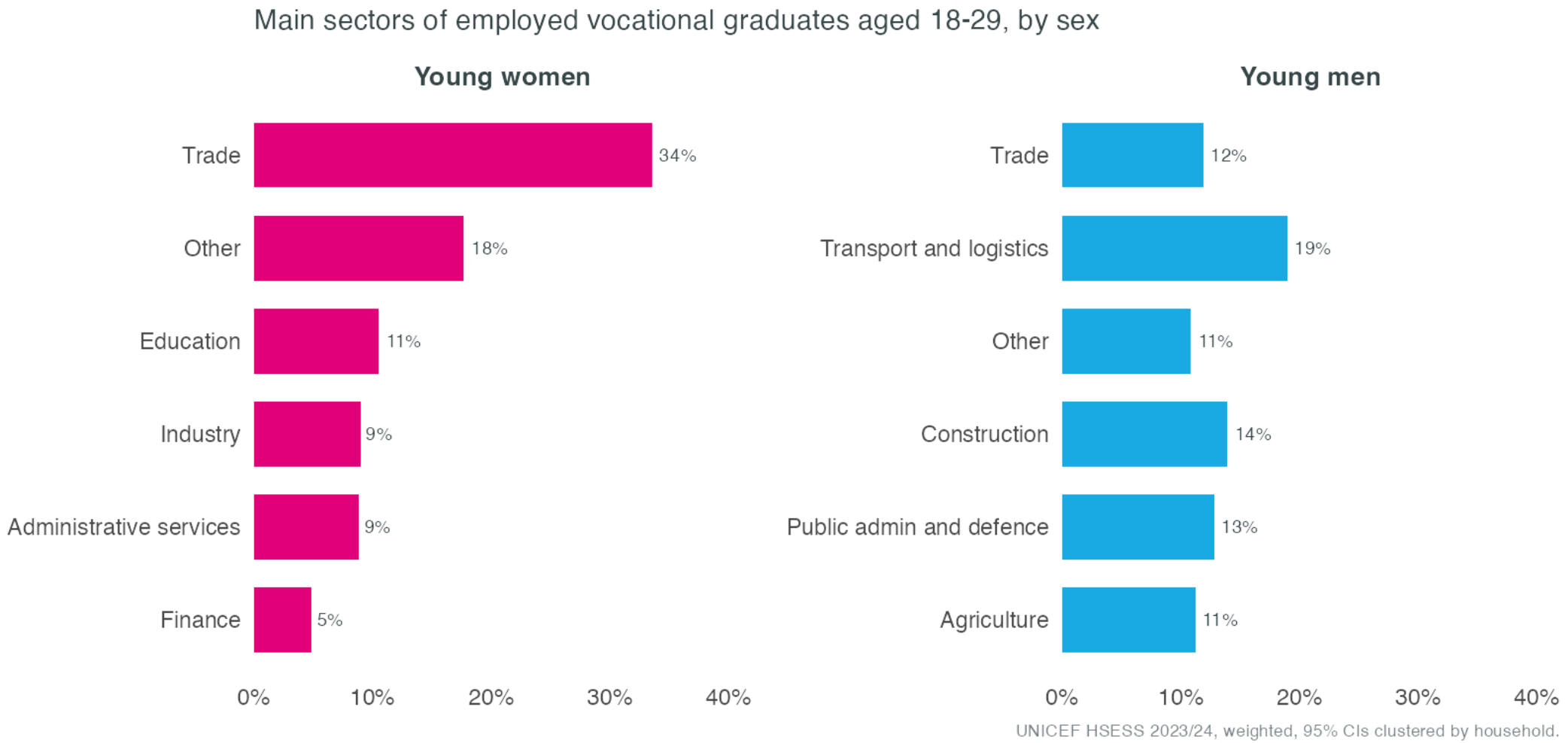
Vocational graduates aged 18–29: profile (HSESS)

People aged 18-29 by highest level of education and sex



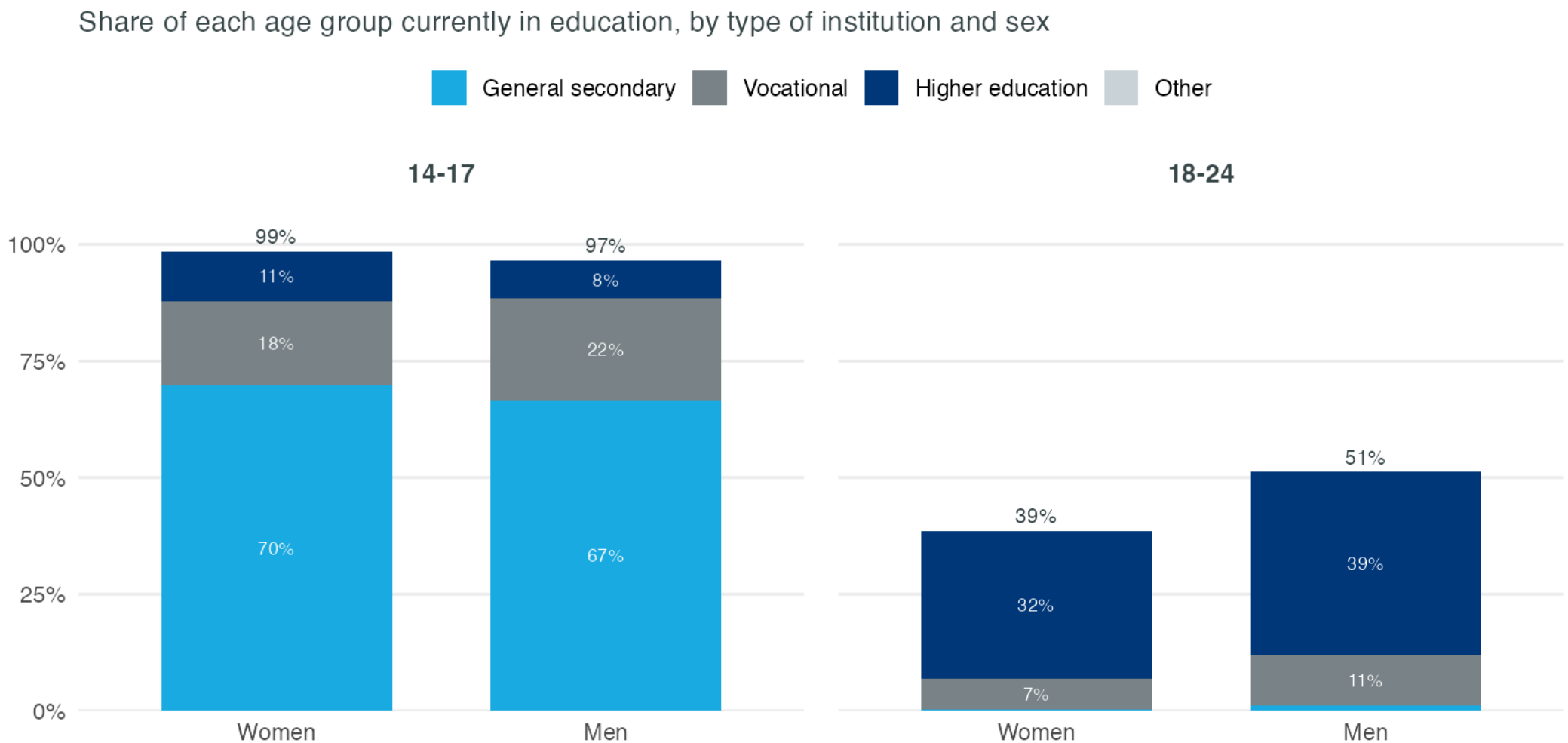
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Sectors of employed vocational graduates aged 18–29 (HSESS)



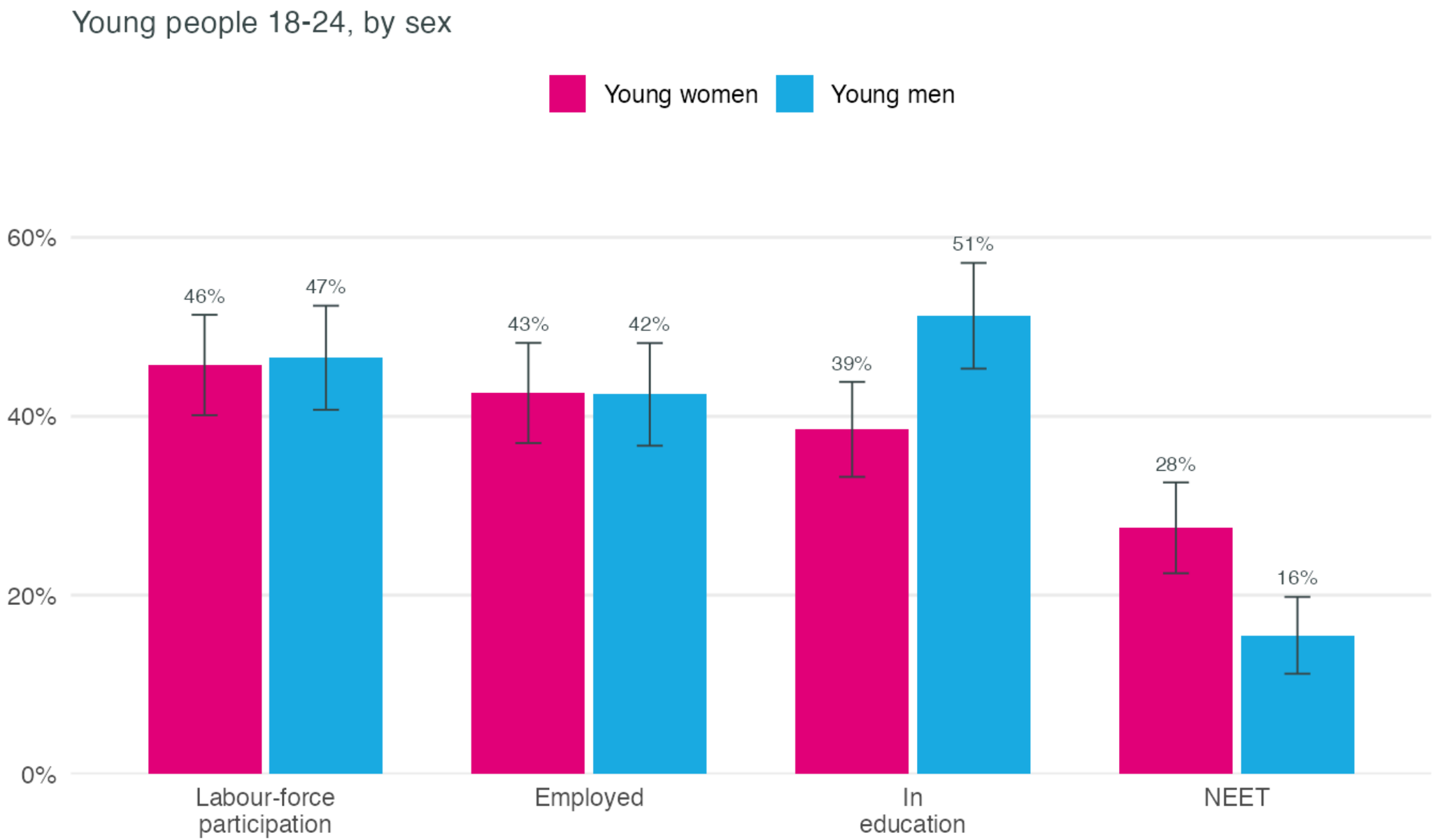
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

In education by type of institution (HSESS)



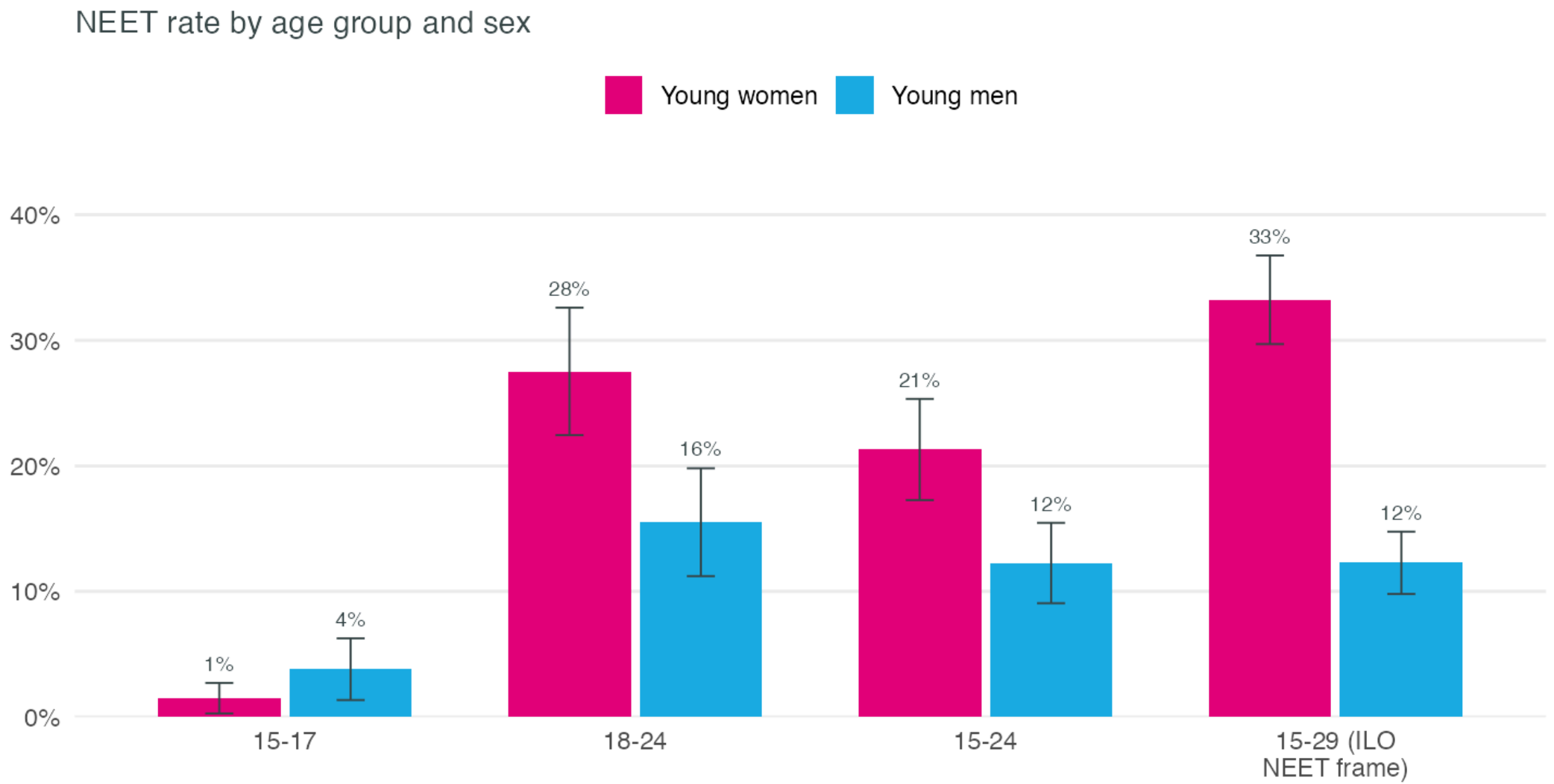
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Participation, employment, education and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



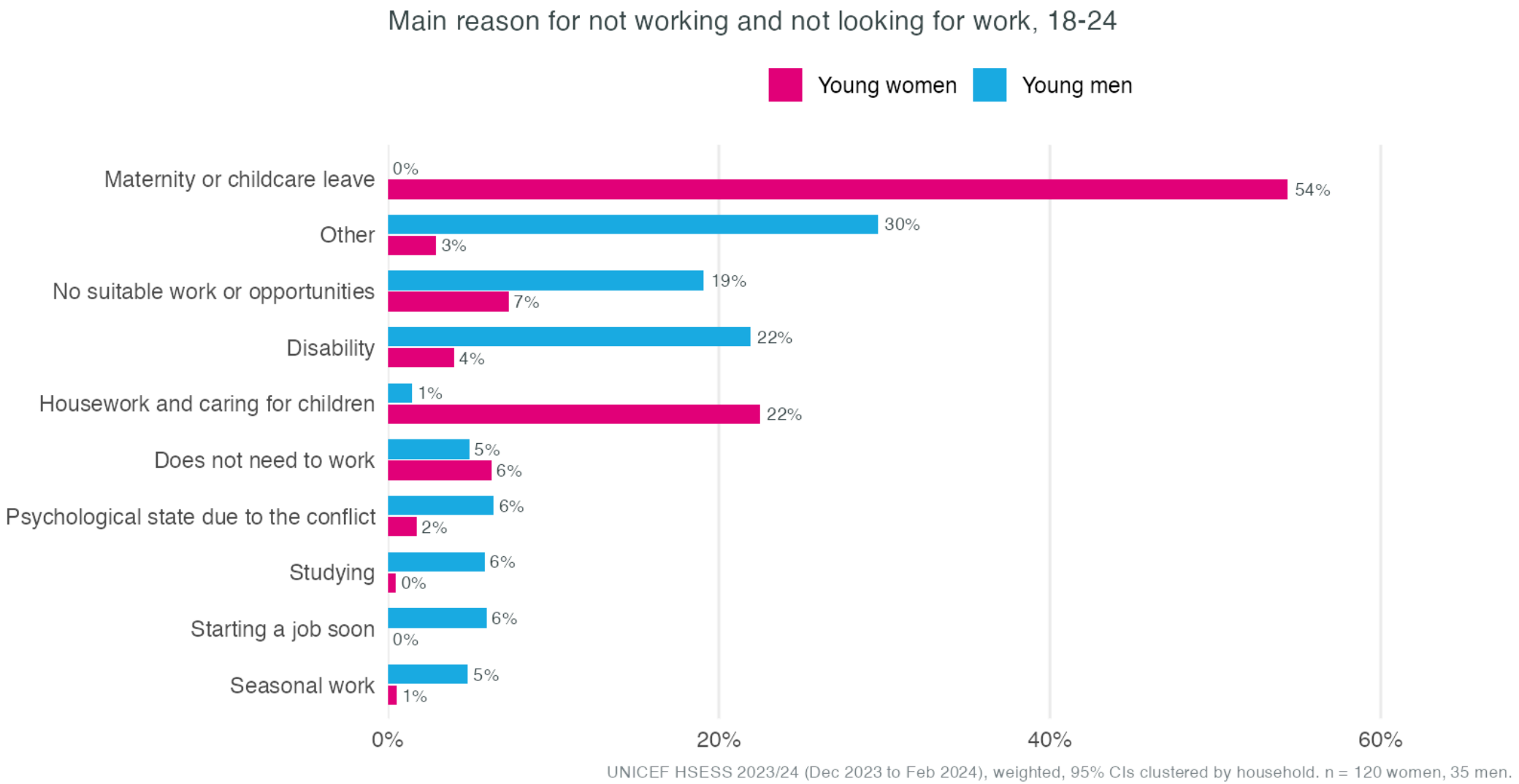
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

NEET by age group and sex (HSESS)



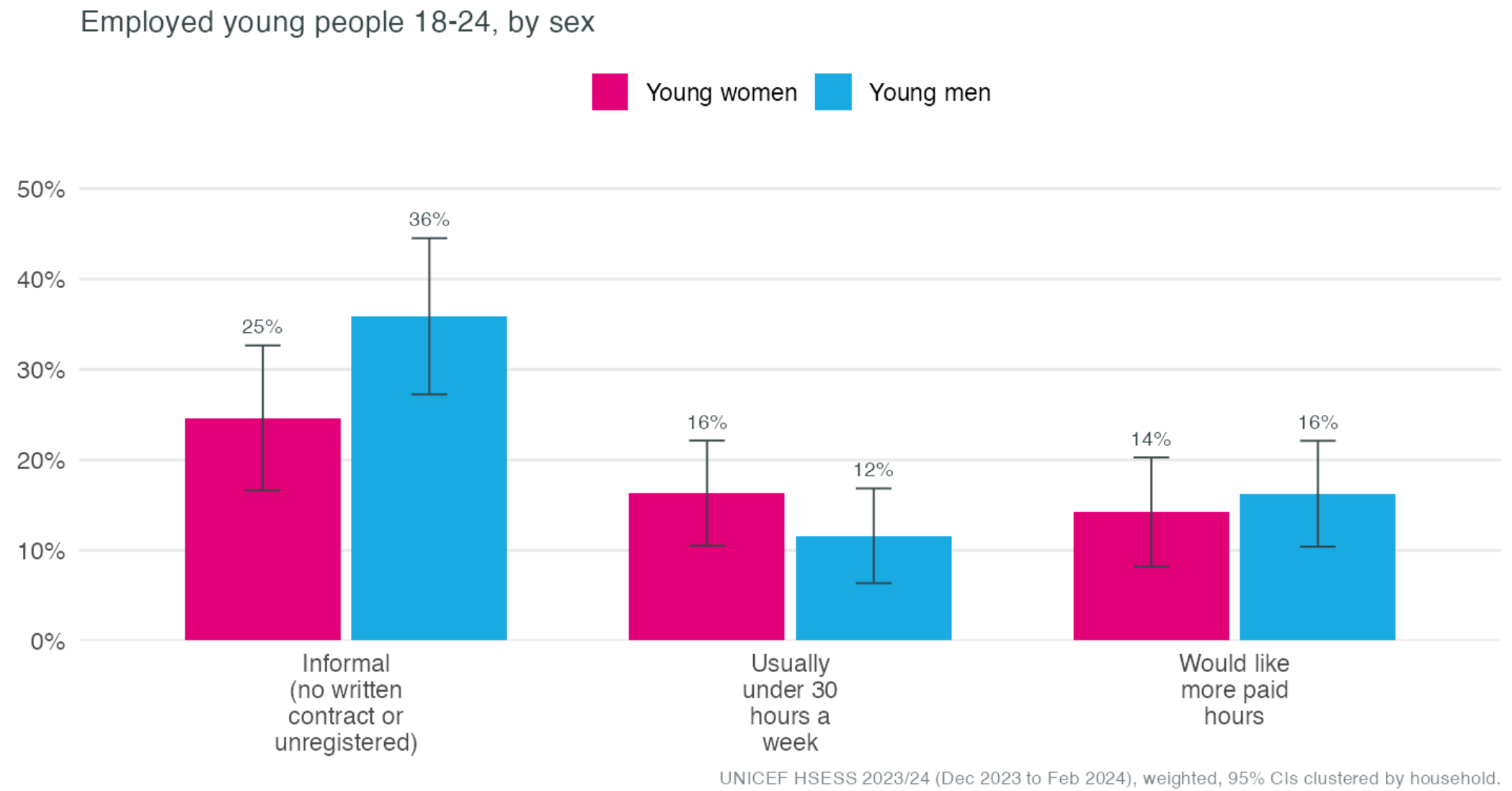
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Reasons for not working, detailed (HSESS)



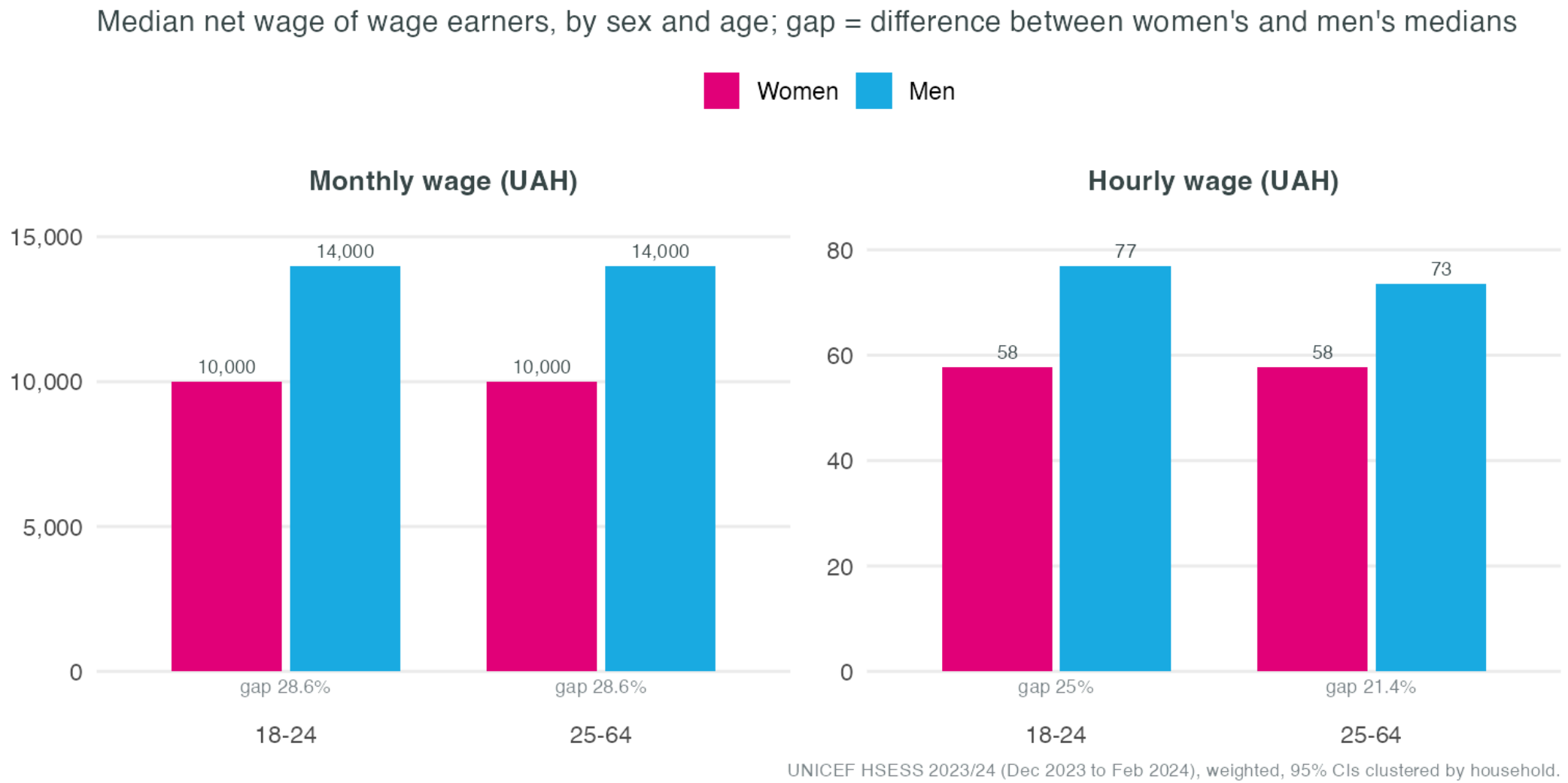
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household. n = 120 women, 35 men.

Informality, hours and wish for more hours at 18–24 (HSESS)



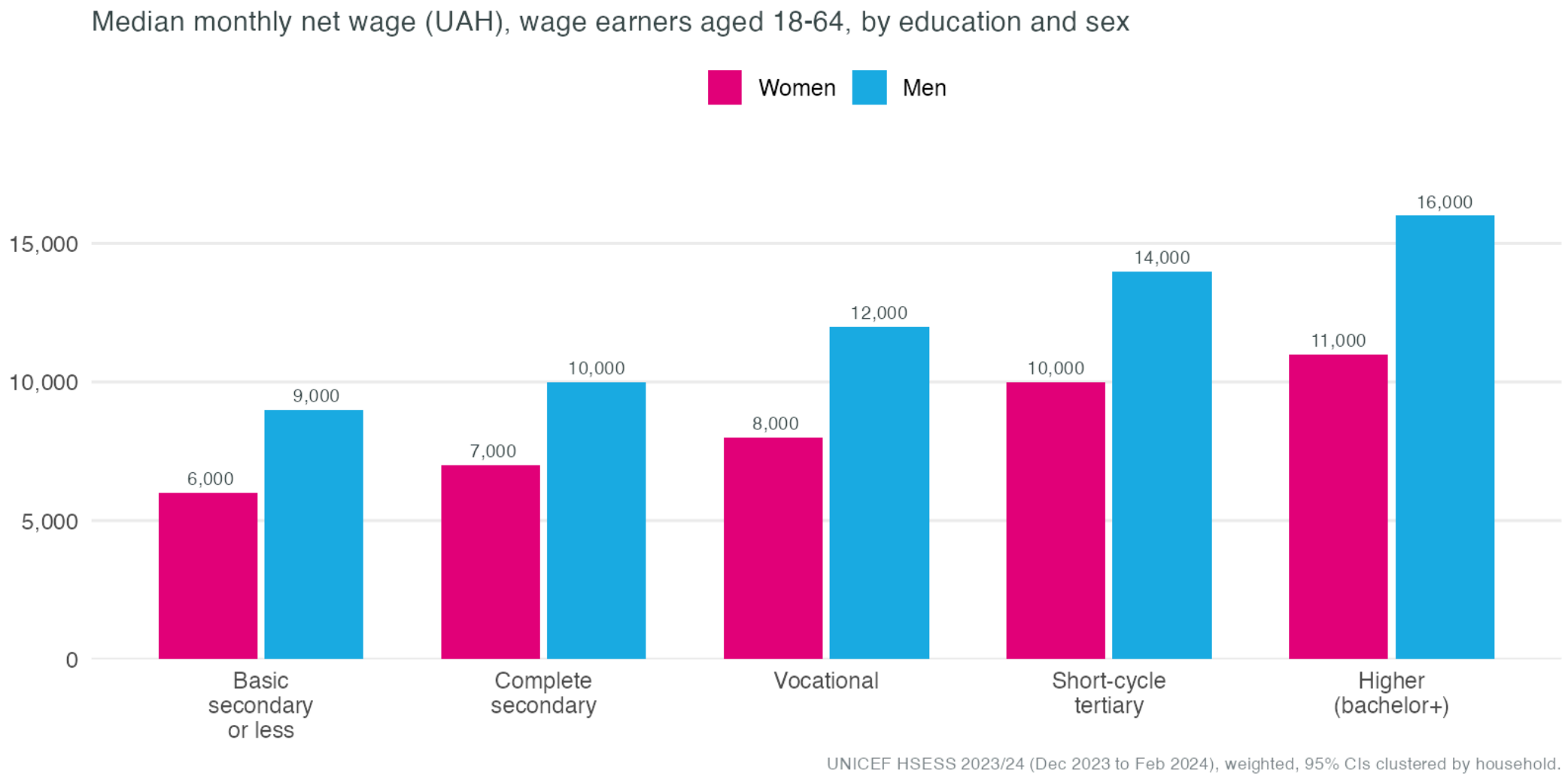
Informal: women 25%, men 36%.

Monthly and hourly wage gaps (HSESS)



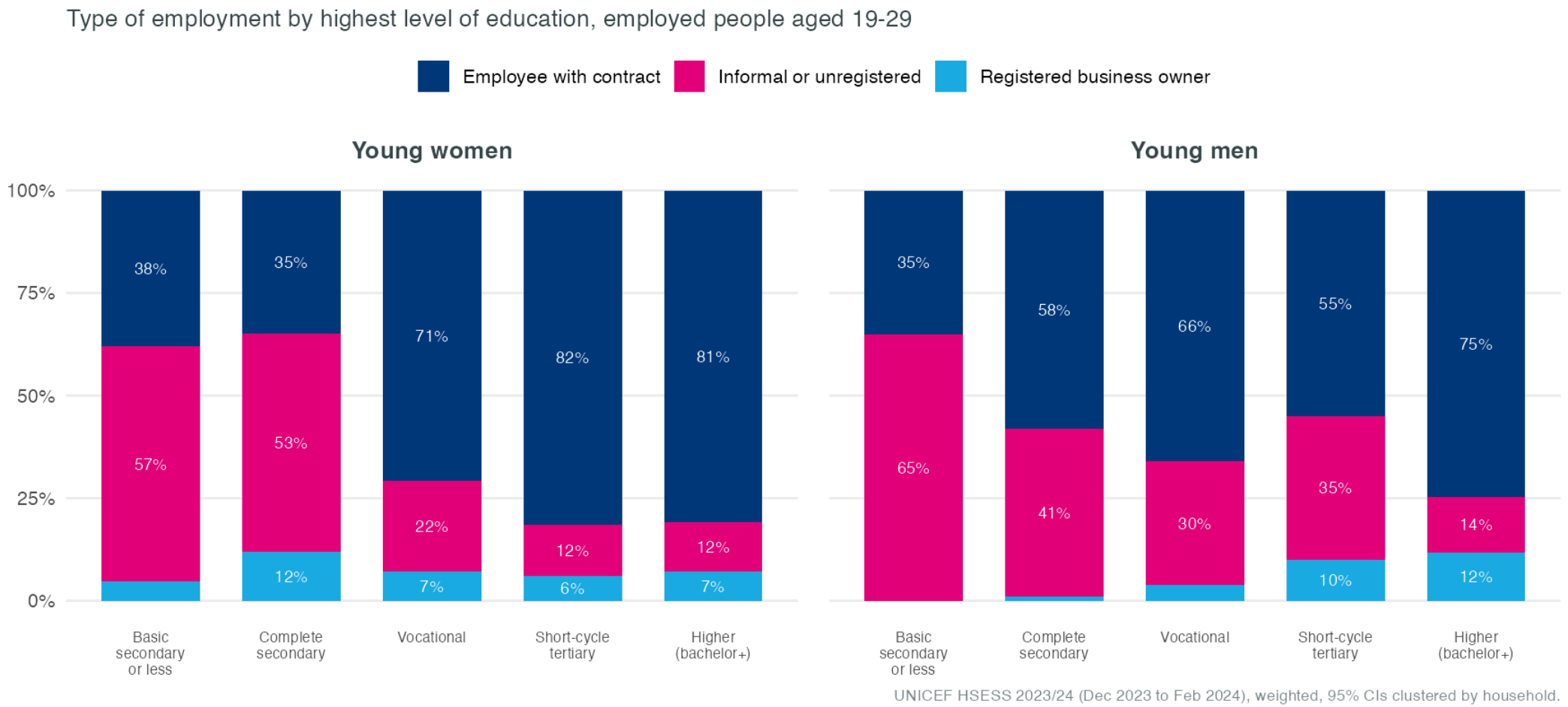
Hourly gap at 18–24: 25%.

Median wage by education and sex (HSESS)

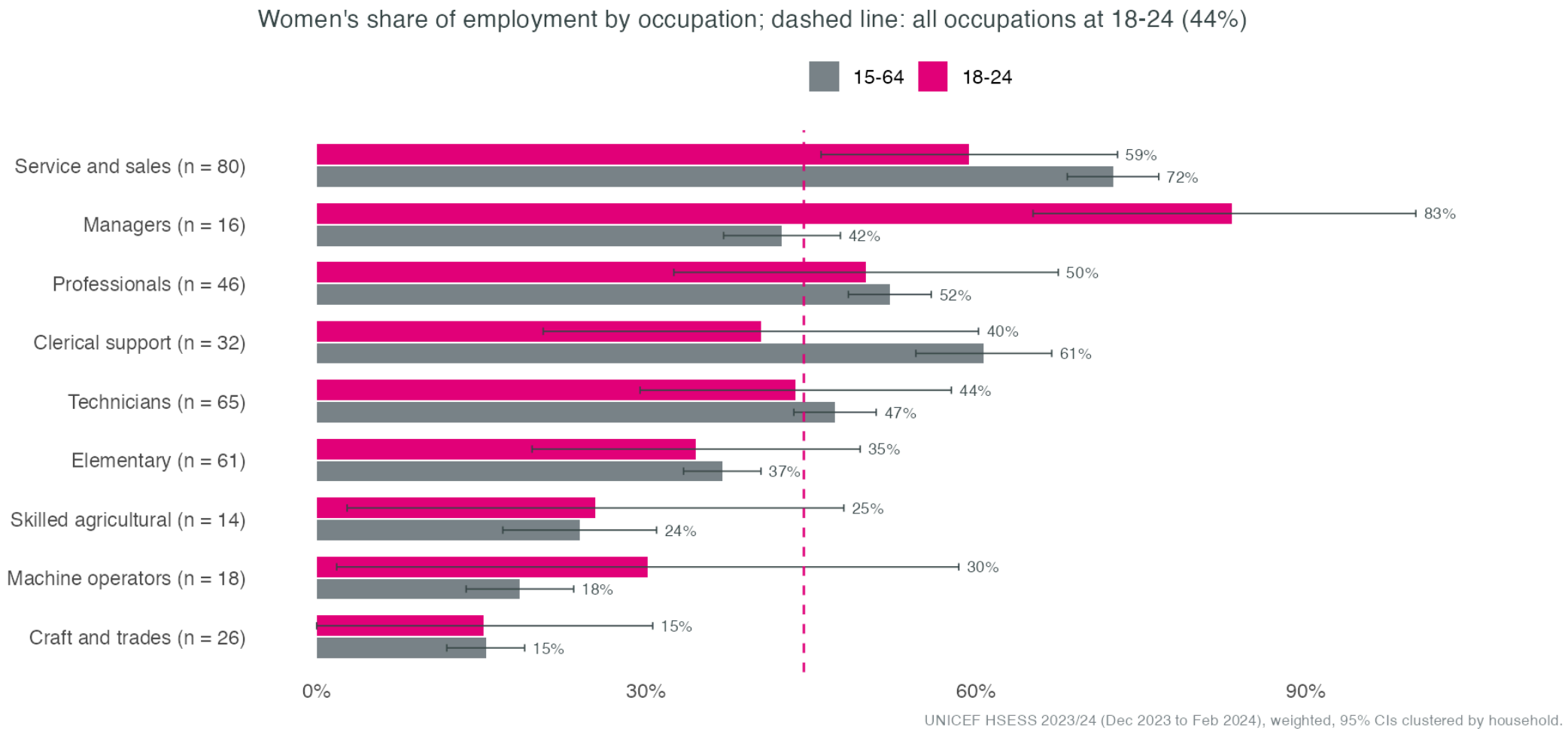


UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Type of employment by education, employed 18–29 (HSESS)

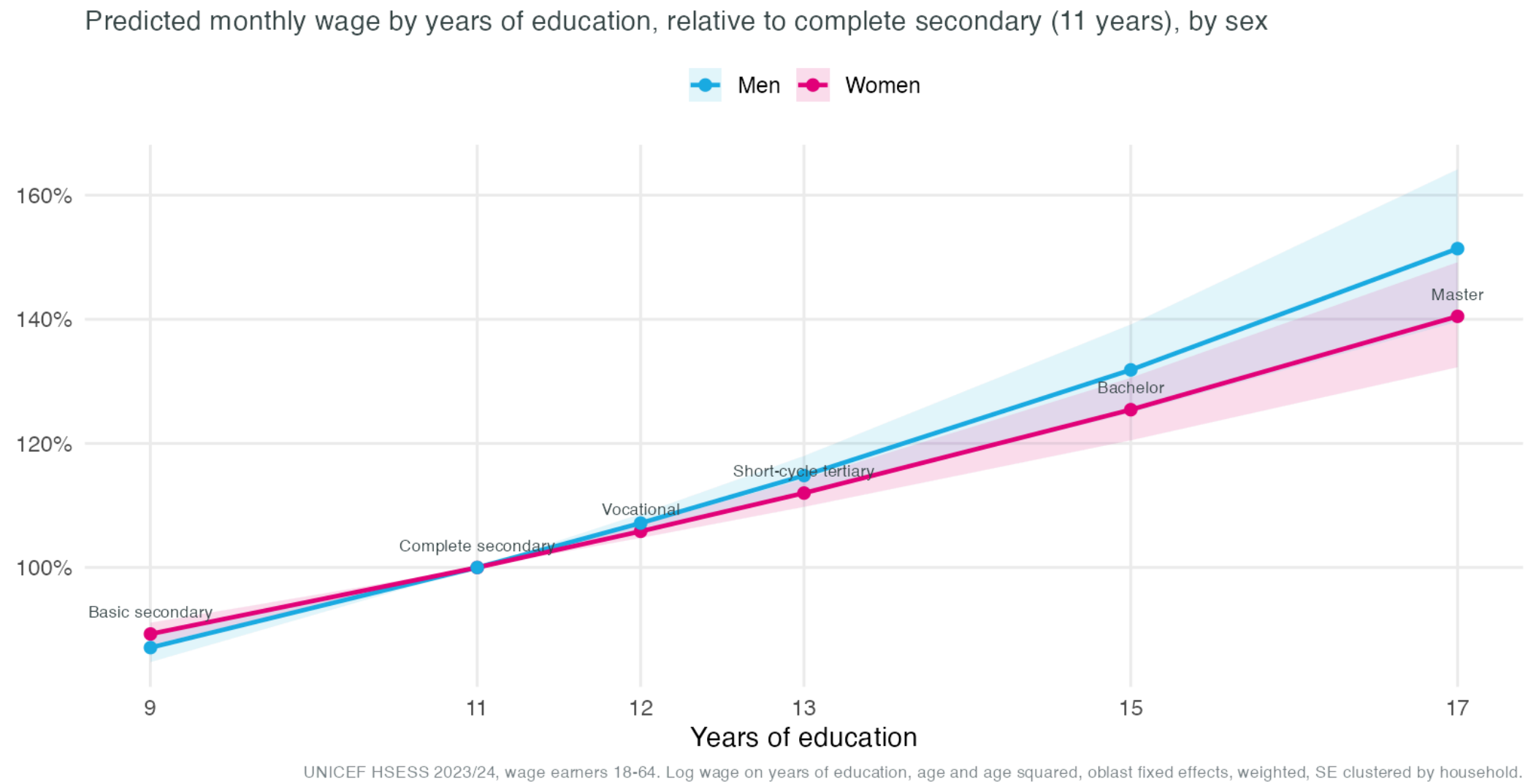


Women’s share of employment by occupation (HSESS)



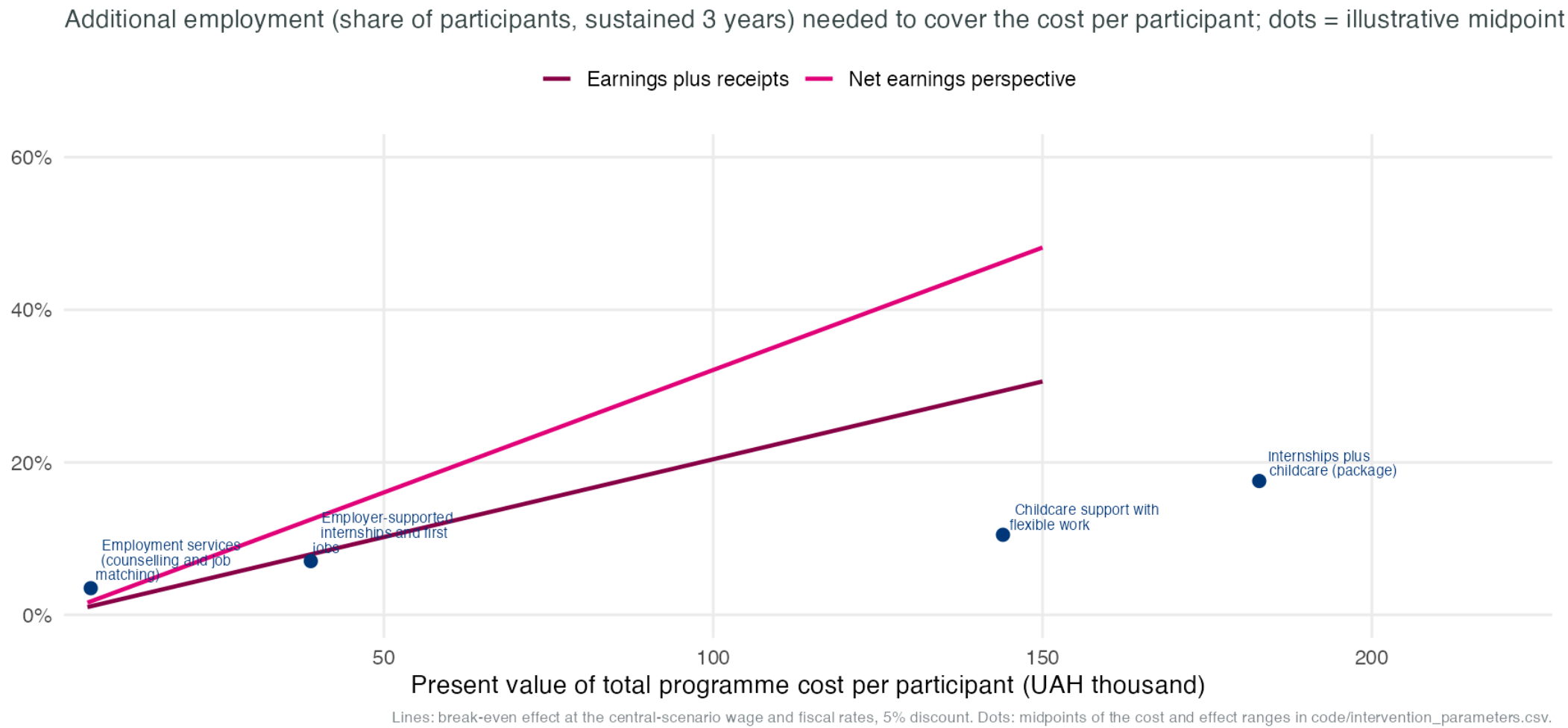
Occupation group as reported by the respondent; groups at 18–24 are small (n shown).

Wages and years of education (HSESS)



Return per additional year: women 5.8%, men 7.2%.

Break-even curves by cost per participant (illustrative)

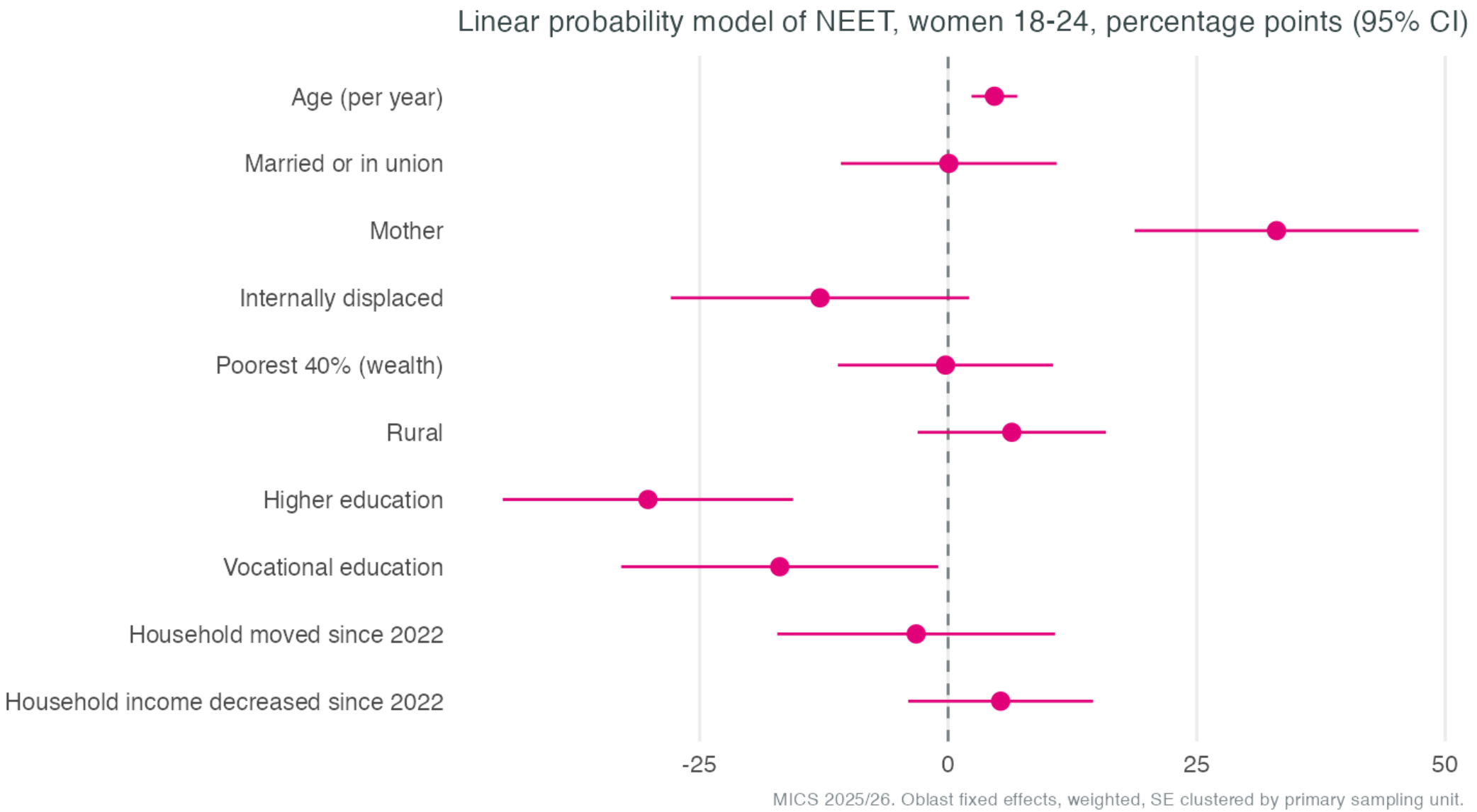


Break-even applications by intervention, 1, 3 and 5 years

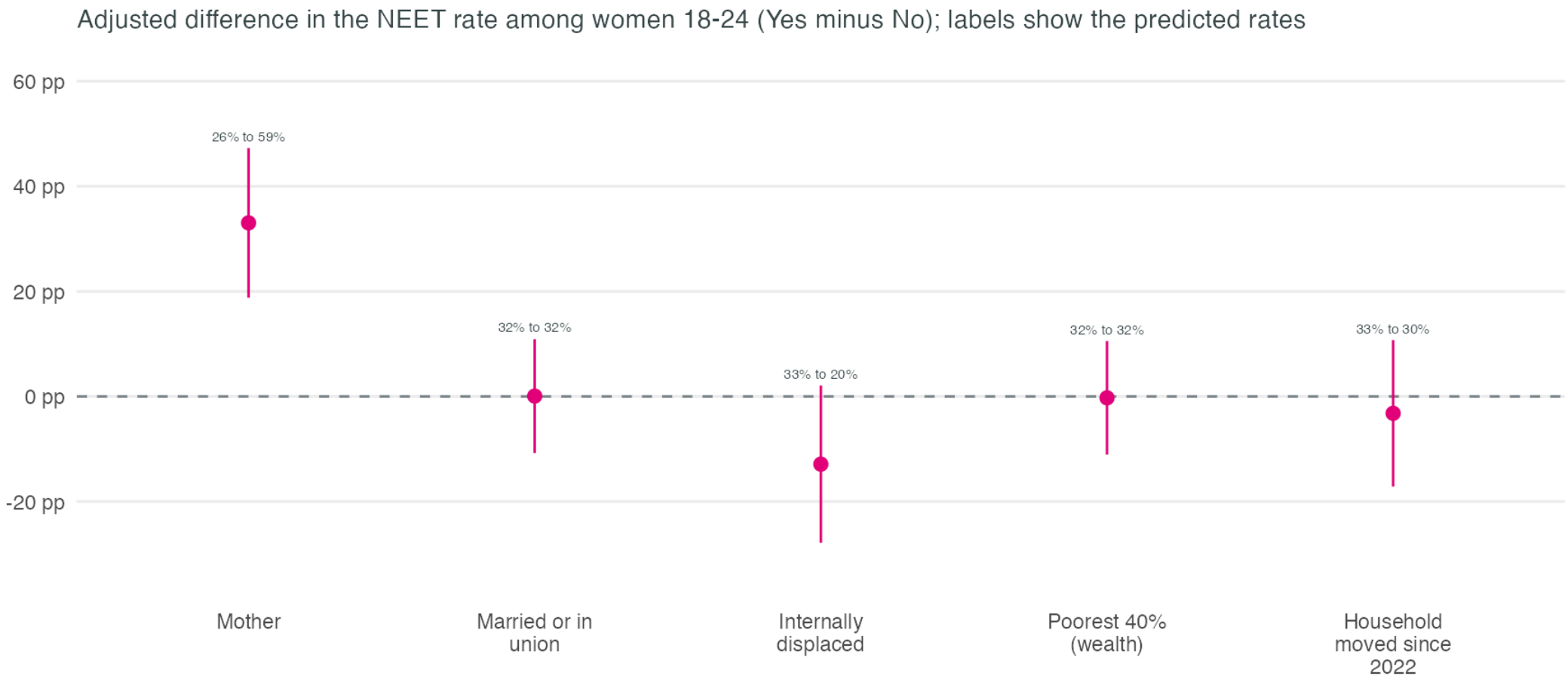
Intervention	Target group	Years	Cost per participant (UAH)	Needed, net earnings	Needed, plus receipts	Evidence range
Employment services (counselling and job matching)	All NEET young women	1	3,000 to 8,000	3% to 7%	2% to 5%	2% to 5%
Employment services (counselling and job matching)	All NEET young women	3	3,000 to 8,000	1% to 3%	1% to 2%	2% to 5%
Employment services (counselling and job matching)	All NEET young women	5	3,000 to 8,000	1% to 2%	0% to 1%	2% to 5%
Employer-supported internships and first jobs	All NEET young women	1	25,941 to 51,882	24% to 48%	15% to 30%	5% to 9%
Employer-supported internships and first jobs	All NEET young women	3	25,941 to 51,882	8% to 17%	5% to 11%	5% to 9%
Employer-supported internships and first jobs	All NEET young women	5	25,941 to 51,882	5% to 10%	3% to 7%	5% to 9%
Childcare support with flexible work	NEET young mothers	1	96,000 to 192,000	88% to 176%	56% to 112%	7% to 14%
Childcare support with flexible work	NEET young mothers	3	96,000 to 192,000	31% to 62%	20% to 39%	7% to 14%
Childcare support with flexible work	NEET young mothers	5	96,000 to 192,000	19% to 39%	12% to 25%	7% to 14%
Internships plus childcare (package)	NEET young mothers	1	121,941 to 243,882	112% to 224%	71% to 142%	12% to 23%
Internships plus childcare (package)	NEET young mothers	3	121,941 to 243,882	39% to 78%	25% to 50%	12% to 23%
Internships plus childcare (package)	NEET young mothers	5	121,941 to 243,882	25% to 49%	16% to 31%	12% to 23%

“Needed”: share of participants who must gain additional employment, sustained for the number of years shown, for benefits to equal the cost per participant (from the low to the high cost). “Evidence range”: employment effects reported in evaluations in other contexts. Central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount.

Model of NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)

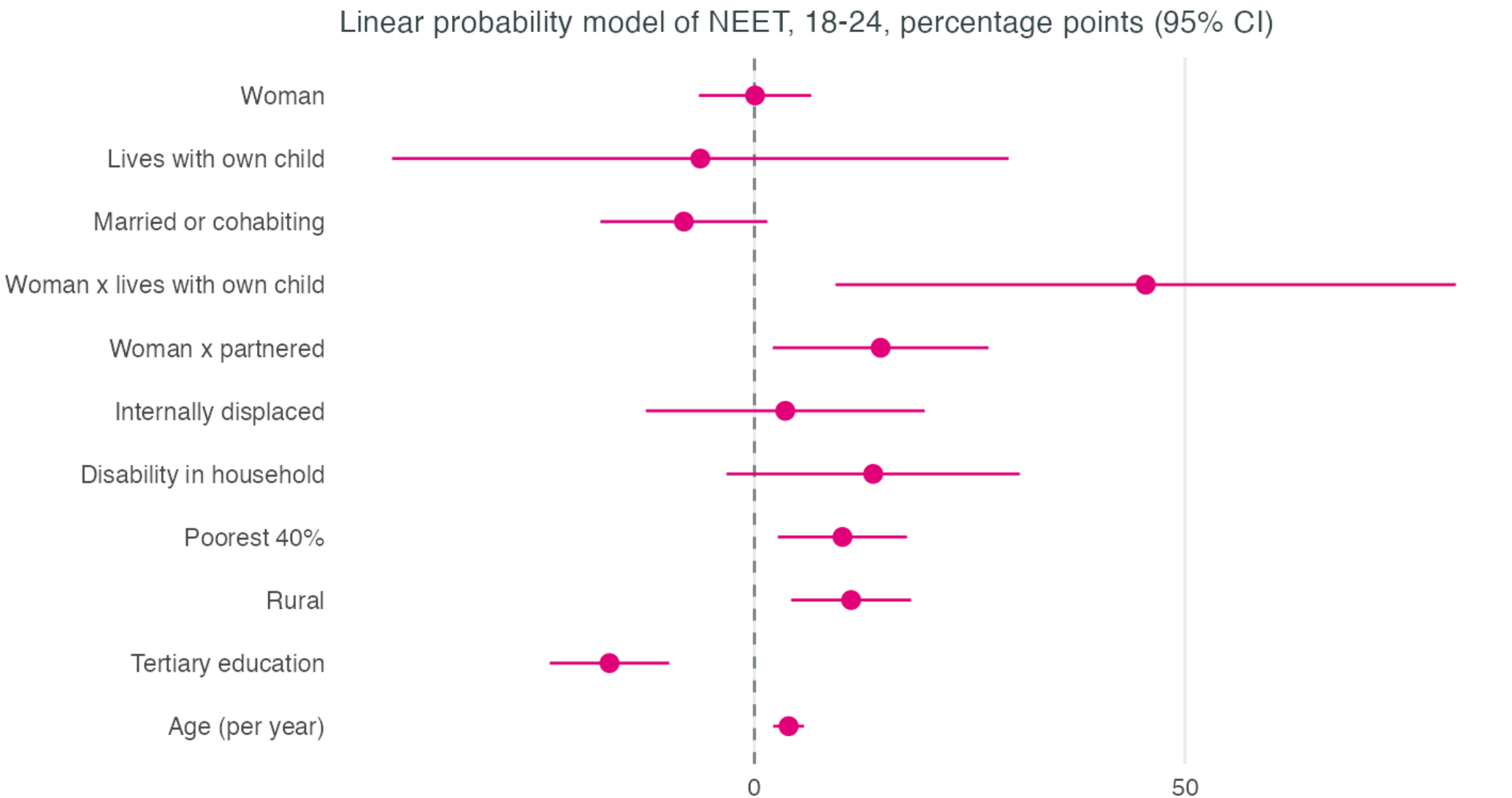


Adjusted differences in NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)



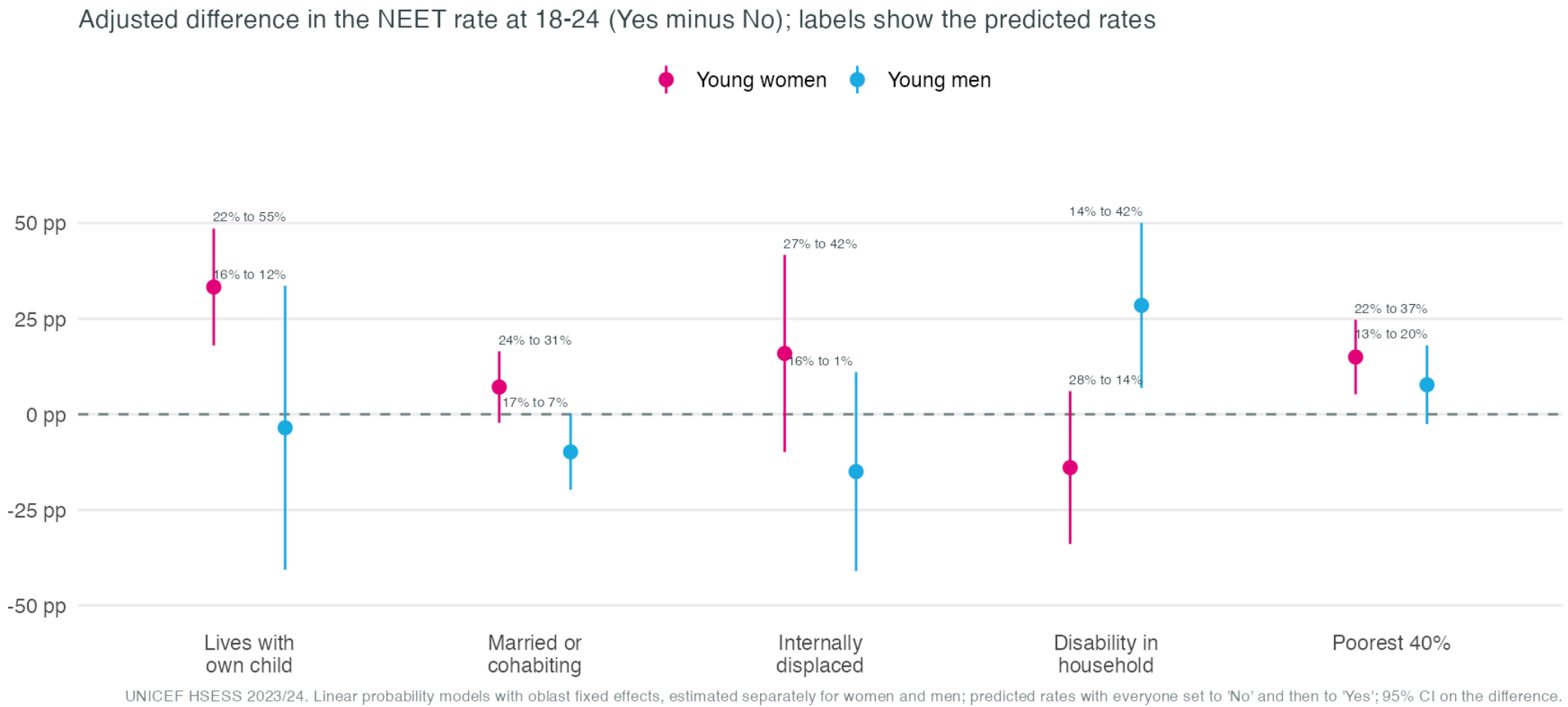
MICS 2025/26. Linear probability model with oblast fixed effects; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

Model of NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)

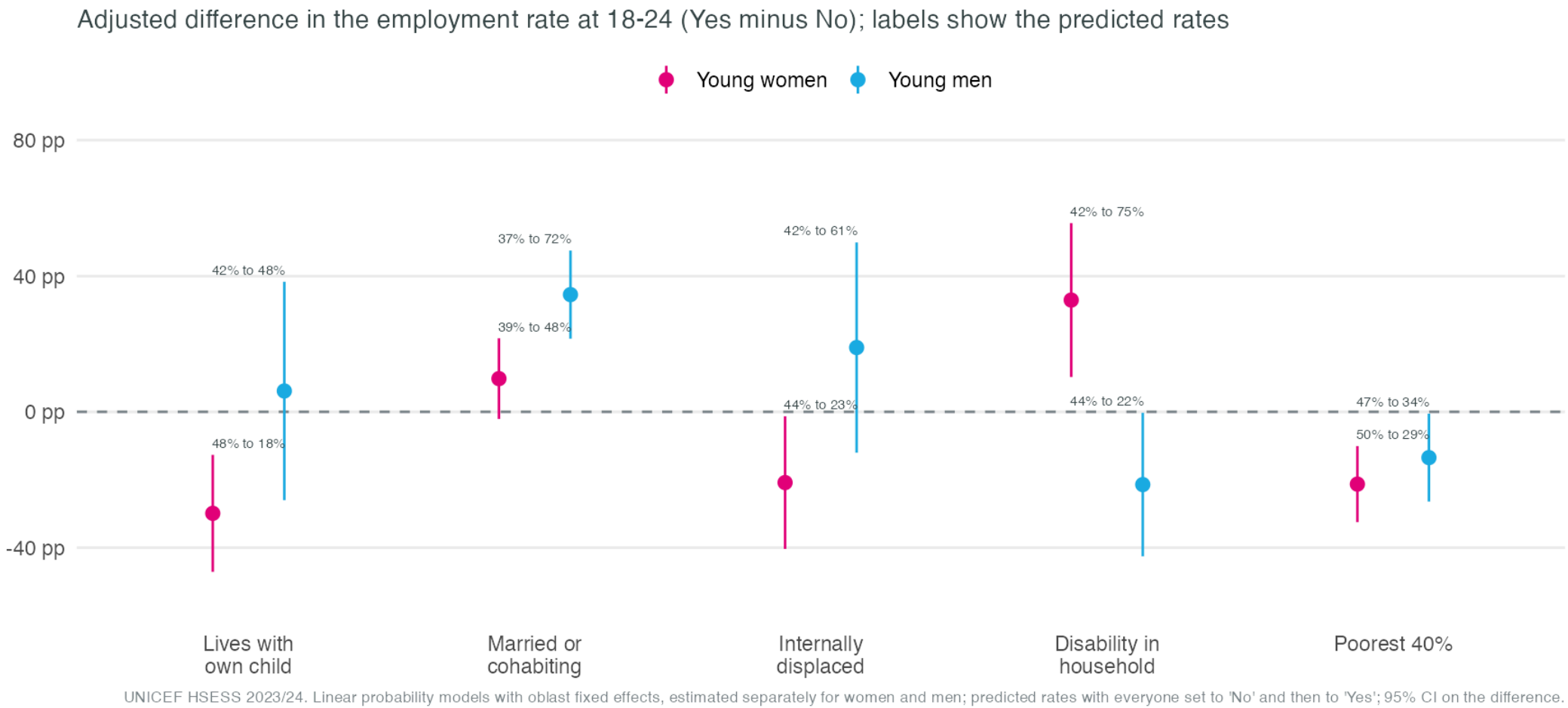


UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Oblast fixed effects, weighted, SE clustered by household.

Adjusted differences in NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



Adjusted differences in employment, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Linear probability models with oblast fixed effects, estimated separately for women and men; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

Estimates, MICS 2025/26

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: married or in union	Women 18-24	0.1	5.5	0.990	709
NEET: mother	Women 18-24	33.0	7.3	<0.001	709
NEET: married x mother	Women 18-24	11.2	12.9	0.390	709
NEET: internally displaced	Women 18-24	-12.9	7.6	0.092	709
NEET: poorest 40% (wealth)	Women 18-24	-0.3	5.5	0.960	709
NEET: rural	Women 18-24	6.4	4.8	0.180	709
NEET: household moved since 2022	Women 18-24	-3.2	7.1	0.650	709
NEET: household income decreased since 2022	Women 18-24	5.3	4.7	0.260	709
NEET: functional difficulty	Women 18-24	14.1	16.3	0.390	709

Effects in percentage points. Women aged 18–24. Controls: age, marital status, motherhood, displacement, poorest 40%, rural, education level, household moved and household income decreased since 2022, oblast fixed effects. Functional difficulty is estimated for women 18–24.

Estimates, HSESS 2023/24

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: women vs men	18-24	6.3	3.0	0.033	1084
NEET: woman x lives with own child	18-24	55.1	17.9	0.002	1084
NEET: woman x married or cohabiting	18-24	21.3	6.7	0.002	1084
NEET: internally displaced	18-24	5.2	8.4	0.530	1084
NEET: person with disability in household	18-24	13.5	9.2	0.140	1084
NEET: poorest 40% of households	18-24	8.9	3.9	0.021	1084
NEET: woman x poorest 40%	18-24	7.7	6.7	0.250	1084
NEET: rural	18-24	12.9	3.6	<0.001	1084

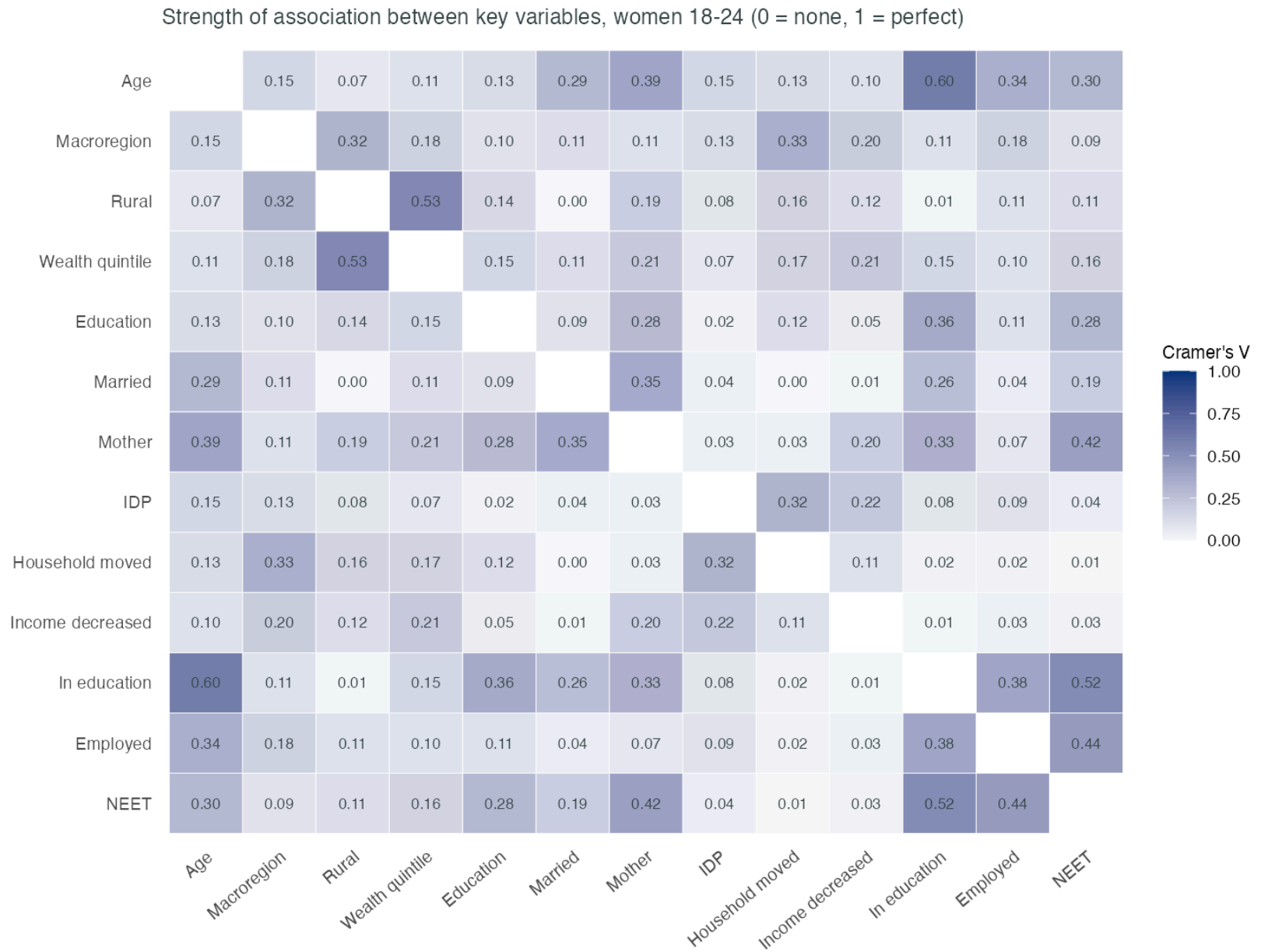
Effects in percentage points. Ages 18–24. Controls: age, rural, displacement, disability in household, poorest 40%, lives with own child, partnership and tertiary education (except where interacted), oblast fixed effects.

Returns to education, HSESS 2023/24

Sample	Return per year (%)	95% low	95% high	p	N
Women 18-64	5.8	4.8	6.9	<0.001	3112
Men 18-64	7.2	5.7	8.6	<0.001	2772
Difference women vs men (interaction)	-0.9	NA	NA	0.230	5884

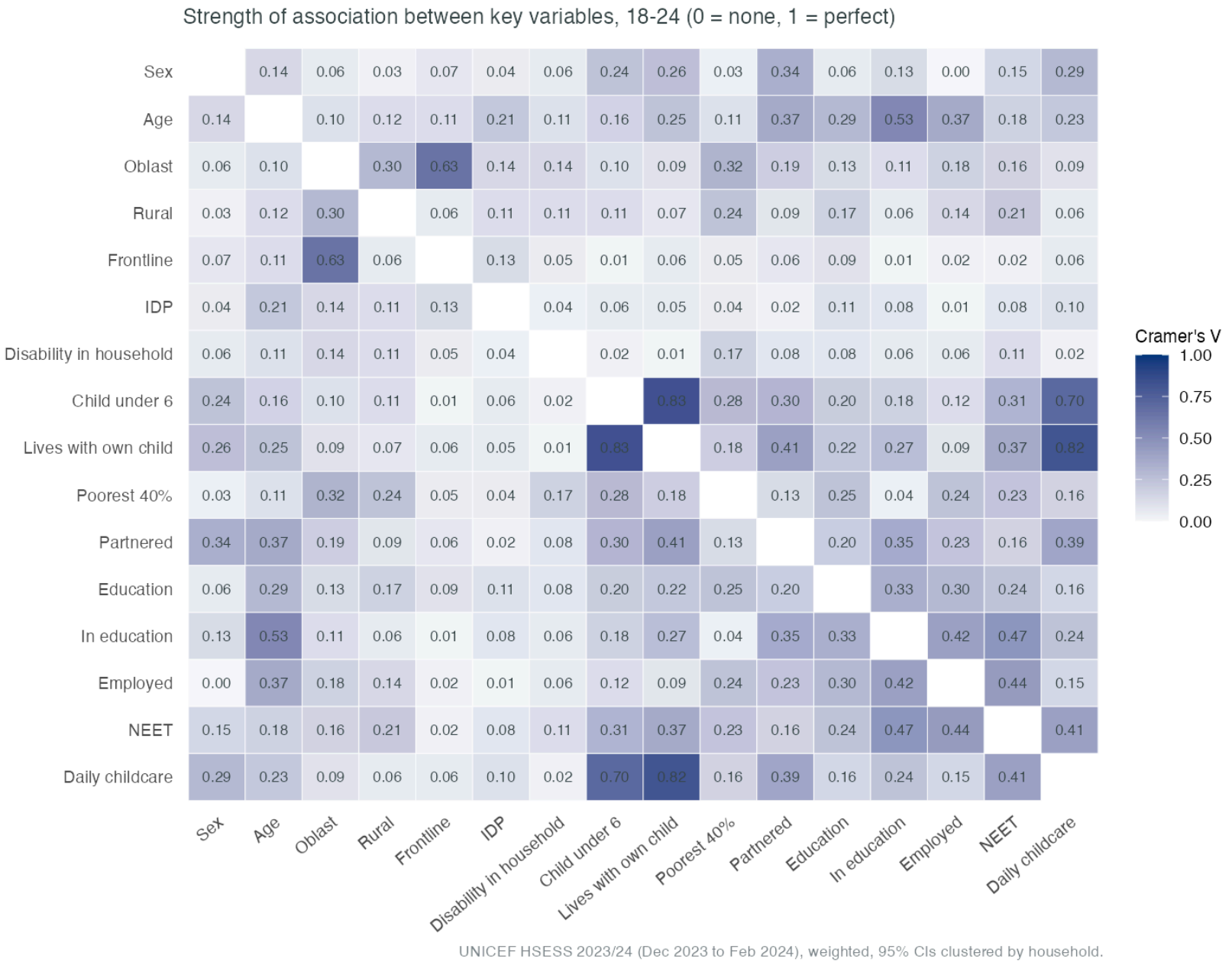
Log monthly net wage on years of education, age and age squared, oblast fixed effects, weighted, standard errors clustered by household. Wage earners aged 19–64.

Association between key variables, women 18–24 (MICS)



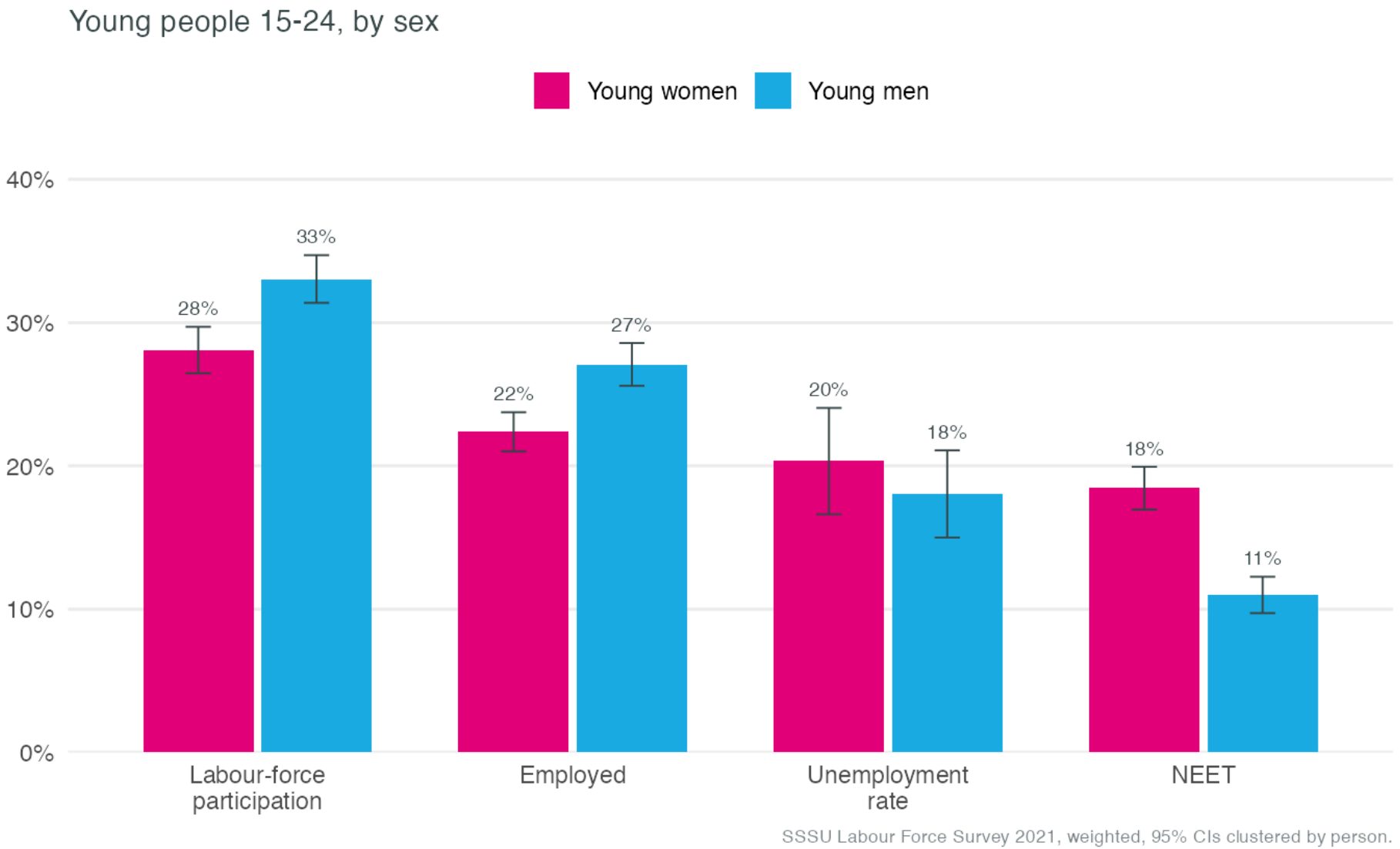
MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

Association between key variables, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



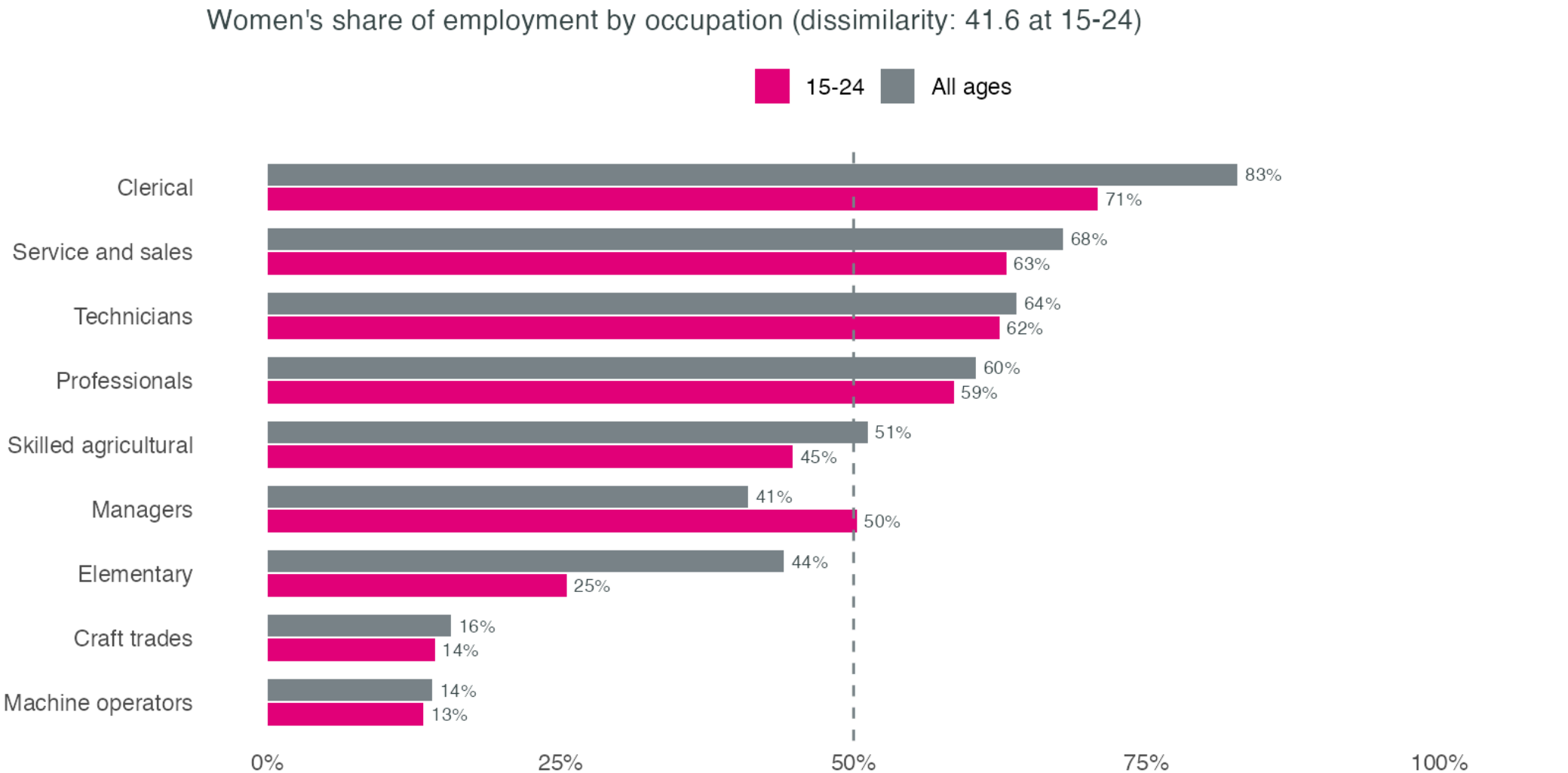
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: outcomes at 15–24 (age released only in bands)



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021. NEET: women 18%, men 11%. Age is released in bands, so 18–24 cannot be shown.

Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: occupations



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

HSESS variables used

Variable	Code	Variable	Code	Variable	Code
key (ind)	questionnaire key	econ_status (ind)	IND_B1	income_amount (ind)	IND_V1_1_1
weight (ind)	final weight	job_type (ind)	IND_B3_1	n_children (ind)	dity_n
oblast (ind)	OBLAST	sector (ind)	IND_B5_2	hh_size (ind)	hh_size
settlement (ind)	SETTL_TYPE	job_title (ind)	IND_B6_1	key (hh)	questionnaire key
relation (ind)	IND_A1	occupation (ind)	IND_B6_2	hh_income (hh)	V1
age (ind)	IND_A2	hours (ind)	IND_B9_1	disab_adult (hh)	D1_Mult3
sex (ind)	IND_A3	attitude (ind)	IND_B10_1	disab_child (hh)	D1_Mult4
marital (ind)	IND_A6	why_not_working (ind)	IND_B17_1	idp_hh (hh)	D1_Mult9
educ_level (ind)	IND_A7	seeking (ind)	IND_B21	veteran (hh)	D1_Mult10
in_educ (ind)	IND_A9	reason_inactive (ind)	IND_B24	lost_home (hh)	G3_5_1
institution (ind)	IND_A10	care_children (ind)	IND_B28_1	damaged_home (hh)	G3_5_2
preschool_reason (ind)	IND_A14	care_disabled (ind)	IND_B28_3	wealth (hh)	V16
moved (ind)	IND_A15	care_elderly (ind)	IND_B28_4		
idp (ind)	IND_A19	income_source (ind)	IND_V1_1		

Codes as in the questionnaire and the “variables_ukr” sheet of each HSESS file; “ind” = individual file, “hh” = household file.